WEDNESDAY
October 7, 2026

CHENNAI
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DHANALAKSHMI SRINIVASAN GROUP

FOUNDER'S

81st BIRTHDAY AND FOUNDER'S DAY CELEBRATIONS 2026

We cordially invite you to the august celebration of the 81st Birthday of our Founder on wednesday 07 October, 2026 at 09:30 a.m.

Shri A. SRINIVASAN,
Founder and Chairman, Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan Group and
Honorable Chancellor, Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan University

who, through his visionary thinking, dedication, educational service, social service, and humanitarian qualities, has built a strong foundation for the future of many generations.

This grand celebration will be held at the Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan University Auditorium in Perambalur.

With joy in extending a warm welcome – The Chancellor's Family Members

Son - Daughter-in-law

Shri. S. Kathiravan, MLA - Smt. Ananthalakshmi Kathiravan

Daughters - Sons-in-law

Smt. Jayanthi - Shri. Neelaraj
Smt. Ananthi - Shri. Rajaboopathy
Smt. Suganthi - Shri. Mani

and Grandchildren

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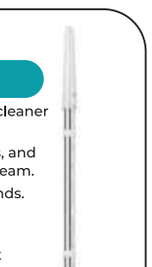

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Houthis claim Riyadh hit, deny losing ground

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Bestselling British novelist Jeffrey Archer dies at 86

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EASING BOTTLENECKS

Govt. plans 5-pronged reform for GST system

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OPENING UP

Indian research can shape world

National laboratories need to be liberated from insularity

OPINION » PAGE 9

SMRITI TAKES OVER

Harmanpreet quits as India captain

SPORT » PAGE 15

Bypolls held peacefully in Tamil Nadu, Puducherry

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Assembly byelections in Madurantakam and Dharapuram in Tamil Nadu and Thattanchavady in Puducherry went off peacefully on Tuesday.

Barring some glitches in the EVMs, polling in Madurantakam in Chengalpattu district was peaceful, with 86.26% voters exercising their franchise. While the final polling figures are awaited, the turnout was lower than the 93.22% recorded during the Assembly election. The byelection was necessitated by the resignation of Maragatham Kumaravel, who won on an AIADMK ticket in the Assembly election and then switched to the TVK, which has fielded her now.

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DMK'S PLEA TO ECI
» PAGE 6

Pioneer of IceCube neutrino detector wins physics Nobel

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

This year's Nobel Prize in Physics will be awarded to Belgium-born Francis Halzen, 82, for his contributions to IceCube, a neutrino observatory in the South Pole, and for the discovery of high-energy neutrinos of astrophysical origin.

While there are several massive detectors for these extremely elusive particles, IceCube is designed to find high-energy neutrinos that are believed to have originated far in space from energetic collisions.

These "cosmic neutrinos" with extremely high energies are very rare and an enormous volume of ice is needed to observe an adequate number of collisions.

Mr. Halzen, who is presently at the University of Wisconsin-Madison, in the U.S., first presented his vision for capturing neutrinos at the South Pole in 1988.

Francis Halzen

Pure, undisturbed ice is an ideal medium to capture these neutrinos: when they occasionally collide with atomic nuclei, they produce charged particles that announce themselves as a flash of pale blue light.

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18 accused of sharing Navy's sensitive info with Pakistan

Rajulapudi Srinivas
VIJAYAWADA

An espionage racket involving 18 people, including 13 personnel working for the Navy, allegedly shared sensitive information with Pakistani operatives, according to intelligence officials from Andhra Pradesh.

Two of the accused, a civilian driver engaged for Navy officers and a Visakhapatnam Naval Base employee, have been arrested.

Officials said on Tuesday that the Counter Intelligence Cell of the Andhra Pradesh uncovered the racket, which allegedly shared information related to defence establishments, including strategic locations at the Visakhapatnam Naval Base, with Pakistani intelligence operatives.

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Rahul labels SIR 'treason' as INDIA bloc ups the ante

LoP leads sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan after march to ECI office stopped; Opposition leaders demand CEC Kumar's removal; several MPs detained

Sobhana K. Nair
Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

"What has been done to my country is treason," Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said on Tuesday even as the Opposition parties closed ranks, marching from Parliament to the Election Commission of India's (ECI) headquarters to demand the scrapping of special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, restoring the names deleted from the rolls, and sacking of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Later in the evening, Mr. Gandhi, his sister, the Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other MPs were forcibly removed, detained and huddled into a bus even as Mr. Gandhi resisted, attempting to wriggle out of the vehicle's window.

Before being detained, Mr. Gandhi, along with Ms. Vadra and Congress leader K.C. Venugopal, held a sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan, just metres away from Nirvachan Sadan, where the protest march was stopped at 11 a.m. by Delhi Police.

Strong pushback: Rahul Gandhi trying to get out of a police van after being detained during a protest in New Delhi on Tuesday. AP

Around 6 p.m., Congress reached out to all parties to join the sit-in. Trinamool's Derek O' Brien and Mahua Moitra, IUML's E.T. Muhammad Basheer, and SP's Mohibullah Nadvi, who were removed earlier in the day by Delhi Police, also returned to join Mr. Gandhi.

While the Aam Aadmi Party and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam stayed away from the protest, all 19 parties that attended the September 30 Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) meeting were represented. Top Opposition leaders, including Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Trinamool general secretary Abhishek Banerjee, Shiv Sena (UBT)'s Sanjay Raut, and NCP (SP)'s Supriya Sule, were seen walking together. For the first time, Biju Janata Dal, which has maintained distance from both the ruling side and the INDIA bloc, joined in.

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UNUSUAL DEMAND: ECI
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NEARBY

CM Vijay owns poromboke land: petitioner in HC

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has claimed ownership of 50 cents of government poromboke land in Kodaikanal, an election petitioner has claimed before the High Court » PAGE 6

TVK-led regime has backstabbed nurses: Stalin

CHENNAI
DMK chief M.K. Stalin has alleged that the TVK had backstabbed nurses after promising them that it would fulfil their demands. » PAGE 6

Bodies of three workers handed over to families

ARIYALUR
After several days of protest, the families of three labourers who suffocated to death in a septic tank in Ariyalur on October 2, received their bodies on Tuesday. » PAGE 6

OPPORTUNITIES PAGE 5
▸ Over 20 Jobs in today's issue

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Actual site image

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INBRIEF

World Tourism Day celebrated at Madras Christian College

The Department of Tourism Studies at Madras Christian College celebrated "World Tourism Day" recently. It focused on Artificial Intelligence and the future of tourism. The inaugural event featured inter-collegiate competitions and an inter-school "Thinkathon 2026 Idea Pitching" competition. Industry leaders from the tourism sector, educators and college students discussed the transformative role of AI in tourism and hospitality at the inaugural session. D. Elangovan, managing director, SBLT Group participated in the celebrations, while B. George, principal in-charge, Madurai Kamaraj University College participated in "Thinkathon 2026". Paul Wilson, principal, Madras Christian College, urged students to cultivate industry-ready skills and digital competencies, a press release said.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (October 7, Wednesday), the following articles are available:

- The status of the U.S. blockade on Cuba **newsth.live/cubablockade**
- In this Delhi studio, tintype brings chemistry into every portrait **newsth.live/tintype**

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

CUMTA set to roll out ride hailing app by March 2027

The bids for developing the app will be floated soon and the contract will be awarded in about two months; an official says that plans are on to make the app as seamless as 'Chennai One'

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Fair fare: Officials say the main objective behind the app is to ensure commuters are not fleeced and to also provide reasonable per ride commission for autorickshaw and cab drivers. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Chennai Unified Metropolitan Transport Authority (CUMTA) will roll out a ride hailing app to help commuters get autorickshaws and cabs at an affordable price by March 2027.

Officials of CUMTA said the main objective behind the app was to ensure commuters were not fleeced and to also provide reasonable per ride commission for autorickshaw and cab drivers. The details of the minimum fare and the commission are still being worked out and will be finalised in a couple of months.

"We are planning to make the app as seamless as the [multi model public transport app] 'Chennai One'," an official said.

The bids for developing the app will be floated by CUMTA shortly and the contract will be awarded in about two months, another official said.

"Then the firm will be granted a time of three months to develop the application and carry out the trials to iron out any glitches. We hope to complete these processes and launch the app in March 2027," he added. The app will be available for both Android and iOS platforms.

Commuters said, amid a growing number of ride hailing apps operated by various private firms, it will be particularly useful to have one of the State government.

R. Boopalan, a resident of Tiruvottiyur who frequently shuttles between Chennai Metro Rail system, buses and cabs for daily commute, said such a move to bring an additional app will be beneficial but the government has to give a reasonable commission to the drivers so that they stop overcharging passengers.

Additional payment

"On several occasions, cab and autorickshaw drivers ask for an additional payment complaining that the ride hailing companies don't give them a fair per ride commission. Invariably, it is the commuter who suffers then as he pays more," he added.

He noted that commuters struggle to find cabs and autorickshaws particularly during monsoon. "Most of us pay sky high fares for rides whenever it rains. In such situations, it will be helpful to have an app with reasonable fares. But the government must also have a good grievance redressal mechanism to ensure commuters using this app don't face this issue," he added.

Police book over 2,900 cases for defective and missing number plates

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

Stern action: A two-wheeler without a number plate that was seized by the police.

The Greater Chennai Traffic Police (GCTP) have booked 2,945 cases against motorists found driving vehicles without number plates or with defective and improper number plates during a special drive held from October 3 to 5.

Additional Commissioner of Police (Traffic) B. Shamoondeswari told *The Hindu* that over 2,900 vehicles were identified during the drive for either not displaying number plates or having improper ones. "A total of 918 vehicles were detained as the number plates were found to be improper or seemed suspicious. Such vehicles are being verified through the crime wing to check whether they are involved in any offences or have been reported stolen elsewhere. In some cases, vehicle users were allowed to produce the required documents or fix the number plates in accordance with the traffic rules," she said.

The special drive will continue, and motorists have been advised to comply with traffic rules, Ms. Shamoondeswari added.

31 held for bike stunts

Meanwhile, the GCTP arrested 31 persons for speeding, reckless driving, and performing stunts while riding two-wheelers on city roads. In the early hours of Sunday, the youths performed bike stunts in Nungambakkam, Valluvar Kottam, Anna Salai, and Sardar Patel Road, endangering the lives of other motorists and the public. Cases were registered at the Traffic Investigation Wings and Law and Order police stations.

Following the investigation, 31 persons were arrested, and 20 two-wheelers were seized.

Ms. Shamoondeswari said the traffic police, in coordination with the law and order police, were continuing intensified surveillance and enforcement against dangerous riding and bike stunts on public roads.

'Students involved'

"Special teams have been formed to trace those involved in bike stunts, and action is being taken continuously. In many cases, school students were found to be involved. We are also booking cases against their parents for allowing their children to use two-wheelers, besides seizing the vehicles," she said.

The Greater Chennai Police has warned that strict legal action would be taken against those who perform stunts, including wheeling, in a manner that endangers public safety or causes damage to public property.

Special teams formed after gang hacks youth to death in Mylapore

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Mylapore police are on the lookout for a three-member gang that hacked to death a youth from Velachery on Veerabadran Street in Mylapore on Monday night.

The deceased was identified as Sathyaseelan, 21, of Balaji Nagar. He worked as an air-conditioner mechanic and had lived in Mylapore for three years. The police said Sathyaseelan had a history of substance abuse, and his family had arranged treatment for him at a de-addiction centre. The family had also moved from Mylapore to Velachery.

Sathyaseelan frequently visited his friend Sabari in Mylapore. When his friends and him were on Veerabadran Street on Monday night, three unidentified men arrived on motorcycles and allegedly attacked Sathyaseelan with knives, leaving him critically injured.

The assailants then fled the spot and Sathyaseelan was rushed to the Government Royapettah Hospital, where he died of injuries.

Special teams have been formed to nab the gang. The police are also investigating the motive behind the murder.

Traffic diversions announced

CHENNAI: Traffic diversions will be in force at the TTK Road-Sriram Nagar North junction for three months from October 8 in connection with Chennai Metro Rail's tunnel work.

Vehicles proceeding on TTK Road from Adyar Gate Hotel and Abhiramapuram 4th Street toward Sriram Nagar North Street, will not be allowed to pass through the junction.

Motorists will have to use the TTK Road 1st Cross Street to reach Sriram Nagar North Street.

Similarly, vehicles coming from Sriram Nagar North Street towards TTK Road will be diverted through North Street and TTK Road 1st Cross Street.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur-721301 invites e-Tender for the following works before 15:00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15:30hrs. : **Tender No. : E/KGP/GS/08/2026**; **Description of work :** Augmentation and Up-gradation of Wagon maintenance facilities in Wagon Repair Shop, Kharagpur; **Tender Value :** ₹ 14,93,32,855.79; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 29,86,700.00; **Tender Document Cost :** ₹ 0.00; **Completion period of the work :** 12 Months; **Date of opening :** 23.10.2026; **Bidding Start Date:** from 09.10.2026 and up to 15:00 hrs. on 23.10.2026; Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/descriptions/specifications of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted. **N.B.**: Prospective bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-859)**

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Chief Engineer (CON)/HQ/Garden Reach - 700043, S. E. Railway invites e-Tender for the following works. Following tender has been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in.** The tender will be closed at 12:00 hrs. on due date : **Pre Bid Meeting : Date:** 16.10.2026, **Time:** 12:00 hrs.; **Venue:** Office of the Chief Administrative Officer (Con), 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043; **e-Tender Notice No. : 4659-GRC-CE-C-HQ-33-2026**; **Brief Description of Works :** Request for Proposal (RFP) for providing Project General Management Services for various projects under the jurisdiction Chief Administrative Officer of Construction South Eastern Railway; **Approx. Cost:** ₹ 347.09 Crore; **Bid Security:** ₹ 6,94,17,400.00; **Period of Completion:** 60 months; **Closing Date :** 12:00 hrs. (IST) on 27.11.2026; Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **NB:** "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders." **(PR-858)**

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice, Civil Engineering, Kota Division
No. - W. 623/15, Date - 29.09.2026

Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination), West Central Railway, Kota for and on behalf of President of Union of India invites following open E. tenders.

Sr. No. 1 **Tender No. :** 177-2026, **Description of work :** Extension of Stripping Shop at WRS/Kota, **Approx. Cost :** 51445091.28, **Earnest Money :** 1028900.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 16.10.2026

Sr. No. 2 **Tender No. :** 178-2026, **Description of work :** DEN/South Kota & DEN/East Kota Jurisdiction - Supply, installation and commissioning of track based Rail Gauge Face Lubricator (Electronic type) (with AMC of 5 years) - 49 Nos., **Approx. Cost :** 83421103.20, **Earnest Money :** 567100.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 23.10.2026

Sr. No. 3 **Tender No. :** 179-2026, **Description of work :** KOTA (DRM) - Provision of New Dining Hall & Kitchen, toilet in Room no-3&4, visitor Room near ICU Store Room and Physiotherapy room, **Approx. Cost :**14562463.73, **Earnest Money :** 291300.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 16.10.2026

Sr. No. 4 **Tender No. :** 180-2026, **Description of work :**Ramganj Mandi-Bhopal Section: Hiring of manpower for track maintenance activities., **Approx. Cost :**5043168.98, **Earnest Money :** 100900.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 16.10.2026

Sr. No. 5 **Tender No. :** 181-2026, **Description of work :** KOTA-COR Section-provision of basic amenities in staff qtrs. at THEA, KTIA, BUDI, SNAR, JNRI and URML station., **Approx. Cost :** 8701942.35, **Earnest Money :** 174000.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 16.10.2026

Sr. No. 6 **Tender No. :** 184-2026, **Description of work :** KOTA-MATHURA & KOTA-CHITTORGARH Section Supply, installation and commissioning of track based Rail Gauge Face Lubricator (Electronic type) (with AMC of 5 years) 67 Nos., **Approx. Cost :** 113963784.00, **Earnest Money :** 719800.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 23.10.2026

Sr. No. 7 **Tender No. :** 185-2026, **Description of work :** Construction of New store rooms along with improvement of existing TRD depot buildings in Kota-RTA, **Approx. Cost :** 6904185.19, **Earnest Money :** 138100.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 16.10.2026

Sr. No. 8 **Tender No. :** 186-2026 R, **Description of work :** A. Sr.DEN/S Section - Provision of various siding facilities including Pit Line for TTM/RGM sidings at different stations. B. Provision of Derailing switches to enable stabling on long haul loop at THUR station., **Approx. Cost :** 12999340.51, **Earnest Money :** 260000.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 16.10.2026

Sr. No. 9 **Tender No. :** 187-2026 R, **Description of work :** Provision of RCC OH tank cap. 225000 lts in replacement of RCC OH tank at filter no.1 of Kota, **Approx. Cost :** 10191065.87, **Earnest Money :** 203800.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 23.10.2026

Sr. No. 10 **Tender No. :** 188-2026, **Description of work :** Kota NAD section-Replacement of old/dilapidated Type-II Qtrs. (8 Units) in ADEN SGZ and ADEN/RMA section KOTA-NAD Section - Provision of New Type-III Quarter 04 units at SGZ=1, BWM=1, MKX=1, JHW=1 under ADEN/RMA and ADEN/SGZ, **Approx. Cost :** 29895554.27, **Earnest Money :** 597900.00, **Last date & Time of submission of tender :** (15.30) Hrs. On dt. 16.10.2026

Complete details are available in the E- tender notice uploaded on the railway web site www.ireps.gov.in and also placed on the notice board of the Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination), DRM Office, West Central Railway Kota's office **(Sd.)**

Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination)
West Central Railway, Kota

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

TAMIL NADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION
Poonamalee High Road, Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) Admin Building, Koyambedu, Chennai-600 107. Ph.No. (044) 26426773
Email id . : tncsc.tn@nic.in | CIN:U15137TN1972SGC006157

SHORT E- TENDER CUM REVERSE E- AUCTION / REVERSE BIDDING

RC.No.BS6/023654/2026 **Date: 06.10.2026**

Short E-Tender Cum Reverse E-Auction / Reverse Bidding
Rc. No. BS6/023654/2026- TNCSC/26-27

Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation invites online short electronic tender cum electronic reverse auction / reverse bidding for the Purchase of **"60,000 Metric Tonnes of Tur dal (Split-Husked & Fatka) [Indigenous]/Tur Dal (Split Husked-Imported)/ Lentil locally known as Canadian Yellow Lentil (Split – Husked & Laired No.2) / Lentil locally known as Canadian Yellow Lentil (Whole-Husked & Laired No.2) for three months of November 2026, December 2026 and January 2027 as per AGMARK specifications"**

Complete short e-tender cum reverse e-auction / reverse bidding document can be viewed and downloaded from **https:tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**

The bidders have to participate only through online bidding with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-II or Class-III. Last Date and Time for Online Submission: **23.10.2026 up to 11.00 A.M.**

DIPR / **3039** / Tender / 2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

CHENNAI METRO RAIL LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Tamil Nadu)
(ISO 9001:2015 AND ISO 14001:2015 CERTIFIED)
METROS, ANNA SALAI, NANDANAM, CHENNAI - 600 035

E-Tender Notice

National Competitive Bidding (NCB)

CMRL invites tenders through the GeM Portal (https://gem.gov.in/) from reputed, experienced, financially sound, eligible firms who fulfil the qualification criteria as mentioned in the tender document through National Competitive Bidding under Single Stage Two Envelope (Technical & Financial) system for the work mentioned below:

Tender No: CMRL / O&M / CIVIL MAINTENANCE / Plumbing / FMS -02/2026 "Facility Management Services (FMS) for Plumbing systems at Stations of Phase-I & Phase-I Extension of CMRL, including Koyambedu Depot, Wimco Nagar Depot, Administrative Buildings and staff quarters at Koyambedu & MetroS"

i) **Tender document available from: 07/10/2026**
ii) **Deadline for Bid Submission: 05/11/2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.**

For further details, please visit: www.chennaimetrorail.org & (https://gem.gov.in/)

Any Corrigendum/Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above-mentioned GeM Portal and will not be published in newspapers.

For Managing Director
Director (System and Operations)
Chennai Metro Rail Limited

DIPR / 3032 / Tender / 2026

TRIBAL COOPERATIVE MARKETING DEVELOPMENT FEDERATION OF INDIA LTD.(TRIFED)
(Under Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Government of India)
NSIC Business Park, NSIC Estate,
Okhla Phase - III, Okhla Industrial Area,
New Delhi -110020

Advertisement No: 04/2026

Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India (TRIFED), under the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Government of India, invites applications from retired personnel of Central/State Government Ministries/Departments, Autonomous Bodies, Statutory Bodies, and Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) for engagement as Consultants on a contractual basis.

Applications are invited for two (02) Consultant positions, one each in the fields of Marketing and Minor Forest Produce (MFP) & VDVK.

The last date for receipt of applications is 15.10.2026.

For eligibility & details, please visit TRIFED's website ***https://trifed.tribal.gov.in*** *under opportunities - careers section*

Place: New Delhi

Preeti Maithil
GM (Pers.)
CBC 43104/11/0003/2627

डॉ. आचंट लक्ष्मीपति क्षेत्रीय आयुर्वेद अनुसंधान संस्थान
Dr.Achanta Lakshmipathi Regional Ayurveda Research Institute
केन्द्रीय आयुर्वेदीय विज्ञान अनुसंधान परिषद्, आयुष मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार
Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS)
Ministry of AYUSH, Govt. of India
V.H.S Hospital Campus, Taramani, Chennai – 600 113
E-mail: alrari.chennai@gmail.com, alrca.chennai@gmail.com Tel. Ph: 044-29508035

क्र.सं. 2/4/2026/ALRARI/Rect. दिनांक:

वॉक-इन-साक्षात्कार / Walk-In-Interview

योग चिकित्सक - 01 पद के लिए वॉक-इन-साक्षात्कार संस्थान के **SAMYOGA** परियोजना के लिए अनुबंध/सह-टर्मिनस आधार पर **17.10.2026** को उपर्युक्त पते पर आयोजित किया जाएगा। आवेदन पत्र और अन्य विवरण सीसीआरएएस वेबसाइट **www.ccras.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध हैं।

Walk-In-Interview for the post of **Yoga Therapist - 01** on contractual/ co-terminus basis for **SAMYOGA** project of this institute will be conducted on **17.10.2026** at the above-mentioned address. The application form and other details are available at CCRAS Website **www.ccras.nic.in**

Sd/-
प्रभारी सहायक निदेशक

தொழிலாளர் அரசு காப்பீட்டுக் கழகம்
(தொழிலாளர் மற்றும் வேலை வாய்ப்புத்துறை அமைச்சகம், இந்திய அரசு)
கர்மசாரி ராஜ்ய பீமா நிகம்
(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
EMPLOYEES' STATE INSURANCE CORPORATION
(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt of India)

தொ.அ.கா.ம. மருத்துவக்கல்லூரி மற்றும் மருத்துவமனை,
தொ.அ.கா.கழகம், கே.கே.நகர், சென்னை-78
(ஐ.எஸ்.ஓ 9001:2015 சான்றளிக்கப்பட்டது)/
க.ரா.வி.நி. चिकित्सा कॉलेज और अस्पताल,
कर्मचारी राज्य बीमा निगम, के. के. नगर, चेन्नई-78, (आई. एस. ओ. 9001-2015 प्रमाणित)
E.S.I.C. MEDICAL COLLEGE AND HOSPITAL, E.S.I. CORPORATION,
K.K. NAGAR, CHENNAI-78 (ISO 9001-2015 Certified)
M.S: 044-24893714, **Fax:** 044-24891094
Email: ms-ddochennai@esic.nic.in, deanmc-kkn.tn@esic.nic.in
Website: www.esic.gov.in, www.esichospitals.gov.in

க.ரா.வி.நி
E.S.I.C

PUBLIC NOTICE

As per Headquarters policy no; **U-16/30/232/2013-Pro.Cell(SST)/Pro.cell(SST)/Maha/Wup dated 09-05-2019,** the following medical records maintained at **ESIC Medical College & Hospital, KK Nagar, Chennai - 78** are scheduled for discarding:

- Inpatient medical record case sheets up to December 2022
- OPD registers
- Admission and discharge registers

Stakeholders, patients, their legal representatives, or any concerned authority who require information or copies of these records may contact the **Office of the Medical Superintendent, ESIC Medical College & Hospital, KK Nagar, Chennai - 78.**

within 30 days from the date of this publication. In case no representation is received within the aforementioned 30-day period, the above-mentioned records will be destroyed as per policy. No correspondence regarding this matter will be entertained after the said period.

By Order of the Dean
ESIC Medical College & Hospital KK Nagar, Chennai - 78

CANTONMENT BOARD
St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram,
Ministry of Defence, Government of India, Chennai-16.

CANCELLATION OF PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the General Public that the Public Notice issued vide No.STM/Works/1/2107, dated 02.10.2026, regarding invitation of objections/suggestions from the General Public on the Draft St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram Cantonment Building Bye-laws, 2026, and published in The Hindu Daily – English and The Hindu Daily – Tamil Newspapers on **05.10.2026,** is **hereby withdrawn and cancelled** with immediate effect due to administrative reasons.

Accordingly, the General Public is requested to treat the aforesaid Public Notice as cancelled. No action is required to be taken in pursuance of the said notice.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
Office of the Cantonment Board
St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram, Chennai-16.

No.STM/Works/1/2124
Dated: 06-10-2026.

கண்டோன்மெண்ட் வாரியம்
பரங்கிமலை மற்றும் பல்லாவரம்
Ministry of Defence, Government of India, Chennai-16.

பொது அறிவிப்பு ரத்து செய்யப்படுதல்

பொது அறிவிப்பின் மூலம், **02.10.2026** தேதியிட்ட அலுவலக பொது அறிவிப்பு எண். STM/Works/1/2107-ன் வாயிலாக, செயின்ட் தாமஸ் மவுண்ட் மற்றும் பல்லாவரம் கண்டோன்மெண்ட் கட்டிட விதிமுறைகள், 2026-ன் வரைவு தொடர்பாக பொதுமக்களிடமிருந்து ஆட்சேபனைகள் / ஆலோசனைகள் கோரப்பட்டு, மேற்கண்ட பொது அறிவிப்பு **05.10.2026** அன்று The Hindu Daily-ஆங்கிலம் மற்றும் The Hindu Daily-தமிழ் நாளிதழ்களில் வெளியிடப்பட்டது.

நிர்வாக காரணங்களுக்காக, மேற்கண்ட பொது அறிவிப்பு உடனடி அமலுக்கு வரும் வகையில் திரும்பப் பெறப்பட்டு, ரத்து செய்யப்படுகிறது என பொதுமக்களுக்கு இதன் மூலம் தெரிவிக்கப்படுகிறது.

அதன்படி, மேற்கண்ட பொது அறிவிப்பு ரத்து செய்யப்பட்டதாக கருதி, அதன் அடிப்படையில் பொதுமக்கள் எந்தவித நடவடிக்கையும் மேற்கொள்ளத் தேவையில்லை என இதன் மூலம் கேட்டுக்கொள்ளப்படுகிறது.

Sd/-
தலைமை நிர்வாக அதிகாரி
கன்டோன்மெண்ட் வாரியம்
பரங்கிமலை மற்றும் பல்லாவரம்

No.STM/Works/1/2124
Dated: 06-10-2026.

Incomplete civic works hit monsoon readiness in some areas

Deputy Mayor says alternative monsoon preparedness measures have been proposed in many areas, such as Besant Road, Ganesapuram, Perungudi, and Sholinganallur. Corporation Commissioner G.S. Sameeran says all culverts across 44 canals have been desilted, and end-to-end desilting has been completed in major waterways such as the Kodungaiyur, Padikuppam, and Trust Puram canals

Taking stock: Greater Chennai Corporation officials inspecting the Otteri Nullah at Thirumangalam in Anna Nagar zone on Tuesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

CITY MATTERS

Aloysius Xavier Lopez
CHENNAI

A number of neighbourhoods in the city are not prepared for the onset of the Northeast monsoon owing to incomplete civic infrastructure projects.

At a meeting with Mayor R. Priya on Tuesday, officials pointed to incomplete projects in areas such as Korattur, Ganesapuram, Saidapet, Parangusapuram, and neighbourhoods along Anna Salai and Arcot Road. Deputy Mayor Mu. Magesh Kumaar said alternative arrangements had been proposed in many areas, such as Besant Road, P.S. Sivasamy Salai, Saidapet Govindan Road, Ganesapuram, Perungudi, and Sholinganallur, because of the incomplete infrastructure projects.

Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said: "The cut-and-cover drain work from East Avenue to Padi is in full swing. The GCC plans to have a dedicated drain from East Avenue and from Kiran Palace to Imayam Colony for a total length of 2.5 km. As of now, 2.1 km work has been completed. Efforts are on to complete the remaining 400 metres on CTH Road in another 15 days."

In the event of a delay in completion of the project by October 15, the GCC plans to deploy additional heavy duty pumps to bail out water during the rain. "Two 100-HP pumps will be set up at the junction of Korattur signal and East Avenue Road. These will send the rainwater to the Lucas TVS front gate, where a highway drain is available. From there, the water will be sent to the new drain near Park Road, from where it will reach the zero point of Otteri Nullah," Dr. Sameeran said.

As residents have also complained about National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) delaying the removal of debris from the Cooum, the GCC has persuaded the authority to expedite work. "We have instructed the NHAI to remove all debris and temporary structures from the Cooum by October 15. Currently, they have removed nearly 70%," the GCC Commissioner said.

"Regarding the ongoing Metro Rail work, a technical committee, comprising Chief Engineers of Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) and officials of the GCC and Highways and Water Resources Departments, has been formed, and its members jointly visited all the work sites of CMRL and suggested mitigation measures. The GCC and CMRL have made arrangements accordingly," he said.

Work was carried out at 60 sites of CMRL as part of monsoon preparedness across the city.

"All culverts across 44 canals have been desilted using six robotic excavators, five float excavators, three amphibious excavators, 40 skid steer loaders. End-to-end desilting has been completed in major canals such as the Kodungaiyur, Padikuppam, and Trustpuram canals. Over 85% of the Otteri Nullah has been desilted. Over 80% of the work on Virugambakkam Canal has been completed. The rest of the work is under way," Dr. Sameeran added.

Hospital develops minimally invasive procedure to treat children with congenital heart diseases

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

For children born with complex heart defects in which only one ventricle can support circulation, the Fontan procedure is the final stage of treatment for many, redirecting blood retuning from the lower half of the body directly to the lungs, so that the single functioning ventricle can pump oxygen-rich blood into the body.

Traditionally, children with single-ventricle heart disease have had to undergo many major heart operations before the Fontan stage. Now, however, Apollo's paediatric cardiology and paediatric cardiothoracic surgery teams have developed and refined a technique that enables the Fontan pathway to be completed using catheters, wires, and stents through blood vessels, said C.S. Muthukumaran, senior consultant and head, department of paediatric cardiology, Apollo Children's Hospital, at a press meet held on Tuesday.

C.S. Muthukumaran, senior consultant and head, department of paediatric cardiology, Apollo Children's Hospital, and his team along with children who underwent Fontan procedure. M. SRINATH

This percutaneous procedure, first performed by the hospital in 2023 and the work published, is not suitable for every child; it requires careful selection and assessment of patients, but in those found suitable, it offers the advantages of the procedure being done under local anaesthesia, no ICU stay, and a quicker return home, Dr. Muthukumaran said.

50 procedures done

Dr. Muthukumaran added that 50 Fontan pathway procedures had been performed. Neville A.G. Solomon, director, paediatric cardiothoracic services at the hospital, said this milestone gave hope to children and their families. Ilankumaran Kaliamoorthy, CEO, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai Region and Sushila Narayanasamy, unit head, Apollo Women and Children's Hospitals, Chennai, also participated.

4 persons held for murder in Tiruttani

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tiruttani police have arrested four persons, including a 17-year-old boy, in connection with the murder of a 41-year-old petty shop owner in Tiruttani.

D. Yuvaraj was hacked to death by a masked gang near Periyar Nagar on Sunday. The arrested were identified as Sushil, 24, Bhuvanesh, 21, and Harish, 19. The police said Sushil had several cases, including for robbery and attempt to murder, against him. The police said the juvenile allegedly had one-sided feelings for Yuvaraj's daughter. The police suspect the attack may have happened in retaliation to a complaint Yuvaraj had lodged after his daughter was allegedly threatened by Sushil and his friends over her friendship with a 19-year-old college student from Palvedu. Based on the complaint, the police arrested Sushil's friends Lawrence and Roshi.

Timings
CHENNAI

WEDNESDAY, OCT. 07	
RISE	05:59 SET 17:55
RISE	02:52 SET 15:37
THURSDAY, OCT. 08	
RISE	05:59 SET 17:55
RISE	03:46 SET 16:17
FRIDAY, OCT. 09	
RISE	05:59 SET 17:54
RISE	04:37 SET 16:55

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	35	22
Chennai Airport	35	25
Chennai City	35	26

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be mostly dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night also will be uneasy.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable.

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CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

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Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
East Mada Street, Mylapore,
Chennai-600 004

SOOPER PRESENT

"**Multi-Lingual Theatre Festival**" from **October 5** to **10, 2026 daily at 6.30 P.M. Today:** 7th Oct: **Hindi "Ladies Compartment"** by Being Theatre. **Tomorrow**: 8th Oct: **Kannada "Ushaharana"** by Mysore Natana. High Tea at 6.00 pm.
All are Welcome.

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Naada Inbam, 24992672
Prof. Dilip Veeraraghavan Birthday Concert. R S Shankari, R Srikritii, Thillaistanam Suriyanarayanan. Today 6.15 pm at Ragasudha Hall.

Narada Gana Sabha Trust
Ph: 24993201
Today Mini Hall (Swami Haridhos Giri Hall) - Nadasangamam Concert - 5.30 pm - K Giridharan, G.Kailasapathy, Jayendrakumar, 7 pm - Hari Kishan, Sivateja Mallajosyula, Kaushik Sridhar. All are welcome.

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PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME

I, ABHILASH RAJENDRAN PILLAI Residing at Door No.B3, Nahar Skanda Apartments, New No.2, Subramaniam Avenue, Thiruvanmiyur, Chennai – 600041. shall henceforth be known as ABHILASH RAJENDRAN, vide affidavit dated 03.10.2026 at Chennai.

I , Sankar S/o Subramani, born on 15/10/1958, residing at P No. 2, Mahalakshmi Enclave, A1, 1st floor, Ethiraj Street, Rajaji Nagar, Zamin Pallavaram, Chennai 600043 have changed my name to Sankaran Subramani vide Affidavit dated 01.10.2026 at Chennai 600044.

I, KARTHIK Sankar s/o K. S. Sankaran, born on 20/04/1992, residing at No. 4/7, Raja Royal Towers, T1, 3rd Floor, Ranganathan street, Essa Pallavaram, Chennai 600043 have changed my name to Karthik Sankaran vide Affidavit dated 01.10.2026 at Chennai 600044.

I, THULASI Bai. P, w/o Purushothaman K, aged 55 years, residing at No 87, Dwaraka Flats, M, Ponnanginaru Street, Villivakam, Chennai – 49, have changed my name to Thulasi Devi. P vide affidavit dated, 20/08/2026 before notary H. Madhavan, Chennai.

I, DHANUSUYA S , D/o Sivalingam, DOB: 16.09.2003, R/o. No.4, 2nd St., Annai Sathya Nagar, Jafferkhanpet, Chennai-83 shall henceforth be known as DHANUSHIYA S for all purposes.

I, Ramaswamy Vasudevan Suganya, residing at 17/9 Sahana Apartment, Flat 1, 2nd Main Road R. A. Puram, shall henceforth be known as Suganya Vasudevan

PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME

I, Giju John, S/o. O S John, R/o. Plot 12, Door 18 Senthur Street, Arulmurugan Nagar, Keelkattalai, Chennai-600117, declare that my name is incorrectly recorded in my Passport (F9491422) as Ottaplavunilkkunnathil Gijujohn. My correct & actual name is Giju John, vide notorized affidavit FD 063864 dated 08-08-2026 at Chennai.

I, VENKATESH A, Son of Thiru N. ANNAVU, born on 8th November 1996, R/o. at Plot No. 23, Majestic Colony Main Road, Valasaravakkam, Chennai - 600087, shall henceforth be known as A VENKATESH.

I, Shiby Nair, wife of Devaraj Rajendran, aged 37 years, residing at D1704, Pride Towers, Pacifica Aurum, Padur, Chennai – 603103, have changed my name from Shiby Nair to Shiby P Nair and shall henceforth be known as Shiby P Nair. Both names refer to one and the same person. – Shiby P Nair

I, AANSHU PARMAAR VIKRAM D/o. Vikram Kumar Ambalal, DOB: 08.06.2002, Residing at Flat No. 1502, M Block, 15th floor, KLP Abinandan Apartment, No.1, Perambur Barracks Road, Pattalam, Chennai - 600012. Henceforth be known as AANSHU VIKRAM PARMAAR

My daughter, Aarishka.J, born on 24th October 2018 (District of Birth: Chennai), residing at C72,B1, First Floor, Aaji Encalve, Park Avenue road,Thiruvengada Nagar, Ambattur O.T, Chennai-53 shall henceforth be known as TARA.J - Lakshmi Priya U (Mother)

PERSONAL
LOST & FOUND

I, GOKUL S (alias Gokul Selvaraj), lost my original certificates during house shifting: 10th Marksheet (Reg: 884788), 12th Marksheet (Reg: 651237), B.Tech IT 2012 Degree & Consolidated Marksheet (Reg: AC08UIT029, Adhiyamaan College/Anna Univ), and Master's Degree (Reg: 10551994, Dublin Business School). Finder kindly contact: +91 72999 29092. Address: M101, Casagrand Castle, Manapakkam, Chennai – 600125.

I, DHANVANTH D P U, S/o Uma Magesh and Vaishnavi, have lost my original 10th Standard Marksheet and pass certificate (Year of Examination: 2024) issued by Vaels International School. Index Number: 1244222/041, UID Number: 8394302. It was lost on 3-5-2026 in or around vettuvankeni bus stand. If found, please contact: 7810032962 or return to 77, 2nd avenue, 3rd cross street, vettuvankeni, Chennai.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

MR. HIMANSHU Dugar, plans to surrender his SEBI registration as a Research Analyst with registration number INH200009944 and BSE RA Enlistment Number 5593. If anyone has any grievances, they can lodge the grievances at scores.sebi.gov.in

REAL ESTATE

T.NAGAR 2000SF UDS 1100 Posh 3BHK Flat Lift CP Genst 3.30Cr 9962312504

SITUATION VACANT
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REQ 50+ M/F 15+Yrs Exp Deg Must for Reputed Banking Sector. 8015314663

VRS /RETD /House Wives RPD Channel – Immediate Requirement Salary + INCENTIVE + Promotion Ct: 86673 82657

MARKETING

STAFF WANTED– APPAREL Industry–Chennail. Need Smart Salesman + Excel Master + Ready to Travel. Location: Shenoy Nagar, Chennai. Package: Rs.5 Lakhs per annum. Ct: 9600193328

TECHNICAL

REQUIRES IMMEDIATE: Civil Engineers with 5+yrs Experienced @ Chennai Salary:Based on Experience &Skills RMT Constructions. Send CV to: rmtconstructions4545@gmail.com Contact: 9962271755/ 9841124620

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that our clients are in the process of purchasing the below-referred rights for multiple telecasts of the below-referred films (Films), for the period detailed in the schedule hereinbelow.

To the best of our knowledge and belief, the Film is free from any encumbrances, claims or demands, whatsoever. However, should any person(s) have claim against, to, or in respect of the Film, whether by way of any sale, lease, assignment, license, pledge, gift, mortgage, charge, sale, litigation, and/or transfer of any kind whatsoever or otherwise, such person(s) are hereby required to make the same known in writing along with documentary proof/evidence (certified true copies) of the aforesaid claim to the undersigned at the address given below, within 7 (seven) days from the date of publication hereof, failing which the transaction will be completed without reference to such claims and the claims, if any, will be deemed to have been waived. Claims without any documentary proof and /or any claims received after the expiry of the stipulated 7 (seven) days shall not be entertained.

SCHEDULE

Title of the Film	:	Gatta Kusthi 2nd Round
Language(s)	:	Tamil original and its dialects & Telugu (dubbed)
Star Cast	:	Vishnu Vishal, Aishwarya Lekshmi and others
Director	:	Chella Ayyavu
Effective Date	:	85 (eighty-five) days from Theatrical Release Date **("Pay TV Start Date")** 6 (six) months from Theatrical Release Date **("Free TV Start Date")**
End Date	:	Perpetual
Territory	:	Entire World (Exclusive for India territories and non-exclusive for rest of the world)
Runs	:	Unlimited
Rights	:	Shall mean the Linear (i)Satellite Broadcasting rights; (ii) Cable TV Rights; (iii)Terrestrial Rights; (iv) Doordarshan Rights; (v) DTH Rights; (vi) IPTV Rights; (vii)Simulcast Rights; (viii)Subtitling Rights in English, Tamil and Telugu; (ix) Digital Terrestrial Television("DTT") (x)Syndication Rights in India;(xi) Ancillary Rights;(xii) Clip Rights; (xiii) Catch up TV Rights ;(xiv) Direct - to - Mobile Rights and (xv) New Exploitation Rights & Methods.

Dated : 7th October 2026
Place : Chennai
Sd/-
Nanavati & Co Advocates
1206-1208, 12th Floor, Elite Business Park, In the lane of Shapath Hexa rights, Next to Prajapati Bhavan, Near Kargil Petrol Pump, Sola, Ahmedabad, Gujarat- 380 060.

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin 603209. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

INBRIEF

TVK not keeping its poll promises, says Kanimozhi

The Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), which made a slew of promises ahead of the Assembly elections, is in no mood to fulfil them, and this has triggered agitations across the State, Member of Parliament K. Kanimozhi said. After reviewing the work on the construction of a flyover at Keezha Eral on Thoothukudi-Madurai Highway, she said that those who protest against the State government should remind themselves of the ruling party's poll promises. Farmers, nurses, and other sections of society, who agitate demanding the execution of the poll promises, were being arrested and cases filed against them, she said. Even though the names of TVK office-bearers figured in the crimes against women, action had not been taken against them.

Teacher arrested for sexually harassing 13-year-old boy

The Colachel All Women Police have arrested a teacher on charges of sexually harassing a 13-year-old boy. The police said the teacher, Vedhakkann, 52, of Paalapallam sexually harassed the boy when he was taking a bible class that was being held by a church. When the boy was asked why he did not go to school the next day, he told his parents about the sexual harassment. After the boy's father lodged a complaint, Colachel All Women Police arrested Vedhakkann on Tuesday under the POCSO (Protection of Children against Sexual Offences) Act.

Actor-activist Prakash Raj contended that the SIR had removed over 13 crore people from the electoral rolls. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Attempts being made to divide the country into two: Prakash Raj

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

There were attempts to divide the country into two -- those with voting rights and those without them, actor-activist Prakash Raj said in Chennai on Tuesday. He appealed to the people of Tamil Nadu to come to the streets and protest against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls, which was undertaken by the Election Commission of India (ECI).

Addressing a press conference, Mr. Prakash Raj flagged several issues through which he contended that the SIR had removed over 13 crore people from the electoral rolls across the country. Those whose voting rights were taken away included Adivasis, daily wage labourers, Scheduled Castes, Muslims, Christians, and other minorities, among others, he contended.

"Once such a 'clean up' process is undertaken, think about who will be voters and what will be their mindset. In the eventual elections, every political party will speak appealing only to that mindset".

He also pointed out how the BJP government brought in two legislations to amend the way in which the Chief Election Commissioner was chosen.

Former High Court judge D. Hariparanthaman said it was *The Indian Express* journalist Ritika Chopra who brought to light that two Election Commissioners objected 14 times in 10 months on record to steps being undertaken by the ECI. Political commentator V. Ponraj referred to a report of *The Hindu Businessline* and further contended that the "electoral rolls have been weaponised".

Activist Radhika Ganesh charged that the BJP was "using SIR as a tool to weaken those who have been opposed to its principles and ideology". Journalist K. Ayyanathan emphasised on the need to scrap the use of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) and bring back paper ballots. State Coordinator of All India People's Mission Thomas Franco also spoke.

T.N. sees hottest Southwest monsoon in the last 9 years

A Regional Meteorological Centre analysis finds that the State registered a mean temperature of 29.45°C between June and September this year, which is nearly 1.21°C above the 2018-25 average

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu experienced unusually warm weather during the Southwest monsoon this year, with temperatures remaining elevated for a sustained period, according to an analysis by the Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC).

The State recorded its highest temperatures during the season compared to the 2018-25 period. This assumes significance particularly against the backdrop of 2023, 2024, and 2025 being the three warmest years on record globally.

According to the Regional Weather Forecasting Centre (RWFC), RMC, the State registered a mean temperature of 29.45°C during the season (between June and September) this year, which is nearly 1.21°C above the 2018-25 average.

Both maximum and minimum temperatures remained above the 2018-25 average, with the strongest warming signal observed between July and September. The maximum mean temperature was 34.25°C, with an anomaly of 1.40°C compared to the 2018-25 average. The mean minimum temperature was 24.64°C (+1.02°C).

V.R. Durai, Head, RWFC, said it was not just isolated hot days in different locations, but elevated temperatures persisted over the months. This season's mean temperature was 0.72°C higher than the previous highest temperature recorded in 2023. "We found that Tamil Nadu recorded a marked rise in mean temperature this season compared with each of the previous years," he said.

The warming trend strengthened from July this year, after widespread rainfall in June helped keep temperatures under control. This year's July, August, and September were the warmest months compared to corresponding months in the 2018-25 period.

Vellore, Puducherry, Palayamkottai, and Meenambakkam in Chennai, Kodaikanal, and Tiruttani were among the weather stations that recorded above normal mean temperatures during the Southwest monsoon. The weather station-wise assessment also showed that the warming weather trend was widespread across the State.

Citing the three warmest years globally, Mr. Durai said the trend pointed to an overall warming of weather conditions with every passing year. The spike in temperatures had intensified since 2020. While global warming was a major factor behind the soaring mercury level in the State during the Southwest monsoon, a strong El Niño this year also contributed to the increasing warm trend.

Weather station-wise assessment also showed that the warming weather trend was widespread across the State

Monsoon heat

The table shows the average temperature recorded in Tamil Nadu during the Southwest monsoon between 2018 and 2026

Year	Mean max (°C)	Mean min (°C)	Mean temp (°C)
2018	32.81	23.73	28.27
2019	33.14	23.95	28.54
2020	32.31	23.59	27.95
2021	32.42	23.11	27.77
2022	32.09	23.17	27.63
2023	33.73	23.72	28.73
2024	33.28	23.81	28.54
2025	33.07	23.89	28.48
2026	34.25	24.64	29.45

Medicine covers at CMCH changed after language controversy

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

The Coimbatore Medical College Hospital (CMCH) administration on Tuesday replaced the brown paper covers used to dispense medicines to patients with fresh ones after instructions printed in Hindi on the former triggered a row. Many criticised it as contradicting the two-language policy of Tamil Nadu.

DMK leader and former Minister for Industries T.R.B. Rajaa was among those who criticised the inclusion of Hindi instructions on the covers.

"(It) seems like the three-language policy is being implemented in Tamil Nadu hospitals too! First Karur... Now the same situation in Coimbatore as well", he posted on X, along with a photo of a pharmacy cover purportedly issued by CMCH, with instructions in Tamil, English and Hindi. Earlier, he had posted that similar covers with instructions in three languages were being used in Karur.

A senior official from CMCH said the covers with instructions in three languages were printed and supplied by Chinthamani Cooperative Society and no one had flagged any issue with the instruction in Hindi.

The pharmacy cover purportedly issued at Coimbatore Medical College.

"We replaced these covers with new ones on Tuesday evening," said the official, adding that such covers had been in use for a long time.

A source from the pharmacy section of the hospital claimed that similar covers with instructions in three languages had been in use during the previous regime as well. Meanwhile, pharmacists were instructed not to use the covers with instructions in three languages and use the new ones, containing Tamil and English.

According to CMCH authorities, the hospital handles around 3,000 to 4,500 outpatients a day, and a large number of migrant workers seek treatment at the hospital.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY — SUPPLY OF STORES ITEMS THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT TENDERS

TENDER NOTICE No.: S/2026/40 Date: 05.10.2026

The Principal Chief Material Manager, North Western Railway, headquarter Jaipur, for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-tenders on website as follow- www.ireps.gov.in

S.N	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	Due date
1.	50265231	Relay QNNA1 4F/4B and 6F/2B	4522	28.10.26
2.	37261899A	Bogie centre pivot top for casnub bogies	2081	16.11.26
3	10264499	NICKEL CADMIUM STARTER BATTERIES	100	11.11.26
4	36263393	LOAD CONTROL CARD	15	30.10.26
5	20261616	Metalised Carbon Strips	1005	30.11.26
6	10264006	ELEMENT ENGINE AIR FILTER	1747	22.10.26
7	70262172A	Dust Bin Container	3696	23.10.26

CORRIGENDUM

S.no	Tender No.& Description	Corrigendum in
1	63265010-Manufacturing & supply of high performance Rail clamp RDSO/T-5916	TOD-25.11.26 in lieu of 30.09.26

Note:- Interested tenderers may visit the website ireps.gov.in for Full tender details/description/Specification, quantity & corrigendum if any. 1430-AM/26

Please join us on / NWRailways

Rural Development & Panchayat Raj Department
Government of Tamil Nadu

Notification

Rc. No. 1511/2026/A1 Date:06.10.2026

Invitation of Application for the Post of
Director, Social Audit Society of Tamil Nadu (SASTA)

In accordance with the norms, procedures laid down by Government Order No: (Ms) 94 RD&PR (CGS1) Dept. dated 22.08.22. Application for appointment to the post of Director, SASTA is hereby invited. Application format can be downloaded from website **https://crd-training.in/** The application in prescribed format should be submitted on or before 29.10.2026 with all enclosures and DD for Rs.500/- drawn in favour of 'The Director, State Institute of Rural Development and Panchayat Raj'.

Director,
SIRD&PR, TN

DIPR/ 861 /Display/2026

TAMILNADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION
Head Office : Poonamallee High Road,
CMRL Admin Building, Koyambedu, Chennai - 600107
Ph.No. (044) 26426773 Email ID : tncsc.tn@nic.in
CIN:U15137TN1972SGC006157

SHORT E-TENDER CUM E-REVERSE AUCTION/ REVERSE BIDDING NOTICE

Com1/031692/2026 Date:06.10.2026

Short e-Tender cum e-Reverse auction/ Reverse bidding No. : Com1/031692/2026-TNCSC/26-27

Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation invites short electronic tender cum Electronic Reverse Auction for **"PURCHASE OF 60,000 MTs. of S Grade Type of sugars for the month of October 2026, November 2026 and December 2026 [Season 2025-26 & 2026-2027]".**

Complete e-Tender cum e-Reverse Auction/ Reverse bidding document can be viewed and downloaded from **https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.**

The bidders have to participate online bidding only with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-II or Class-III.

Last Date and time for Online Submission : 23.10.2026 upto 10.30 AM

Managing Director

DIPR/3038/Tender/2026

TAMIL NADU PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
No.3, TNPSC Road, Chennai-600 003.
Advertisement No : 747
Notification No : 11/2026 Dated: 06.10.2026

SHORT NOTICE

TamilNadu Public Service Commission will hold the Examination for appointment by direct recruitment to the posts in **Combined Civil Services Examination - IV (Group IV Services) on 10.01.2027 F.N..**

For information relating to educational qualification, age limit, applicability of rule of reservation, scheme of examination, payment of fee, concessions and other details, prospective candidates are advised to refer to the detailed Notification uploaded in the Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission's website **www.tnpsc.gov.in.**

DIPR / 862 / DISPLAY / 2026 Secretary

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पश्चिमी कोशी नहर प्रमंडल, खजौली
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–03 / 2026–27
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

1. कार्य का विवरण :–

क्रम सं0	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रू0 लाख में)	अग्रधन की राशि (ऑन लाईन अथवा फिजिकल /मैनुअल मोड में भुगतेय) रू0	परिमाण–विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0	बेलट्रॉन को देय "बीड प्रोसेसिंग फी" (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि।
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	पश्चिमी कोशी मुख्य नहर के विभिन्न बिंदुओं पर अवस्थित पुलों के रेलिंग का मरम्मति, सोनी लिंक नहर का पुर्नस्थापन कार्य तथा आउटलेट मरम्मति कार्य।	37.705	75500.00	5000.00	1180.00	2 माह

2 विज्ञापन दाता का नाम : कार्यपालक अभियंता, पश्चिमी कोशी नहर प्रमंडल, खजौली।
3 निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि : दिनांक 30.09.2026
4 निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि : दिनांक 21.10.2026 के 10.00 बजे पूर्वाह्न से दिनांक 29.10.2026 के 03.00 बजे अपराह्न तक। (केवल वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
5 प्री–बीड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि : दिनांक 22.10.2026 को 03 .00 बजे अपराह्न में अधीक्षण अभियंता, पश्चिमी कोशी नहर अंचल, जयनगर के कार्यालय कक्ष में।
6 तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक 31.10.2026 के अपराह्न 03.30 बजे (केवल वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)।
7 वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर घोषित की जायेगी।
8 निविदा खोलने का स्थान : केवल वेबसाईटwww.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
9 निविदा की वैद्यता अवधि : 120 दिन
10 विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु : वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in / www.wrd.bih.nic.in / www.state.bihar.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
पश्चिमी कोशी नहर प्रमंडल, खजौली
मो0 :–7463889762

PR- 013133 (WRD) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

Shri . R. Kannan
(Advocate, Madras High Court)
(Ex. City Govt Pleader)
With profound grief, we inform the passing of our beloved father who attained Sivalokaprapthi on **5th October.** Last rites will be performed on **7th October at 11/1, Josier Street, Nungambakkam, Chennai - 600034.**
Deeply mourned by:
Latha (Wife),
Ashwath Kannan (Son),
Akshaya (daughter),
Grandchildren, Relatives, and Friends
Ph: 6374496451

DEATH

OBITUARY

T.D. JAYARAMAN IYER
Retd. General Manager, Cholan Roadways Corp. Ltd.,
S/o. Late. V. Dandapani Iyer, Pillayar Koil Street, Kumbakonam.
Death : 02.10.2026
Dasasthu : 11.10.2026
Mourned by:
Wife: **J. Bharathi**
Son: **J. Bharani** - Cell: 89254 32223
Daughters:
J. Indira Srinivasan - Cell: 96190 43610
J. Hema Sriram - Cell: 92255 64676

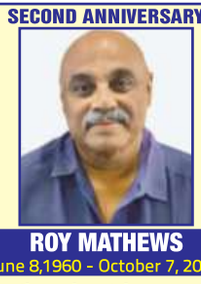
DEATH

OBITUARY

Sri S.Janarthanaram
Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Co. Ltd.
Passed away on 6th Oct 2026, Last rites on Wednesday, 7th October 2026 at 12.30 pm
Contact: 98403 58345

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

SECOND ANNIVERSARY



ROY MATHEWS
June 8,1960 - October 7, 2024
Death may have taken you away from us, but in our life, a hero you'll forever be. We miss you Dad
Fondly remembered by
Wife - Treasa Mathews
Sanjay & Family,
Rohit & Anand Mathews

OBITUARY
With profound grief, we inform the passing of our beloved

V. K. Varijakshan
26.05.1948 - 05.10.2026
A Retired SSB Official and Director of Linktech Engineering Pvt. Ltd.,
Vadakke Kanichukunnath family members

M N SETHUMADHAVAN
28.10.1938 - 01.10.2026
With deep sorrow we announce the passing away of Shri. M N Sethumadhavan at the age of 87 years in Chennai. A loving husband, a devoted father and a friend to the world. He lived a life of simplicity and integrity, extending a helping hand to anyone in need. May his soul rest in peace.
Forever in our memories
Wife Vanaja, children, son/daughters-in-law, grandchildren, relatives, friends, ex-colleagues from Ordnance Factories Aruvankadu, Varangaon and Avadi.
Ph: 9819219039

GEORGE PIUS THARAYIL
(11.09.1963 - 5.10.2026)
S/o late Pius Joseph & Mariamma Pius

8th October 2026
Viewing at Home: 8-10am
Tharayil House, 17 Ramappa Nagar, 1st Cross Street, Perungudi, Chennai.

Funeral Service: St.Pius X Church, Church Road, Perungudi, Chennai.

MOURNED BY
Shoba George(wife), Tara (daughter), Samir(son) family & friends

PRAYER MEETING

Smt Aruna Ramesh Sayani
(08.11.1946 - 06.10.2026)
Wife of Ramesh Jethalal Sayani
D/o. Late Smt Hiralakshmi and Late Shri Lakshmidas Thakker (Sadani)
Daughter-in-law of Late Smt Champaben and Late Shri Jethalal Kalidas Sayani

Sons & Daughters-in-law
Rajesh & Namita Sayani
Suraj & Trupti Sayani

Daughter & Son-in-law
Shital & Ajit Thakker

Grandchildren
Dhruv, Prachi, Shaan, Panya, Armaan, Shiven and Sayani Family

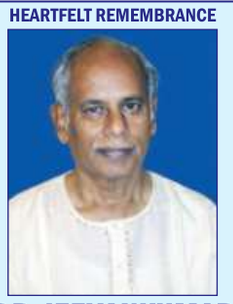
Prayer Meeting : 07.10.2026
Timing: 4.30 - 5.30 pm at
C U Shah Bhavan, Ritherdon Road, Purasaiwakkam, Chennai - 600007

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

13th ANNIVERSARY

04.11.1963 07.10.2013
Dr. S. Manimozhi
Husband: Er .R. SIVASHANMUGAM
Son: Dr. S. NAVEEN, M.D.
D-in-law: Dr. M. ILAKKIYA. M.S.(OG)
Granddaughter: Baby. N. Kavinila

HEARTFELT REMEMBRANCE



P.R.JEEVANKUMAR
(5.5.1943 - 07.10.2025)
Forever remembered,
Deeply cherished by all whose lives were touched by his kind heart and gentle soul
Dearly missed by
Kumari, Ravi, Meera Family and Friends
Cell: 9663368546

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

To dedicate a space in this section, Please contact:
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Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010.

Website : https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com

Advt. No. :–JCECEB/48 /26 - 91 Ranchi/Dated: 06 /10/2026

Notice regarding 3rd Round of Online Counselling for MDS All India & NRI Quota Seats of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Farathiya, Garhwa on the basis of NEET MDS-2026 Result

Online Application Forms are invited from qualified eligible candidates of NEET MDS-2026 examination for the preparation of all India merit list. Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare Department, Ranchi has earmarked 60% Seats of MDS for All India Quota and 15% for NRI Supported Candidates out of 15 of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Farathiya, Garhwa.

2. Interested eligible candidates are requested to fill the **Application Form Online** from **06.10.2026 to 07.10.2026** on Board's official website **http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in** by Clicking on " **Click Here for All Online Application Submission – JCECEB 2026**" tab by following the given directions.

The Candidates already enlisted in All India & NRI Quota merit list of 2nd Round Counselling need not have to apply again. Other terms and conditions and Eligibility criteria are same as per Advt. No.– JCECEB/48/26-86 dated-18.09.2026 which can be seen on Board's website **http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in** in Important Notice Column.

A. Schedule for 3rd Round of Online Counselling for NEET (MDS) - 2026 Course

Sl. No.	Activity	Schedule Date
1.	Online Application Form filling & Certificates/Documents Uploading	**06.10.2026 to 08.10.2026**
2.	Publication of Provisional State Merit List for 3rd Round of Online Counselling	**09.10.2026**
3.	Online Registration & Choice Filling for Seat Allotment	**10.10.2026 to 12.10.2026**
4.	Issue of Provisional Seat Allotment Letter	**13.10.2026**
5.	Certificates /Documents verification and admission in the concerned Institute	**14.10.2026 19.10.2026**

3. **Counselling will be held as per the guidelines issued by MCC/DCI New Delhi. In case of any change in guidelines, counselling dates as well as other terms & conditions will be notified accordingly.**

4. **It is mandatory for the candidate to upload Score Card of MDS -2026.**

5. **Applicable Fees**:– Applicants have to pay Application/Registration, Counselling Fee and Security Deposit through Payment Gateway by Credit Card/Debit Card/Net Banking as given below:-

(a) Application/Registration Fee :-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	₹ 1000/–
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of jharkhand state	₹ 500/–
3.	Divyang candidate	–

(b) Counselling Fee:-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	₹ 2000/–
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of jharkhand state	₹ 1200/–

© Security Deposit:-

Sl. No.	Institution	Security Deposit
1.	GOVERNMENT	30,000/- (UR/EWS) 15,000/- (ST/SC/OBC/PWD)
2.	Private	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
3.	Both (Government/Private)	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
4.	Stray/Mop-up	50,000/-

6. (a) Security Money will be forfeited if admission is not taken after seat allotment in Second Round and next Round of Counselling. Apart from this, Security Money will not be returned even in case of cancellation of admission in case of giving wrong information by the candidate at the time of registration and not presenting the required original certificates at the time of admission.

(b) The Security Money will be refunded if the candidates have taken valid admission and no seat is allotted after any stage of Counselling.

By the order of Controller of Examination,
Sd/- Officer on Special Duty

PR 391207 (Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board)26-27*D

GOVERNMENT OF TAMILNADU
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
PROJECTS, CHEPAUK, CHENNAI - 600 005.

FORM OF CONTRACT : LUMPSUM - ITEM RATE CONTRACT
e-TENDER NOTICE NO. 14 CE/JDO-1/2026-27 / Date : 05.10.2026

For and on behalf of the Governor of Tamil Nadu, e-tenders are invited from the eligible PWD registered Civil Contractors by the Chief Engineer, PWD, Projects, Chennai - 600 005, for the following work.

S. No.	Name of Work	Approximate value of work (Including GST 18%) Rs. in Lakhs	Amount of Earnest Money Deposit & period of completion	Eligibility of Contractor	EMD online mode remitted in favour of Executive Engineer, PWD, Technical Education Division
1.	Construction of Permanent Building for Government Arts and Science College at Muthupettai in Thiruvarur District.	1700.00	8,60,000/- 15 Months	Class I and above	Thanjavur

(1) For Tender documents e-tendering and instructions visit Government website **https://tntenders.gov.in** **(2)** The availability of tender schedule in the above Government website from **08.10.2026 to 10.11.2026** upto **3.00 P.M.** (As per server system clock). **(3)** Last date and time for submission of tender documents: **10.11.2026 upto 3.00 P.M.** (As per server system clock) Online only. **(4)** Date and Time of opening of e-tender: **11.11.2026 at 3.30 P.M.** (As per server system clock). **(5)** Digital signature is mandatory to participate in the tender. If any Changes / Corrections in the tender will be published in the above website only.

DIPR/3034/Tender/2026

Chief Engineer, PWD
Projects, Chepauk, Chennai - 600 005.

ODISHA STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LTD.,
(A Govt. of Odisha Undertaking)
REGISTERED OFFICE : C/2, NAYAPALLI, BHUBANESWAR-751012
CIN: U51211OR1980SGC000894
Tel No: 0674-3544751, Fax No: 0674-2395291, Website: www.oscsc.in
No.17470 / OSCSC Ltd., Date : 05.10.26

Corrigendum

Ref: Request for Proposal (RFP) Advt. No. 16228/OSCSC Ltd., Date: 17/09/2026

With reference to the RFP issued by OSCSC Ltd. for e-Auction of CMR, the following dates are hereby revised :

Particulars	Existing Date	Revised Date
Last Date of Registration	06.10.2026	12.10.2026
Date of Bidding / e-Auction	08.10.2026 and 09.10.2026	14.10.2026 and 15.10.2026

All other amendments/details of the Corrigendum may be viewed/downloaded from the websites of **www.oscsc.in** and **www.neml.in**. All other terms and conditions of the RFP, except those specifically modified through the Corrigendum, shall remain unchanged.

7001/123/2627

Sd/- Managing Director, OSCSC Ltd.
OIPR- 7001/7002/2/26-27/0011

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI
Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032
Certified Professional Course on
LEAN SIX SIGMA CERTIFICATION
AI POWERED WORKSHOPS

COURSE	FEES (incl GST)	CLASSROOM TRAINING DATES
YELLOW BELT	₹ 5,900	10 & 11 October 2026 (WEEK END)
GREEN BELT	₹ 17,700	10, 11, 17 & 18 October 2026 (WEEK END)
BLACK BELT	₹ 29,500	10, 11, 17, 18, 24, & 25 October 2026 (WEEK END)

COURSE	FEES (incl GST)	ONLINE TRAINING DATES
ROOT CAUSE ANALYST	₹ 2,950	12, 13, 14, 15 & 16 October 2026 (WEEK DAY)
LEAN CHAMPION	₹ 7,375	14,15,16,21,22 & 23 October 2026 (WEEK DAY)
5S AUDITOR	₹ 7,375	18, 19, 20, 25, 26 & 28 November 2026 (WEEK DAY)
YELLOW BELT	₹ 2,950	31 October | 1, 14 & 15 November 2026 (WEEK END)
GREEN BELT	₹ 14,750	31 Oct | 1, 14, 15, 21 & 22, 28 & 29 Nov 2026 (WEEK END)
BLACK BELT	₹ 22,125	31 October | 1, 14,15, 21, 22, 28 & 29 November | 5, 6, 12, 13, December 2026 (WEEK END)

Timings : Classroom : 10.00 AM - 5.30 PM, Online : 07 PM - 10 PM Weekday Online : 8.00 PM - 10 PM
Classroom Venue: CFTI Block, 65/1, G.S.T Road, Guindy, Chennai – 32

LEAD TRAINER: Prof. Dr.Gopal Sivakumar,
M.E.,Ph.D.,CSSMBB, 20+ Years Exp. Founder & CEO , Vision Excellence

Call us for In-House Training Requirements:
APQP, PPAP, FMEA, SPC, MSA, 7 QC TOOLS, KAIZEN, 5S, POKA YOKE, MINITAB, QFD, DoE
Fees to be Paid through online www.cftichennai.in | Account No: 39868874350, IFSC Code: SBIN0000956, Director, MSME TDC
›› Group Registration Offer Available for Corporates ‹‹

For More Details Contact 90878 88225 | 88381 65936
044 22501529 EXT 27 msmetdc@cftichennai.in

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number **1800 102 1878**
Or write to us at **customercare@thehindu.co.in**
Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU | thehindu businessline | FRONTLINE | SPORTSTAR | The Hindu Young World | THE HINDU

APPOINTMENTS

TICEL BIO PARK LTD
(TIDCO Centre for Life Science)

TICEL INVITES APPLICATION FOR THE FOLLOWING POST

Post	Qualification	Experience	Upper Age Limit (as on 30.09.2026)	Salary per month (Consolidated)
Manager (Civil) on Contract basis	Degree in Civil Engineering.	Post qualification experience of Minimum 10 years in Project Execution, Plant Maintenance in Multi Store building. Experience in Central / State government or Public Sector undertaking will be added advantage. (Details of requirements are available in our website)	40 Years	Rs.1,00,000/-

The eligible candidates may send their resume on or before 28.10.2026:
For Details Website: **www.ticelbiopark.com**

THE MANAGING DIRECTOR
TICEL BIO PARK LTD.
No.05, CSIR Road, Taramani, Chennai - 600 113
Tel.: 044 - 22542060 / 61, Email: **carriers@ticelbiopark.com**

DIPR/860/Display/2026

एचएलएल लाइफ़केयर लिमिटेड
(भारत सरकार का उद्यम)
HLL Lifecare Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)
CIN: U25193 KL 1966 GOI 002621
Corporate & Regd. Office: Poojappura, Thiruvananthapuram-695 012, Kerala

RECRUITMENT OF PROFESSIONALS

HLL invites applications for the following positions :

Role	Location(s)	Type	Vacancies
Deputy General Manager (QA & QC)	Kanagala, Belguam	Permanent	1
Senior Business Manager (IBD)	Trivandrum	Fixed term contract basis	1
Business Manager (IBD)	Trivandrum		1
Junior Manager (Production)	Anywhere in India		8
Quality Assurance Officer	Anywhere in India		9
Associate Manager (Internal Audit)	Anywhere in India		2

Apply Online : **www.lifecarehll.com/careers**
Last Date for Submission of Application : **21.10.2026**

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THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
CORRIGENDUM-3

Tender No.: 75265010, Dated: 05/10/2026. The following Corrigendum against **Tender No. 75265010** scheduled to be opened on **23.11.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.** is carried out as under: **- SL. NO. : [1]. PARTICULARS: 2nd Pre-Bid Conference Date and Time**. AS PER **TENDER DOCUMENT:** Existing. **TO BE READ AS:** 26.10.2026, 11:00 Hrs.

PR5/509 AMM(M)/CLW/Chittaranjan
visit us on:www.facebook.com/clwrailways

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, Divisional Electrical Engineer (Con) S.E. Railway, Kharagpur invites e-tender for the following works. Following tender has been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in.** The e-tender will be closed at 12.00 hrs. on due date: **e-Tender Notice No. : EL-CON-KGP-SHM-TRIP-26-07; Brief Description of Works :** Supply, erection, testing, commissioning of Retractable Overhead Conductor-rail System (ROCS) including transition arrangement from conventional OHE to Retractable OHE including all accessories and Electrical General services works in connection with creation of trip maintenance/ Advance inspection centres at Shalimar for inspection & maintenance activity of Electric Locomotives of Kharagpur Division, South Eastern Railway; **Cost:** ₹ 3,56,68,744.84; **Bid Security:** ₹ 7,13,400.00; **Completion period:** 6 Months; **Due Date:** 26.10.2026; Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/ description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **NB:** "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders." **(PR-853)**

RFP FOR CONSTRUCTION WORKS

Tender Notice No. CON/2026/SEP/04. Open tender through e-Tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractor(s)/firm(s) for the following works: **Tender No. CE/CON/ANJ/EPC/2026/02. Name of work:** RFP for Construction of embankment, cutting, minor bridges, service buildings, P.way works and associated Railway electrification and Signal and Telecom works between New Jalpaiguri (including) to Chatterhat (including) (between Ch Ch 0.4600 km to 22.070 km) and Tin Mile Hat (including) to Aluabari (including) (between Ch Ch 38.400 km to 57.730 km) in connection with 3rd and 4th Railway Lines between New Jalpaiguri - Aluabari. **Approx. value:** ₹1139,89,29,650.51/-. **Earnest Money:** ₹22,79,78,600/-.**Date & Time of closing of tender:** At **14.30** hrs. on **12-11-2026 & opening at: 15.30** hrs. on **13-11-2026**. The complete information and tender document of above e-Tender will be available at **www.ireps.gov.in**

Chief Engineer/CON/
New Jalpaiguri Project, Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
(Construction Organisation)
Serving Customers With A Smile

THE HINDU
OPPORTUNITIES

Over 20 Jobs in today's issue

GENERAL

ONGC MRPL

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise and Subsidiary of ONGC Limited) CIN No. : L19200KA1988GOI008959
Kuthethoor Post, Mangalore – 575 030 E-mail: pfte@mrpl.co.in

Date of opening of online portal for submitting application: 09/10/2026
Last Date for submitting online application: 07/11/2026

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited (MRPL), a Schedule 'A' Mini Ratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) and a subsidiary of ONGC Limited, invites online applications from bright, energetic and dedicated professionals (Indian Nationals only) for engagement as Personnel on Fixed Term Employment (PFTE).

Advt. No.	Position Name	PFTE Position Level	No. of Posts and Reservation	Mode of Selection*
MRPL/PFTE/2026/03	Fire Officer	Executive Level L1	05 (UR-4, OBC (NCL)-1)	Personal Interview

Abbreviation: UR- Unreserved, OBC (NCL) - Other Backward Caste (Non-Creamy Layer)
* Eligible candidates will be called for Personal Interview (PI) after screening of the applications.
Interested candidates can visit website **https://www.mrpl.co.in/careers** for detailed advertisement.

भारतीय सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान कोट्टायम
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY KOTTAYAM
(An Institution of National Importance under the Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)
Valavoor P.O, Pala, Kottayam (Dt), Kerala -686 625
Tel: 04822-202100 (Office), 202135 (Academics), 202110 (Security), 202103 (Accounts)
Email: registrar@iiitkottayam.ac.in Website: www.iiitkottayam.ac.in

No. IIITK/01/12/2026/2762 Date: October 05, 2026

ADVERTISEMENT FOR CONTRACT FACULTY POSITIONS

Indian Institute of Information Technology Kottayam (IIIT Kottayam) invites online applications from Indian Nationals for recruitment to the **Contract Faculty** positions in the interdisciplinary areas of **CSE and Cyber Security**.

Interested candidates may apply online through **https://adhocrecruit.iiitkottayam.ac.in/** on or before **5:00 pm on 14.10.2026**.

The online Interview is scheduled on 16.10.2026 from 10:00 AM onwards.

Sd/-
REGISTRAR

To Advertise in
The Hindu Opportunities column,
Please contact,
Nagaraj. V
Email: nagaraj.v@thehindu.co.in
Ph: 9841571594

SBI
State Bank of India
Central Recruitment & Promotion Department
Corporate Centre, Mumbai
Phone: 022-22820427

Scan QR to Apply

Engagement of Specialist Cadre Officers on Contract Basis

Applications are invited from eligible Indian citizens for the following posts on Contract basis:

Name of Post	Vacancy	Age (As on 31.07.2026) Min	Max
Advertisement No.: CRPD/SCO/2026-27/24 (Contractual Position)			
Deputy Vice President (Analytical Marketing & Campaign)	1	33	45
Deputy Vice President (Digital Marketing)	2	33	45
Content Specialist	1	25	40
Advertisement No.: CRPD/SCO/2026-27/25 (Contractual Position)			
Head Sales	1	40	52
Central Research Team (Product Lead)	2	30	45
Manager (Business Process)	1	30	40
Project Development Manager (Technology)	1	25	40
Central Operations Team (COT) Support	1	30	40

For eligibility criteria (age, experience, job profile etc.), vacancy details, requisite fees, other details and for online submission of application as well as online payment of application fees log on to Bank's website **https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/current-openings**. Refer detailed advertisement to ensure eligibility and other details before applying and remitting fees. For any query, please write to us through link **"CONTACT US" → "Post Your Query"** which is available on Bank's official website **(https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/post-your-query)**

- **DATE FOR FILING ONLINE APPLICATION & PAYMENT OF FEES: FROM 30.09.2026 To 21.10.2026.**

Place: Mumbai
Date: 30.09.2026

General Manager (RP & PM)

GENERAL

DHANALAKSHMI SRINIVASAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND RESEARCH
(Deemed to be University Under Distinct Category Section 3 of the UGC Act)
Siruvachur - 621 113, Perambalur, Tamil Nadu, India

WANTED

DSISR (Deemed to be University) invites applications for the following leadership positions through its Search-cum-Selection Committee / Competent Authority, in accordance with applicable UGC Regulations, including the UGC (Institutions Deemed to be Universities) Regulations, 2023, as amended.

VICE - CHANCELLOR
A distinguished academician with at least 10 years of experience as a Professor in a University or 10 years of experience in an equivalent position at a reputed research organization or academic institution, with proven academic leadership and integrity, as per UGC norms.

REGISTRAR
An experienced academician or administrator with 15 years of experience and substantial expertise in administration, academic governance, statutory compliance and UGC Regulations in a University as per UGC norms.

CONTROLLER OF EXAMINATIONS (COE)
An experienced academician or administrator with expertise in examination administration, evaluation, result processing, digital examination systems, and maintaining confidentiality.

DEAN – ACADEMICS
An accomplished academician with experience in teaching, research, curriculum development, quality assurance, accreditation and academic administration.

GENERAL CONDITIONS

- Qualifications and experience: As prescribed by applicable UGC norms.
- Salary and benefits: Among the best in academia.

Send your resume to
dsisruniversity@gmail.com | 84899 23800

From Page One

Byelections peaceful in T.N., Puducherry

Democratic right: Voters of Mamandur at a polling station in Madurantakam on Tuesday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Polling began on a sluggish pace but picked up pace from 9 a.m., elections officials said. In polling booth number 26 at Sithandi, the control unit of the EVM malfunctioned and had to be replaced twice. This led to a delay in the start of polling. Similarly, in booth number 55 at L. Endathur, the ballot unit of the EVM had to be replaced after polling agents objected to a mark visible on the name of a candidate.

The ruling TVK lodged a complaint against DMK candidate I. Paranthamen for allegedly violating the Model Code of Conduct when he spoke to reporters, alleging horse-trading by the TVK, pointing at a complaint filed by two Opposition MLAs with the DVAC. Denying any violation, Mr. Paranthamen said his party was in possession of screen shots of a message that many voters in Madurantakam received on Monday, containing details of their EPIC and polling booths, with the picture of the TVK candidate. "This happened during the silent period. We have given a written complaint with proof," he told *The Hindu*.

Chengalpattu Collector M. Veerappan said the polling was peaceful.

The EVMs have been moved to the strong room at the Integrated Training Institute for Social Development, Athur.

80.3% polling in Dharapuram

The Dharapuram (reserved) constituency in Tiruppur district, which has 2,23,306 voters, recorded 80.3% polling. The voting was disrupted for a while at a couple of booths. The turnout that was sluggish in the morning hours picked up as the day progressed. However, the turnout was lesser in the byelection than in the April-May Assembly election which recorded 89.9%.

Officials said polling went off without any untoward incident, and the disruption at two booths was addressed immediately.

P. Sathyabama of the TVK, who had won earlier as the AIADMK candidate by securing 40.56% of 1,99,944 votes, is pitted against S. Suganya of the DMK and Banumathi of the AIADMK. In the April-May election, Gowri Chitra of the TVK came third, with 46,438 votes, securing 23.23% of the votes polled. The DMK, whose candidate T. Indirani polled 63,336 votes accounting for 32.2%, is testing its strength without the support of allies in the byelection.

After polling came to a close, officials sealed the EVMs and the VVPATs for moving them to the strong room at LRG Government Arts and Science College at Tiruppur.

80.81% turnout in Thattanchavady

The byelection in the Thattanchavady Assembly constituency of the Union Territory of Puducherry recorded 80.81% turnout, around 6.29% less than the figure for the Assembly election held in April-May to constitute the 16th Assembly.

Of the total 26,921 electors, 21, 756 voters exercised their franchise in the byelection. As against 79. 97% of the men who turned up to vote, 81. 55% of the women voters exercised their franchise. In addition, 109 electors voted through postal ballot.

The byelection was held after Chief Minister and All India N.R. Congress (AINRC) founder N. Rangaswamy chose to vacate Thattanchavady, while retaining Mangalam which he won. The byelection passed off peacefully with no untoward incident reported from any of the 31 booths spread across 19 locations. The EVMs have been moved to Motilal Nehru Government Polytechnic at Lawspet. The votes will be counted on October 9.

DMK seeks ECI action against TVK's Dharapuram candidate over 'poll spending violation'

MLA S. Austin lodges complaint with Chief Electoral Officer. Citing a video in which P. Sathyabama is heard saying ₹14 lakh was spent, he questions whether the account was submitted to authorities

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The DMK on Tuesday lodged a complaint with the Election Commission of India (ECI), seeking action against the TVK candidate for Dharapuram, P. Sathyabama, over alleged non-disclosure of election campaign expenditure and violation of the Model Code of Conduct.

DMK MLA S. Austin lodged the complaint with Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik at the Secretariat. In his complaint, he referred to a video in which Ms. Sathyabama was heard saying "approximately ₹14 lakh was spent on logistics, including hotel accommodation for visiting dignitaries/Ministers, flight tickets for alliance representatives, and settling amounts related to election coordination/resorts". The video had gone viral on social media platforms.

Mr. Austin urged the ECI to initiate an inquiry by directing the Expenditure Monitoring Cell, the District Election Officer, and the Returning Officer of the Dharapuram Assembly constituency to verify the day-to-day expenditure registers filed by Ms. Sathyabama.

Courting controversy: It is unclear whether Sathyabama was referring to the Assembly poll, in which she was the AIADMK's candidate, or Tuesday's bypoll, in which she was fielded by the TVK. S. SIVA SARAVANAN

Ms. Sathyabama was also heard saying in the same video that she had "spent ₹31 crore" on an election

He also sought verification of whether the account for ₹14 lakh was submitted to the election authorities. If it was found to have been omitted, he sought action against her under the Representation of the People Act, 1951, and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for filing "fake expenditure statements".

Ms. Sathyabama was also heard saying in the same video that she had "spent ₹31 crore" on an election. It is unclear whether she was referring to the 2026 Assembly election, in which she was the AIADMK's candidate, or the subsequent byelection, in which she was fielded by the TVK. The video clip had been submitted to the ECI for further action, officials said.

Expenditure Observer Bhaskar Bhattacharya said that altogether, money and materials valued at over ₹5 crore were seized, as of October 4. The expenditure accounts submitted by the candidates by the same deadline had also been compiled.

Further action based on the video would be taken by the ECI, the official said.

Ms. Sathyabama said she had submitted to the ECI evidence to show that the video was the "handiwork of her DMK detractors".

Candidates in Assembly elections are permitted to incur poll-related expenditure up to ₹40 lakh.

TVK-led regime has backstabbed nurses, says DMK president

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Tuesday alleged that the TVK-led government had backstabbed nurses after promising them that it would fulfil their demands.

In a social media message, he condemned the arrest (on Monday night) of nurses who had been fighting for job security, equal pay, and permanent employment. "How could the government bring itself to arrest nurses when it is not able to hold talks with them? The legal adviser of the nurses has alleged that they were arrested after being invited for talks," he said.

Mr. Stalin said the TVK had supported the protesters before assuming office, but had taken police action against them after coming to power. "What do the TVK Ministers say about this incident when they have been defending Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay? The nurses continued their protest with the help of the flashlight on their mobile phones after the power supply was cut. They were arrested overnight. Is this the change the TVK is talking about," he asked.

The former Chief Minister also recalled the warning given by a police officer, who was seen gesticulating with her fingers, saying, "Your life is important". "Will the Chief Minister, who holds the police portfolio, respond to it? Or will he make reels on the woman police officer's action and advertise it as an achievement?" he said.

Height of cruelty: EPS

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami said the "police brutality" unleashed by the TVK-led government on the nurses, who were staging a peaceful protest, "is the height of cruelty".

"The police force under the Chief Minister has committed this fascist atrocity against nurses who are engaged in the vital duty of saving lives. How will this 'Reels Chief Minister' justify it?" he said in a social media post.

"Before coming to power, do you remember what your party functionaries – and those who are Ministers today – said, standing in front of these nurses? Is this the change you promised: saying one thing before coming to power and doing the exact opposite after assuming office," he asked.

He urged the government to immediately release the arrested nurses and ensure that no cases were filed against them.

AMMK general secretary T.T.V. Dhinakaran also criticised the government for the "arbitrary action" against the nurses.

Plea alleges CM has claimed ownership of poromboke land

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has claimed ownership of 50 cents of government poromboke land at Vilpatti village in Kodaikanal, falsely declared a property sold by him for ₹35 crore at Padi in Chennai as his property worth ₹7 crore, and wrongly termed his Neelankarai bungalow an inherited property, an election petitioner has claimed before the Madras High Court.

However, Mr. Vijay said the allegations against him were baseless and the petition must be dismissed.

In the petition pending before Justice V. Lakshminarayanan, S. Dinesh, a voter from Perambur constituency, insisted that the election of the Chief Minister be declared null and void for "wilful and deliberate" suppression, misrepresentation and false declarations with respect to many of the immovable properties referred to in his 2026 election affidavit.

According to the petitioner's counsel, V.R. Shanmuganathan, Mr. Vijay had claimed to have purchased the Vilpatti agricultural land for ₹30,000 in 1997. Mr Vijay had also said the current market value of the property was around ₹20 lakh. However, an examination of the village 'A' register revealed the property was actually on government poromboke land, the counsel claimed.

Similarly, Mr. Vijay had declared to have purchased a non-agricultural land measuring 33,955 sq. ft at Porur for ₹9.13 crore in 2010. But an examination of Registration Department documents revealed he had purchased only 20,773 sq. ft for ₹7.5 crore, the petitioner alleged.

He said Mr. Vijay had declared that he owned a ₹7-crore-worth 11,854 sq. ft commercial building at Padi, and claimed to have purchased it for ₹1.95 crore in 2009 besides spending ₹3.9 crore on construction. However, he had sold the commercial building with a constructed area of 23,460 sq. ft for ₹35 crore on February 12, 2026, the petitioner claimed.

The court was told that he had not purchased the commercial property in 2009 as declared in the election affidavit, and had received it in exchange for his Korattur property from the Tamil Nadu Housing Board. The petitioner said the Chief Minister had not disclosed that the property was acquired through a deed of exchange, and that it was sold for ₹35 crore much before the filing of the election affidavit.

As for the Neelankarai bungalow, the petitioner said it was not inherited. Mr. Vijay's father, S.A. Chandrasekhar, had purchased it from Sumathi Raghunath Gaitonde in 2003 and settled it in favour of his son in 2005. The settlement deed said the father was giving away the property to the son without receiving any consideration out of love and affection. The 2005 settlement deed had declared the value of the property, spread over 17,100 sq. ft of land area and a 5,500-sq. ft building, to be ₹2.75 crore. However, in his 2026 election affidavit, the Chief Minister had claimed to have spent ₹18.73 crore to put up 18,633 sq. ft of built-up area on the land, and that the current market value of the property was around ₹20 crore, the petitioner said.

Chief Minister's reply

Filing an application to reject the election petition, the Chief Minister said all the allegations were false, unfounded, baseless, and misconceived.

"The entire election petition runs into pages and pages of microscopic dissection of my Form 26 with an item-wise allegation of fluctuations in value of properties declared therein, whether or not these fluctuations are material or not. Even if it is assumed (though not admitted) that the contents of the election petition are true and correct, it would not disclose any cause of action," the applicant said.

"No attempt has been made (by the election petitioner) to show how these imaginary perceived defects have affected the outcome of the election," Mr. Vijay said.

Pointing out that he had secured 1,20,365 votes and won by a margin of 53,715 votes in Perambur constituency, the Chief Minister said his election could not be nullified on flimsy allegations.

(Read the full report at thlink.in/Poromboke)

INBRIEF

Pushpavanam Kuppusamy calls on Chief Minister

Folk singer Pushpavanam Kuppusamy, who has been appointed as the Chairman of the Tamil Nadu Eyal Isai Nataka Mandram, called on Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the Secretariat on Tuesday. Mr. Kuppusamy was accompanied by his wife and playback singer Anita Kuppusamy and his daughter. Minister for School Education Rajmohan was also present. Separately, Dominic Gerald David, president, KLA India Private Limited, and others called on the Chief Minister at the Secretariat, an official release said.

Direct DVAC to register FIR against Finance Minister, PIL plea urges HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

An advocate has approached the Madras High Court for a direction to the Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC) to register a First Information Report (FIR) on the basis of Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson's claim in the Tamil Nadu Assembly that he was a victim of corruption in the School Education Department during the previous DMK government.

The plea is expected to be listed for hearing before the First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, since it had been filed as a public interest litigation (PIL) petition. K. Sivasubramaniam of Chennai had filed the petition for a direction to register an FIR against the Minister, as the payment of a bribe was also a criminal offence.

N. Marie Wilson

The petitioner said Mr. Wilson had, during a debate in the Assembly on August 24, claimed he was a victim of corrupt practices during the previous government, when bribes was allegedly demanded and collected forcibly from educational institutions. The Minister also said he had witnessed the payment of a bribe, and he knew exactly how much was paid.

Pointing out that not only the receipt but also the payment of a bribe to a public servant was an offence under Sections 8 and 12 of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, the PIL petitioner said he had lodged a complaint with the DVAC on August 27. He, however, complained that the law enforcement agency had not taken any action so far on his plea to register an FIR against the Minister.

'No immunity'

"An open confession of a criminal act made by a Minister inside the Legislative Assembly cannot be dismissed as mere political rhetoric," the petitioner said, contending that the constitutional immunity granted to legislators, under Article 194(2) of the Constitution, from civil or criminal proceedings with respect to their actions in the House would not provide any immunity from prosecution for criminal acts.

"While the speech inside the Assembly is recorded in the official transcript, the act of giving a bribe took place outside the Legislative Assembly precincts. The official speech serves as a voluntary, unequivocal evidentiary admission of a completed pre-existing criminal act under Section 8 of the Prevention of Corruption Act. Privileges under Article 194 cannot be weaponised to bar law enforcement from investigating independent cognisable crimes admitted by public functionaries," his affidavit read.

Claiming that former School Education Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi had subsequently levelled allegations of irregularities against Mr. Wilson's educational institutions, the petitioner insisted that the allegations against the sitting Minister, too, be probed by the DVAC.

Kin of labourers who died of suffocation receive their bodies

The Hindu Bureau
ARIYALUR

After several days of protest, the families of three labourers, who suffocated to death in a septic tank at an under-construction house in Sendurai in Ariyalur district on October 2, received their bodies on Tuesday.

K. Bhaskar, 42, of Srinivasapuram in Tiruvarur district; K. Dhinakaran, 60, of Alivalam village in Tiruvarur district; and K. Ramachandran, 45, of Nakkambadi village in Ariyalur district, died after entering the eight-foot septic tank.

M. Subramanian, the owner of the house, was arrested. However, the family members of the deceased refused to accept their bodies, and demanded a compensation of ₹30 lakh each. The CPI(M), the Tamil Nadu Untouchability Eradication Front (TNUEF), and the Annihilation of Hazardous Sewerage Killings extended support to them. After negotiations with police and revenue officials, they withdrew their protest and received the bodies of the victims from the Government Medical College Hospital in Ariyalur. They were given a solatium of ₹3 lakh each under the Chief Minister's Public Relief Fund.

The officials also promised a compensation of ₹8 lakh under the Tamil Nadu Construction Workers' Welfare Board. The bodies were later buried.

Citing a Supreme Court judgment, Chellakannu, secretary, TNUEF, said that if a labourer dies inside a septic tank, the victim's family should be paid a compensation of ₹30 lakh. He added that his forum would take the matter to a competent court.

INBRIEF

4 students injured in clash over *Vande Mataram* event

Four students were reportedly injured in clashes between the police and student protesters at the Central University of Kerala (CUK) in Kasaragod where various student organisations were protesting against a national seminar on *Vande Mataram* on Tuesday. The scuffle broke out as members of the SFI, NSUI, MSF and the AISF tried to enter the seminar hall, alleging that the event was an attempt to "advance a saffronisation agenda" at the university.

Man gets 47-year jail term for sexually assaulting minor

A special court in Kerala on Tuesday sentenced a 43-year-old man to 47 years of rigorous imprisonment for sexually assaulting a 15-year-old boy, who is his relative and neighbour. Special Judge Anju Meera Birla of the Thiruvananthapuram Fast Track Special Court also slapped a fine of ₹32,000 on the convict. The court said that he must undergo an additional three years and three months of imprisonment if he fails to pay the fine.

Karnataka to launch drive to close defunct borewells

Karnataka will launch a Statewide campaign to identify and close defunct and unsafe open borewells, Minor Irrigation Minister Ajay Dharam Singh said in Bengaluru on Tuesday. The 'Borewell Suraksha Abhiyan' will initially focus on defunct borewells coming under the Minor Irrigation Department. It will later cover borewells under other departments and those in public places. "Not a single borewell should become a threat to a child's life," he said. PTI

Surya, India' first indigenous fleet support ship, launched

It is a floating supply powerhouse that can sustain protracted, high-intensity naval engagements; Rajnath urges Indian shipyards to look beyond self-reliance and aim at international markets

V. Kamalakara Rao
VISAKHAPATNAM

Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh launched the Navy's first indigenous fleet support ship (FSS-1), named *Surya*, and laid the keel for the fifth vessel of the series, FSS-5, at Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL) in Visakhapatnam on Tuesday.

The ceremony was attended by Chief of the Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, Secretary (Defence Production) Sanjeev Kumar, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Eastern Naval Command Vice Admiral Sanjay Bhalla, HSL CMD Rear Admiral C. Raghuram, and other dignitaries.

Homemade vessel: Rajnath Singh speaking at the launch of the fleet support ship, *Surya*, in Visakhapatnam on Tuesday. V. RAJU

The Minister urged Indian shipyards to look beyond self-reliance towards global competitiveness, aiming to serve international markets, build a presence in marine technology, and provide advanced ship repair services.

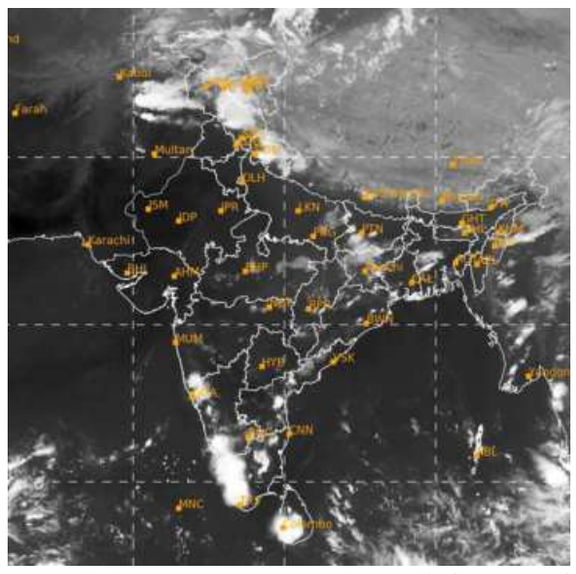
The massive Fleet Support Ship (FSS) initiative is backed by a landmark ₹19,000-crore contract between the Ministry of Defence and HSL to construct five indigenous auxiliary vessels.

The FSS platform, with 82% indigenous content, serves as a floating supply powerhouse, engineered to sustain protracted, high-intensity naval engagements and battle groups far from home ports.

Its internal storage holds up to 20,000 tonnes of high-speed diesel, 2,500 tonnes of aviation turbine fuel, fresh water, alongside dry cargo containers for ammunition and spares. It can simultaneously transfer fuel, stores, and personnel to multiple warships to maintain continuous high-seas deployment.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Wednesday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Chandigarh, Delhi, Bihar, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Keralam and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	0.4	33.6	25.2	Kurnool	—	37.3	26.6
Ahmedabad	—	36.4	25.4	Lucknow	—	33.0	22.5
Aizawl	—	31.2	19.8	Madurai	—	37.3	26.1
Bengaluru	42.6	29.8	19.6	Mangaluru	6.3	31.9	24.0
Bhopal	—	36.1	19.0	Mumbai	—	33.5	24.8
Bhubaneswar	—	35.4	24.4	Mysuru	24	31.8	19.8
Chandigarh	—	34.8	24.6	New Delhi	—	36.8	25.2
Chennai	5.4	36.0	25.4	Patna	—	33.0	25.9
Coimbatore	—	34.5	23.6	Port Blair	3	31.5	24.8
Dehradun	2.8	30.3	21.3	Prayagraj	—	34.2	23.8
Gangtok	3.8	20.6	15.0	Puducherry	—	34.9	26.3
Goa	—	32.6	24.5	Pune	—	36.6	22.2
Guwahati	—	32.4	24.4	Raipur	—	34.8	24.5
Hubballi	—	33.0	21.0	Ranchi	—	30.6	20.0
Hyderabad	—	34.0	20.8	Shillong	—	23.2	15.2
Imphal	—	30.9	19.3	Shimla	—	26.7	16.7
Jaipur	—	36.6	25.6	Srinagar	—	24.6	14.0
Kochi	0.8	32.2	25.2	Thiruvananthapuram	—	34.5	25.1
Kohima	—	21.0	15.1	Tiruchirappalli	—	37.5	26.4
Kolkata	—	34.5	26.8	Vijayawada	3.1	33.5	25.0
Kozhikode	—	36.1	26.5	Visakhapatnam	1	33.2	24.7

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.77	..41	20	... 117	...194	
Bengaluru	.28	..32	80	 43	76	
Chennai	...5	..11	18	 81	86	
Delhi	...8	..68	13	... 229	...267	
Hyderabad	.11	..20	54	 77	...113	
Kolkata	...9	..58	38	... 248	...154	
Lucknow	...6	..27	29	 76	78	
Mumbai	...3	..47	40	 96	...116	
Pune	...5	..61	57	 91	94	
Visakhapatnam	.17	..68	21	 65	...121	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 238 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 20

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

3.7 lakh SIR notices pending in Bengaluru

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

With hearings on notices issued under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) scheduled to conclude by October 12, more than 3.70 lakh of the 6.66 lakh notices pending Statewide for hearing are in Bengaluru, Shilpa Nag C.T., Special Commissioner (Election), said while addressing the media on Tuesday.

Of the more than 24 lakh notices issued in Bengaluru for logical discrepancies and for being unmapped, only 13,550 notices are yet to be delivered. Booth-level officers will visit houses and collect documents, while hearings will be conducted online only in some cases.

Ms. Nag said 1,117 Assistant Electoral Registration Officers (AEROs) have been appointed to conduct hearings, in addition to the 76 regular AEROs.

Form 7 filings linked to BJP, says Owaisi

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Hyderabad MP Asaduddin Owaisi on Tuesday alleged that numerous pre-filled Form 7 applications seeking deletion of voters' names from the electoral rolls were submitted in the Goshamahal Assembly constituency, and sought action against the individual who submitted the forms in bulk.

Goshamahal is part of the Hyderabad Lok Sabha seat. Citing a specific example, Mr. Owaisi said 122 Form 7 applications had been submitted at Booth 28 in Goshamahal. He said it was part of a deliberate move to remove voters belonging to a minority community. Noting that the forms were "pre-printed", he said his enquiries revealed that the person who submitted them was one Janardhan, a "BJP supporter or sympathiser".

Act against illegal resorts: Karnataka Minister

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Environment Minister Ramalinga Reddy has directed forest officials to take immediate action against all illegally established resorts and homestays in the eco-sensitive zone (ESZ) and buffer zone of various tiger reserves and protected areas of Karnataka.

Mr. Reddy, who chaired a meeting of the Standing Committee of the State Board for Wildlife, sought details on the number of resorts, homestays and other commercial activities in the ESZ and buffer zone after the ESZ was notified for various tiger reserves and protected areas.

He also directed that there should be minimal disturbance in ESZ areas

S. E. RAILWAY - CORRIGENDUM

Corrigendum to tender vide **NIT No. E-DRM-Engg-ADRA-96-26, Dtd.03.09.2026** published earlier by Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), S.E. Railway, Adra. The closing date of the above tender should be read as **13.10.2026** instead of 06.10.2026. All other terms & conditions of original tender notice will remain unchanged. Details of e-tenders may please be seen at website **www.lreps.gov.in.**

(PR-861/C)

Government of Karnataka
KARNATAKA EXAMINATIONS AUTHORITY
Sampige Road, 18th Cross, Malleshwaram, Bangalore-560 012 Phone: 080-23 460 460 (5 Lines)
e-mail:keauthority-ka@nic.in Website: http://kea.kar.nic.in

No. ED/KEA/ADMN/PGNEET MD-MS /CR-12/2026 **Date: 05-10-2026**

NOTIFICATION

PGET-2026 - Admission to Post Graduate Medical courses for the year 2026-27 in the state of Karnataka & admission to In-Service seats of DNB (Primary and Secondary) and Diploma (NBEMS)

1. KEA is inviting applications online for admissions to PG Medical courses from the eligible candidates who have qualified in NEET-PG-2026 for the year 2026-27 for the available PG Medical Degree / Diploma courses in Government Medical colleges, Government Quota seats in Private and Minority Medical Colleges and Private seats in Private Medical colleges (KPCF, KRLMPCA, AMPCK and Private Universities) located in the State of Karnataka for the academic year 2026-27.
2. As per Government order No., HFW 882 HSH 2021 Bangalore Dated 10-01-2022, KEA is also inviting application online from the eligible Karnataka in-service candidates who have qualified in NEET-PG-2026 and desirous of applying DNB / Diploma Courses in the State of Karnataka for the academic year 2026-27.
3. The candidates who have obtained more than or equal to the prescribed minimum 50th percentile in NEET PG 2026 only are eligible to register and apply online for PG **Medical** courses for the year 2026-27.
4. Non-Karnataka candidates will not be eligible for reservation. Hence, in the NEET-PG 2026 examination, if they have scored the required minimum 50th percentile or above, fixed for 'GENERAL (UR)' category as per the qualifying criteria, then only they are eligible to register for admissions through KEA or for any other seats in the State of Karnataka. Please note that SC/ST/OBC eligibility criteria are applicable to Karnataka SC/ST/OBC candidates only.
5. Interested and eligible candidates can register, apply online and pay the fees for admission to Karnataka PG Medical Degree and Diploma courses from **11.00 am on 05-10-2026 up to 11.00 am on 15-10-2026.**
6. Afterwards, as per PGNEET-2026 **ANNEXURE-18–19,** candidates have to appear for verification at KEA, Bangalore by booking the slot. (Hosted in the KEA Website)
7. Registration fee, details of document verification, original documents to be submitted for document verification, and other details have been published on the KEA Website. Interested and eligible candidates can register by selecting the specified link on the KEA Website apply online and appear for document verification on the specified dates as per their eligibility.
8. Information Bulletin-2026 detailing admission eligibility criteria and other details are hosted on the KEA Website **https://cetonline.karnataka.gov.in/KEA/pgetmed2026** for the information of the candidates. Before registering through online for admission to PG Medical courses in the state of Karnataka, applicants are hereby informed to read the Information Bulletin PGNEET-2026 and understand the eligibility conditions, educational qualification, classification of seats (different types of category of seats), procedure for conduct of online seat allotment and eligibility to claim such seats.
9. Mere qualifying in NEET-PG 2026 does not confer any right on the candidate for admission unless the candidate fulfils eligibility conditions / submits the documents / certificates. Further, only the candidates who complete the registration process including document verification are eligible for PG Medical seats in Government / Private Colleges in Karnataka.
10. For more details please visit KEA Website **https://cetonline.karnataka.gov.in/KEA/pgetmed2026**

NOTE: As per NMC, New Delhi letter dated 24-07-2023; all the rounds of counselling including Stray Vacancy Round will be conducted only by KEA in online mode, all the PG NEET qualified candidates are hereby advised to register online and complete the document verification process in KEA to become eligible for admission to PG Medical Courses in the State of Karnataka.

Sd/-
(H. Prasanna, IAS),
Executive Director.

DIPR/CP/JA/3092/2026-27

Not getting work at Dandiya events, say Muslim bouncers

Serish Nanisetti
HYDERABAD

A collective of bouncers in Hyderabad has raised alarm over discrimination and denial of job opportunities to Muslims for the Dandiya events during the Navratri festival season.

"Earlier, we used to get contracts for most of the Dandiya events across the city. This year, most of my colleagues have been told that Muslims are no longer welcome to work as bouncers. My team has 10 members and some of them are not Muslims; how will I pay them now," asked Mohammed Feroz.

"Our work involves crowd management and safety. We don't even interact with the guests," he said. "Hyderabad was never like this. We have what is called the *Ganga-Jamuni tehzeeb* (syncretic culture)," Mr. Feroz said.

Salige Prabhakar, who has been in this line of work for 10 years, says "It is not fair to harm someone's livelihood like this."

INDIAN RAILWAYS
PATIALA LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
PATIALA - 147003
Tel.: 0175-2396000, 2396001, Fax: 0175-2306413

NOTICE INVITING ELECTRONIC TENDERS

On behalf of President of India Principal Chief Materials Manager/PLW/Patiala invites tenders in electronic form for following items:

e-Tender Notice No. 27 ET/2026-27

SN	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	Tender closing date
1	01261169	Supply, Installation and Commissioning of Hydraulically Operated Lifting and Swivelling Platform	116 Nos	04.11.2026*
2	02261183	Set of Stator and Rotor Stamping	126 Sets	27.10.2026**
3	02261088A	Polymide Paper (Nomex)	1618 Kgs	27.10.2026

Tender closing Time 15:00 Hrs.
Item marked with * is reserved for procurement from ICF approved sources. Item marked with ** is reserved for procurement from CLW approved sources
The prospective Tenderers are advised to visit the website **http://www.ireps.gov.in or.plw.Indianrailways.gov.in.** for detailed description of items & other terms and conditions of tender document. Please note that Tenderers can submit their quotations only through **http://www.ireps.gov.in.**
Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 21 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 21261166 may be read as 12.10.2026.
Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 16 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 02261097 may be read as 16.10.2026.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3455/26

Rift widens in Keralam film artistes' grouping

G. Krishnakumar
KOCHI

The rift within the Association of Malayalam Movie Artistes (AMMA) has widened following a recent decision by the executive committee to fill the vacant posts of vice-presidents, treasurer and joint secretary.

Actors Asha Aravind and Sijoy Varghese were made vice-presidents by the committee in a revamp held last week after the actors' body plunged into organisational turmoil following the general body meeting held here on June 21. Actors Neena Kurup and Sarayu Mohan were elected treasurer and joint secretary, respectively.

The 17-member panel, led by its first woman president Shweta Menon, had announced its resignation at the general body meeting after a section of the association moved a no-confidence motion against the leadership. She later retracted her decision, and the panel continued to hold their positions.

Actor Ansiba Hassan, who stepped down from the panel in February after accusing actor Tini Tom and some members of subjecting her to character assassination and making communal remarks, questioned the legality of the new appointments.

The committee has said that the appointments were carried out in line with the by-laws of the association.

PITHAMPUR AUTO CLUSTER
(A Government of M.P. Undertaking-Subsidiary of MPIDC)
1st Floor, Atulya IT Park, Khandwa Road, Indore-452001 (M.P.)
website: **www.pithampurautocluster.com**, Email: **md.pacl@gmail.com**

No. PAC/IND/2026-27/170 Date : 06.10.2026

INVITES PROPOSAL
for
O&M Contract for Operation, Maintenance & Management of Tool Room & Technical Service Centre

Pithampur Auto Cluster (PAC) had developed a Tool Room & Technical Service Centre facilities in the year 2009 at 113/2-A, Harniakhedi, A.B. Road, Opp. Veterinary College, Tehsil-Mhow, Distt. Indore (M.P.) with total initial investment of Rs. 47.40 crores, spread on 5 acres' land. Since inception these facilities are being Operated & Managed by M/s Indo Toolings Pvt. Ltd. (A unit of M/s JMB Auto Ltd., Gurgaon). As the current O&M Contract is going to be expired, PAC is looking for an entity capable to take the responsibility to Operate, Maintain and Manage the Tool Room and Technical Service Centre facilities on **"as is where is basis"** for the period of 15 years. The complete details of the proposal may be seen at e-portal **https://mptenders.gov.in.** The last date of submission of proposal is 29.10.2026. The document can be purchased online from 08.10.2026 at 11.30 A.M.

For any further information/clarification you may contact CFO, PAC (Mob: 9424011969).

M.P. Madhyam/128406/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

Let there be light

The Nobel Laureates for Medicine illuminated how the brain works

The first of the Nobel announcements has come, heralding the season of celebrating the fruits of the perennial human endeavour to know more and use that knowledge to benefit people. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine went jointly to Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegeman and Georg Nagel "for their discoveries concerning light-gated ion channels and optogenetics". True to Alfred Bernhard Nobel's aim of annually recognising those who have "conferred the greatest benefit to humankind", this year's Nobel went to people who shone a light, literally, on the brain, providing a quantum leap in understanding how it functions. In essence, if the brain is a puppeteer pulling the strings, the body is the marionette. The dexterity of the puppeteer is obvious, but her methods, often not. It is this that the Nobel trio sought to explain with optogenetics – making it possible to show how nerve cells communicate with each other, and the body, regulating memory, emotions and bodily functions. It allowed mapping the brain in ways that were previously impossible. As most often in work that the Nobel acknowledges and honours, there was rich collaboration across continents in advancing optogenetics. Peter Hegemann wondered what enabled *Chlamydomonas*, a single-celled alga, to swim towards a light source; Georg Nagel went on to discover an algal protein that can be illuminated with blue light to open a channel within, allowing charged ions to flow into the cell and create electrical impulses. Karl Deisseroth transformed the protein into a light-controlled switch for nerve cells. Practically, today, scientists use harmless viral agents to deliver genes for light-sensitive proteins into specific target cells. Then they deliver precise pulses of light, activating the channels, allowing research to study the patterns. In the decades since the laureates described their work, researchers have gone on to use optogenetics to reveal neural circuits governing specific memories, feelings and behaviours relevant to neurological and psychiatric disorders. It laid the groundwork for clinical treatments targeting conditions including Alzheimer's and addiction. Researchers are even using the method in attempts to restore sight.

As technology facilitates easier pathways to translating scientific research that happens in labs into practical therapies, diagnostics and health-care practices that could ameliorate human health or protect it from illness, it is also important for nations to find ways to ensure that the fruits of such research actually reach all the people who might benefit from it, irrespective of their location or station in life.

Break the chain

India must focus on cutting transmission of leprosy

While the prevalence of leprosy among adults and children and the grade-2 disability rate have dropped in India over the last decade, its continued transmission in many pockets constrains India's ability to meet targets outlined in the National Strategic Plan (NSP) and Roadmap for Leprosy 2023-2027. By 2005, the national prevalence had dropped to under 1 case per 10,000 people, prompting the World Health Organization (WHO) to declare that India had "eliminated [leprosy] as a public health problem". However, the government became complacent and allowed the folding of the leprosy surveillance programme into the general health system. Multi-drug treatment regimens also shortened the time for which patients remained formally registered, allowing prevalence to fall and transmission to continue. Disability due to leprosy began to rise in the early 2010s, prompting door-to-door screening. Today, the NSP is right to focus on cutting transmission, in line with WHO. Since India's children accounted for around 46% of all cases reported among children in 2025, the two programmes need to move in tandem. The drop in disease burden has also been highly uneven – Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, and Maharashtra bear disproportionate shares of the national burden. According to the 2025-26 National Leprosy Elimination Programme report, only 148 districts have achieved 'interruption of transmission' (pending field verification) against the projected 300.

In 2025-26, workers screened more than 70 crore people in highly endemic areas, where 24,367 cases were detected, and ASHA workers flagged nearly 40 lakh suspected cases, with 48,027 cases confirmed. Workers also administered single-dose rifampicin as post-exposure prophylaxis to 91.1% of those 16.9 lakh likely to have come in contact. The government has operationalised digital surveillance and is deliberating on using the MIP vaccine to accelerate pathogen clearance in patients deemed highly infectious. One persistent set of lacunae pertains to care: research has shown nerve damage in many patients by the time they sought care, largely due to the stigma, while many clinical practitioners are unfamiliar with leprosy's pathology or misdiagnose it as a skin condition. Reading these realities together, the state should double down on interrupting transmission and make prevalence a secondary outcome. It should also resist the temptation to ease detection or revise its elimination targets – the 2025-26 report says the overall incidence overshot projections by 41%, incidence among children by 91.6%, and the grade-2 disability rate by 34% – and instead redouble its investments to meet the extant 2026-27 projections. Finally, it should commit its augmented efforts at locations and social settings where both late diagnosis and transmission remain trenchant.

Twenty-five years of leadership, an India transformed

N. Chandrababu Naidu

The Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in leadership reflect India's transformation and its rising national ambitions

In my 48 years in public life, I have seen political parties rise and fall. I have seen leaders emerge with great promise and fade away. I have seen governments change, economies transform and technology alter our lives beyond recognition. One lesson has become increasingly clear to me: ultimately, leadership matters.

In today's world, technology, knowledge, capital and ideas are freely available. But the true differentiator for nations is leadership – one with vision, integrity, credibility and the ability to execute.

On October 7, 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi completes 25 uninterrupted years in executive office – first as Chief Minister of Gujarat and, since 2014, as the Prime Minister of India. It is a remarkable journey of leadership sustained by public trust. Through changing circumstances, Mr. Modi has remained remarkably consistent in his purpose: the development of India and the empowerment of its people.

The world around us has been turbulent. We have witnessed a global financial crisis, a once-in-a-century pandemic, wars, geopolitical realignments, technological disruption and economic uncertainty. Several democracies have experienced frequent changes of leadership and consequent policy uncertainty. Through all this, India has remained steady at the wheel and an oasis of economic hope.

Leadership built on trust

Such stable leadership cannot sustain itself for 25 years merely through politics. It requires trust. Mr. Modi has earned that trust through an established track record, impeccable personal integrity and tireless self-discipline. In today's world, public leaders effectively live in glass houses. Every decision and every action can be seen and questioned. To retain the confidence of people over decades under such scrutiny is an achievement in itself.

Mr. Modi brings a unique ability to understand people's aspirations, translate them into action and communicate those results back to the people.

The results are visible. Over the last decade, India's National Highway network has expanded from about 91,287 kilometres in 2014 to more than 1,46,000 km. The airport network has grown from 74 airports in 2014 to over 160. Railway electrification has accelerated dramatically. India's installed renewable-energy capacity has now reached nearly 296 GW, including large hydro, with solar alone crossing 168 GW. Infrastructure today is being conceived not as isolated projects but as an integrated national network through initiatives such as PM Gati Shakti (Prime Minister Gati Shakti – National Master Plan for Multi-Modal Connectivity).

At the same time, India's welfare architecture has expanded basic security and dignity. Around 80 crore people receive free foodgrains, including five kilograms a person per month for eligible priority households. Tapwater coverage in rural homes has risen from about 17% in 2019 to over 82%. An estimated 24.8 crore Indians moved out of multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23. The significance lies not only in the scale of these programmes, but in their reach. Technology has enabled the State to deliver basic entitlements more directly, transparently and at a scale that was once unimaginable.

Technology in nation-building

Mr. Modi has a deep appreciation of technology and its role in transforming India. He understands emerging technologies, adopts them early and, more importantly, applies them to nation-building. He sees technology as a tool to improve governance, empower people, create opportunities and accelerate development. India's Digital Public Infrastructure has shown how technology can democratise access to banking, welfare and public services at unprecedented scale. This deep appreciation of technology has enabled him to launch a host of frontier policies aimed at making India take a giant leap and put it in the league of global tech titans. India's quantum mission, semi-conductor mission, and a host of Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes across electronics and advanced manufacturing are instances of this vision.

India's space sector is another great example. For decades, India's extraordinary capabilities in space were centred overwhelmingly around government. By opening the sector to private enterprise and creating an enabling ecosystem, the government has unleashed a new generation of entrepreneurs. Companies such as Skyroot Aerospace, Pixxel, Agnikul, Dhruva and Bellatrix demonstrate what young Indians can achieve when regulation gives way to innovation.

As a Chief Minister first and then a Prime Minister, Mr. Modi has a strong belief in "Team India". He knows that India cannot be transformed from Delhi alone. Growth needs to be decentralised with States and cities competing. His emphasis on cooperative and competitive federalism has given States a larger role in India's development journey.

India's place in the world

In his tenure, India's stature abroad has also changed profoundly. Today, India's voice is heard with greater respect on global platforms. India protects its national interest while engaging with different centres of global power, preserves strategic autonomy while building deeper partnerships, and projects its civilisational confidence as a modern, technology-driven nation. India today is among the world's fastest-growing major economies. But I believe the most consequential phase of our journey is still ahead.

Few countries possess India's combination of strengths. It has a demographic dividend, an extraordinary entrepreneurial energy, technological capabilities and a young generation that is ambitious, confident and increasingly connected to global opportunity. If we make the right decisions now, the benefits will last for centuries. This is why leadership at this moment assumes historic importance.

Mr. Modi's 25 years in executive leadership have demonstrated the qualities such a moment demands. The Narendra Modi who became Chief Minister of Gujarat on October 7, 2001, and the Prime Minister leading India today are connected by the same clarity of purpose and unshakeable belief in India's potential.

Twenty-five years have established his record. The next 20 years can establish India's place in history. The true significance of these 25 years, however, will be judged by what they enable India to achieve next. Mr. Modi has shifted the country's development trajectory – from incrementalism to ambition, from hesitation to confidence, and from managing limitations to believing in possibilities. I am confident that the direction he has set and the institutional momentum created during these years will help India realise its ambition of Viksit Bharat 2047 and reclaim its place among the world's leading nations.

Few leaders are given the opportunity to shape a generation. Rarer still are those who can shape the destiny of a nation. After 25 years of leadership, Mr. Modi's greatest contribution may ultimately be that he made India believe once again in the scale of its own possibilities – and gave the nation the leadership to turn that belief into reality.

The China-U.S. rapprochement

Kevin Rudd

Global President and CEO of Asia Society, New York, and the 26th Prime Minister of Australia

There is no 'G-2' yet in U.S.-China relations -- Washington and Beijing may manage their tensions, but their strategic competition remains entrenched

The world, understandably, has been watching carefully the unfolding summitry between the United States and Chinese Presidents over the last several months. It had been a long time between drinks: just under a decade in the case of President Donald Trump's last visit to Beijing in late 2017; and just over a decade since President Xi Jinping stood on the White House lawns in 2015 with President Barack Obama.

Whereas now it is four summits in little more than six months: Beijing, Washington, Shenzhen and then Miami. Now it is everything, everywhere, all at once, with some speculating that we are seeing the birth of a new G-2.

More a new phase

It is natural for the world to wonder what, if anything, has fundamentally changed in the strategic architecture of the U.S.-China relationship. It is always hard to parse the difference between the language and theatre of politics and diplomacy, and what is actually happening on the ground.

Despite the pomp and circumstance in both the Beijing and Washington summits, the reality is that nothing much has changed in the fundamentals of the relationship. Whatever public language might be used, the U.S. and China remain fully engaged in an all-pervasive strategic competition on which of them will emerge as the dominant Indo-Pacific and then global power for the 21st century – militarily, in the economy, technology, foreign policy as well as the underlying ideological contest between democratic capitalism and China's alternative authoritarian model.

Whatever the diplomatic surround sound might be, core decision-makers in both Washington and Beijing continue to have a deeply realist view of this ongoing strategic contest – or what the Chinese Communist Party (CCP)has long called the "struggle for the future of the international order". Strategic competition is not going away. The real question is whether that competition can be managed within the framework of some mutually acceptable rules of the road. Or whether it is left unmanaged with a rolling risk of crisis, conflict or even war.

What the U.S. and China appear to be doing is moving towards an imperfect form of bilateral management mechanism. This process began in May last year with the regularisation of the political channel between U.S. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng. This followed the imposition of trade-destroying tariffs of 125% in April 2025 by Mr. Trump, which were then promptly matched by 125% from Mr. Xi. To preserve their respective national economic interests, both sides then walked back from the brink of a full trade war. Since then, Mr. Bessent, Mr. He and their teams have now met eight times – on average every two months. And after a tumultuous decade across every dimension of the relationship, the Bessent-He channel has indeed had a stabilising effect.

Beijing's push for stability

China in particular has sought stability as it moves into 2027. Later next year, the CCP convenes the 21st Party Congress when Mr. Xi will be appointed to a record fourth term as General Secretary and where he hopes to appoint a fresh phalanx of personal loyalists to the party's most senior positions. While Mr. Xi's authority remains unchallenged, he will want as benign a domestic economic environment as possible.

China's dilemma is that the domestic drivers of economic growth are performing poorly. Private domestic consumption is in the doldrums. Private residential construction is into its sixth year of recession. Private fixed capital investment is also flat-lining. That leaves public investment (i.e., China's gargantuan techno-industrial strategy) and net exports as the two primary pistons driving the Chinese growth engine.

The last thing Beijing wants is for the U.S. to resume a full-scale trade war which Mr. Trump is perfectly capable of doing. Just look at what he did in 2018 and in 2025. China therefore has been doubling down on its "stability narrative" with the U.S. Its new concept of "constructive strategic stability" is about maximising "cooperation", managing "competition within defined bounds", while also managing "strategic differences", which is code language for Taiwan. In China's conceptual universe, if these three pillars are properly attended to, then the cardinal objective is achieved: stability.

It is an elegant schemata. It is China's effort at "managed strategic competition" with the U.S. Moreover, the U.S. has formally accepted this framework in official readouts from the Beijing Washington Summits. But the U.S. has added the explicit caveat that any such bilateral framework be both "fair and reciprocal".

For Washington realists,that is enough to drive a bus through any "constructive strategic stability" narrative on any day of the week. Furthermore, Beijing would be wildly optimistic if it concluded that Donald Trump is likely to be constrained in his future freedom of manoeuvre because of some grand, overarching foreign policy narrative. The President just does not operate that way.

A fragile truce

What concerns China most is if what is called the "Busan Tariff Truce" agreed to last October falls apart. That original 12-month truce has only been extended two months. If the U.S. concludes that China has not been helpful on U.S. agricultural exports, or in the normalisation of the critical minerals and rare earths trade with the U.S., there is a real risk that the Busan Truce collapses. And if the European Union were to move in the same direction on tariffs given the crisis in European manufacturing, the consequences for an export-dependent Chinese economy would be large.

For all these reasons, both tactical and strategic, the U.S.-China relationship remains deeply fragile. Even if the Busan Truce extends beyond December, the effective general U.S. tariff rate against China will remain much, much higher than, for example, India's. Beyond trade, there also remains a formidable array of export controls on critical technologies, including world-class chips where China remains several years behind the U.S. And that leaves to one side a bilateral foreign investment regime which remains deeply restrictive at both ends of the relationship.

Therefore, breathless reporting about an emerging "G2" between the U.S. and China in some sort of global strategic condominium is fanciful. Whatever tactical accommodations may occur in the trade relationship, the fundamental nature of the strategic competition between Washington and Beijing continues. Remember it was Donald Trump, on the very eve of Mr. Xi's state visit to Washington DC, who stated, "Whoever wins in AI, wins." That is Xi Jinping's view too. That does not exactly sound like an emerging G-2 to me.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Transparency, poll trust

The Supreme Court of India's notice to the Election Commission of India over the "modified" Form 6 highlights a simple point: any change to voter registration must follow due legal procedure and be made public. Citizens providing correct details should be able to register without hurdles. Transparency in the Election Commission is essential to restoring public trust.

Sankalp Gupta,
Dhenkanal, Odisha

The Changes concerning voter registration and electoral rolls cannot be treated as routine administrative matters when they directly affect citizens' democratic rights. The Election Commission must ensure that every decision is transparent, accountable and supported by clear records. At the same time, allegations must be examined on the basis of evidence rather than assumption. Public confidence in elections ultimately depends on institutions being open to scrutiny.

Albin Thekkethala,
Kallur, Thrissur, Keralam

Medicine Nobel

Many of the most significant advances in medicine start with questions that appear to have nothing to do with the field. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine is a striking instance. This is something that India should take note of. Basic science requires patience, freedom, and continuous support — a question which seems unclear in a laboratory at the present time could end up forming the basis of tomorrow's medicine.

Dr. Yash Javeri,
Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address and the full name.

Why charging for UPI changes the math

Americai V. Narayanan

National Spokesperson of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), a certified public accountant (CPA) and a certified management accountant (CMA)

In the decade since its launch, India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has evolved from a promising digital experiment into critical economic infrastructure. Against this backdrop, the Union Finance Ministry has notified that the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) will operationalise a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on specified merchant transactions above ₹2,000 from October 15. While consumers will not be charged directly, this marks a significant departure from UPI's zero-MDR model for merchants. While the reasoning is understandable, considering the costs to run UPI, one question deserves an answer: what has UPI cost India, and what has it saved?

The costs are easy to see as servers, security and fraud controls show up on balance sheets, while the savings are scattered across the economy. For example, take a small shopkeeper. Before digital payments, taking cash meant counting notes, keeping change, guarding the till and making trips to the bank, with the added risk of theft. UPI removed most of that, with customers also saving themselves a few trips to the ATM. Further, banks now handle less physical cash, businesses reconcile accounts faster, lenders are able to read a small trader's cash flow from digital records, and most importantly, the government gets a trail that helps with formalisation and tax compliance. None of this is revenue to UPI; it is spread across banks, consumers and the exchequer.

The case for MDR is that the payments ecosystem needs a steady income to maintain and expand UPI, which is a fair point. Yet this logic assumes that most of UPI's cost should be recovered from the transactions on it; the wider benefits are not accounted for. Every payment that moves from cash to UPI cuts handling costs elsewhere while every merchant who joins adds to formalisation. Further, the increase in UPI users makes the network more useful to those already on it. India has acted on this logic before: the government approved ₹1,500 crore in 2024-25 alone to incentivise low-value merchant transactions, with the view that moving cash through digital networks was worth paying for.

Balancing benefits

On September 28, the Supreme Court, while declining to stay the levy, asked the Centre, the RBI and the NPCI to explain, on affidavit, the legal basis for the levy, including whether the MDR was a tax or a fee. In response, the government stated that nothing reaches the exchequer and that the money was a settlement between banks and service providers. This answers the legal question but not the economic one – what is India giving up?

Consider a highway between an industrial region and a port. A toll can be perfectly reasonable, but toll collections say little about the highway's real return, which is the faster movement of goods and the businesses that grow with it. A port is similar; while container fees pay for operations, its larger contribution is the trade that it enables. UPI also deserves the same lens. Any plan to recover its maintenance bill should ask what happens to the activity it supports once a toll is introduced. That calculation is largely missing from the MDR debate.

MDR might raise money that lets banks and payment providers invest more in resilience and expansion. But it would also lead to a change in behaviour. Some merchants may prefer cash for transactions while others may nudge customers towards a different payment instrument. When payments slip back to cash, the costs UPI had removed come back such as handling, reconciliation, cash logistics, and less digital visibility. Some of the formalisation gains go too. If ₹100 collected in MDR causes more than ₹100 of economic value to disappear elsewhere, the payment system ends up better funded and the country poorer.

Additionally, UPI and RuPay had helped India build a domestic payments ecosystem at the expense of global card networks. The USTR had earlier called India's zero-MDR policy a market-access barrier for Visa and Mastercard; these players now stand to gain from any drift back to cards. A lasting domestic advantage should not be conceded for trade terms that can later be revised.

A network that millions of Indians rely on has to be secure, resilient and able to grow. The harder question is what "self-sustaining" should mean. The test for the new toll should be straightforward: does it increase India's overall economic return from UPI after accounting for the behaviour it may change and the wider benefits the network creates? This is the question policymakers should answer.

If ₹100 collected in MDR causes more than ₹100 of economic value to disappear elsewhere, the payment system ends up better funded and the country poorer

Indian research can shape the world

K. VijayRaghavan

Former Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India and chairs Ashoka University's Science Advisory Council

Archish Mittal

Vice-President, Iron Pillar

People fret about the buses India has missed in its technological growth. The list is familiar: aircraft, advanced weapons, new materials, and biotechnology. In each, we look at what others built decades ago and ask why we did not. There is value in this introspection, and there is danger. The value is that it forces us to ask whether our systems can be streamlined and enabled. Catching up is not a bad thing. Much of the world's industrial history is a history of catching up. The danger is that catch-up-itis can become a habit. If our ambition is always defined by what someone else has already done, we will always arrive late, pay for licences and know-how, and build on foundations laid elsewhere. The costs of technological catch-up are a heavy burden, and they recur with every new wave.

There is a better question to ask, and it arises from a tectonic change in the relationship between science and technology. By science, we mean discovery, curiosity, the effort to explain the universe, and the development of abstract ideas in mathematics. By technology, we mean the development of tools that enable humans to transform the world. For much of history these were treated as separate enterprises, with technology following science at a distance, sometimes by a century.

However, over the past 50 years or so we have increasingly seen fundamental research and application sewn together at the hip. Much of our understanding of how genes are regulated came from studying viruses that infect bacteria. More recently, studying how bacteria defend themselves gave us CRISPR technology within just a few years, which has an extraordinary range of applications. Today, the distance and time from curiosity to application are short. This shift lets thinking and training lead, and it shows that investing in fundamental research will enable leading than playing catch-up. The bus we need to board is the next one, and it has not yet left.

Get on the bus first

For science from India to have global impact by developing transformative technologies, four things need to be addressed.

First, invest in high-quality education at scale. The features of AI that democratise access to learning allow us to reach millions of students poorly served by our moribund institutions, and to bypass those institutions where necessary. But learning science requires doing science. Hundreds of experimental "foundries" in engineering, physics, biology, chemistry and math should be created; places where young people work with real instruments on real problems.

Second, national laboratories need to be liberated from insularity. The bulk of our national labs are currently poorly accessible to researchers, students and companies outside their walls. This can easily change, benefiting both labs and universities. All national labs need to be organised around three zones: green for open interaction, amber for collaboration, and red for strategic work. Much of what India's labs do belong in the green and amber zones.

National laboratories need to be liberated from insularity. The bulk of our national labs are currently poorly accessible to researchers, students and companies outside their walls

Third is flexibility. Many say we are a low-trust society and that our regulators should trust our research system more and be more flexible. The response to this is to point out that trust is low because compliance with guidelines is poor, necessitating onerous rules. However, India does have many high-quality islands of excellence in universities, institutes and laboratories. These institutions do comply with the rules and regulations, and should be freed from the weight of General Financial Rules compliance, a weight few other countries place on their scientists. Accountability should be measured by outcomes, and not by procedure at every step. Flexibility can allow these institutions to leap ahead.

Fourth, our regulatory system still needs much reform. Approvals for research with biological materials and for clinical trials remain slow and unpredictable. The more hoops companies and researchers must jump through, the less likely small and medium-sized institutions are to succeed, since only those with deep pockets can afford the time and costs. Thus, high-quality, speedy regulation is important.

None of this is beyond us; they can be achieved step by step. Many are already doing so in pockets. What is missing is the decision to make those pockets the norm, and a few who dedicate themselves to this task. How long will it take to become a science-driven nation with global impact? If we improve just 10% in each sector, field, and every year, we will be nearly seven times better in 20 years.

Women are twice as likely to use public transport for work commute

Nearly 67% of all women who commuted to work relied on walking or buses or other public transport

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy
Gandla Sneha

The National Household Travel Survey (NHTS), which captures how people in India travel to the workplace, shows a clear gender divide in mobility and the modes used to travel to work. Data shows that women are twice as likely as men to commute to work using public transport such as buses or trains or on foot compared to men. Nearly 67% of all women who commuted to work relied on walking or buses or other public transport. This figure was only 33% for all men who commuted to work **(Chart 1)**. In rural areas, more than half of all women who were working walked to their workplaces. However, a large share of men were dependent on two-wheelers.

While two-wheelers remained a major mode of transport for both men and women in urban areas, women were not solely reliant on two-wheelers.

A Statewise analysis shows that the share of women walking to work rather than relying on buses was higher than the national average in the central and northeastern States, including M.P., U.P. and Bihar **(Chart 2)** signifying low public transport availability. In southern States such as Keralam, the gap between women taking buses in rural and urban areas reduced significantly.

While women in urban areas also rely on other means such as autos and cars, they still take slightly longer than men to commute to work. In at least 13 major States, a higher share of men commuted to work in around 30 minutes compared to women **(Chart 3)**.

The use of public transport reflects the cost of commuting too. Though women's expenditure on commute is lower than that of men in rural areas, the gap is reducing in urban areas **(Chart 4)**.

The commute divide

Data for the charts were sourced from the National Household Travel Survey conducted by the National Statistics Office (NSO). The survey was conducted between July 2025 and June 2026 covering 2,84,769 rural and 2,07,254 urban households. The analysis pertains only to the share of workers aged 15 and above and a trip is defined as travel covering a distance of more than 1 km

Chart 1: The share of men, women and persons using different modes of transport to commute to work. Figures in %

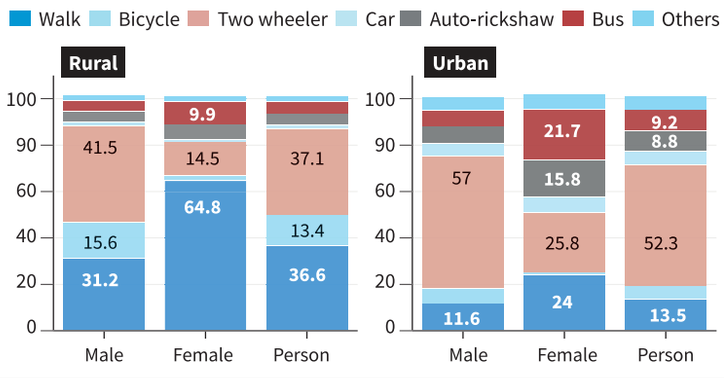
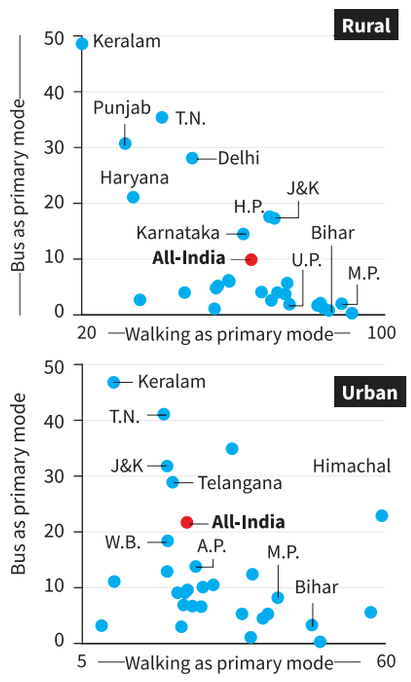


Chart 2: Share of women who either walked or used the bus as a primary mode of transport to commute to work. Data pertains to major States only. Figures in %



- *In States like M.P, U.P., Bihar and Chhattisgarh, rural women are overwhelmingly dependent on walking. For instance, in Madhya Pradesh, 88.7% of rural women walked and only 2.0% used the bus. This could signal either lack of access to public transport or proximity of workplaces*
- *In Keralam, only 20.1% of rural women walked, while 48.6% used the bus. This is the highest share of rural women using the bus for their commute in the country. In general, the share of women walking to work reduces in urban areas*

Chart 3: State-wise share of men and women who commute to work within 30 minutes. Figures in %

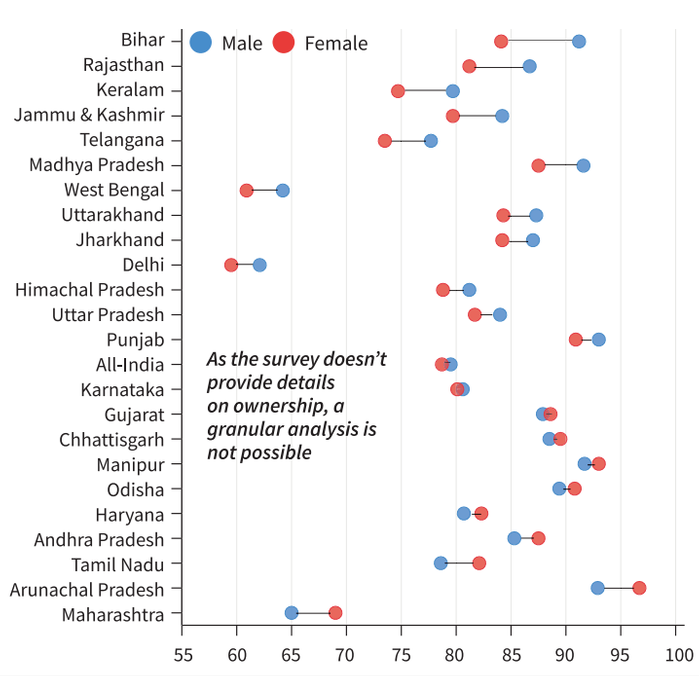
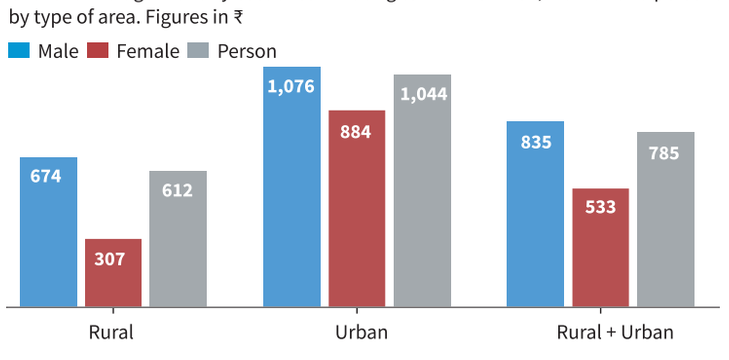


Chart 4: Average monthly cost of commuting to work for men, women and persons by type of area. Figures in ₹



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 7, 1976

'Aluminium conductors cause phone faults'

Hyderabad, October 6: Due to the extensive use of aluminium conductors, quite often "disconnection faults occur on the telephone lines", resulting in the telephones becoming 'dead', according to Mr. K.S. Krishnamurthy Rao, Sub-Divisional Officer, Telephones, at the Saifabad Exchange here.

In a paper presented at the seminar on "Improved Service to Telephone Users", organised by the Junior Engineers (Telcom) Association, Mr. Krishnamurthy Rao said an expert committee constituted by the Indian Post and Telegraphs Department had "discouraged" the use of aluminium conductors and suggested "reversion to copper". "If this is implemented, I am sure, we will be improving our services to a large extent", he said.

Presiding over the seminar, held at the Regional Telcom Training Centre on Abid Road, Prof Alladi Prabhakar, Head of Osmania University's Department of Electronics and Communication Engineering, called for an integrated telecommunication network which could deal not only with voice communication but also facsimile, video and other media. He emphasised the vital role of electronic switching in this regard.

In his paper, Mr. Krishnamurthy Rao observed that the maintenance aspect had not been forgotten by the department in the course of the vast expansion of telecommunication services.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 7, 1926

Fighting malaria in Indian plantations

London, October 6: Under the auspices of the Indian Tea Association, Sir Ronald Ross will leave for India on 29th October on board 'Rajpatanam'. He will travel to Calcutta via Malay States with the object of inspecting measures for the control of malaria, that are being carried out in the plantations in India and Malay States. While in Malay States, he will be the guest of Sir Watson. Sir Ronald Ross will unveil at Calcutta a commemorative tablet in his old laboratory at the Presidency General Hospital. He will also lecture at the Calcutta School of Tropical Medicine.

From Page One

Rahul calls SIR 'treason' as INDIA ups the ante

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav accused the ECI of working for the BJP. "Only BJP members can vote. BJP's workers can be India's citizens," he said, accusing the government of using multiple measures to "steal the mandate". Mr. Yadav accused the ECI of especially targeting the "*Pichde*, Dalit and *Alpsankhyak* (PDA)" (backward, Dalit and minorities). The acronym PDA is a rallying call for his party.

The march began at 10.30 a.m. from Makar Dwar of the Parliament, with the leaders carrying a banner reading: "Election Commission is compromised - Sack Gyanesh Kumar". At Akashvani Bhawan, after being stopped by police, the leaders sat down, raising slogans against Mr. Kumar and the government.

Delhi Police had barricaded all roads leading to Parliament amidst heavy security deployment. Around noon, the Delhi Police began bundling the leaders into buses, clearing the site. Mr. Akhilesh and Trinamool national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee, along with other prominent Opposition leaders, Mr. O' Brien and John Brittas, were detained and taken to the Parliament Street police station, where Samajwadi Party workers protested for about an hour.

At this point, Mr. Gandhi and a few other Congress leaders squeezed past private security personnel posted at the gates of Akashvani Bhawan to enter the building.

The National Students' Union of India and Youth Congress activists briefly barged through the gates of Akashvani Bhawan, storming the precincts. Delhi Police sent out buses to detain these activists. The detained Parliamentarians were taken to Kingsway Camp police station. They were released later at 10:15 pm. The INDIA bloc will hold another protest on Wednesday.

IceCube neutrino pioneer wins Nobel

The South Pole's ice has many advantages, as it is free from various types of interference and the area is geologically stable. Mr. Halzen's idea caught on and, just a few years later, preliminary testing was conducted on sensors in ice. IceCube covers an entire cubic kilometre (or about 917 million litres of water) and was completed in 2010. It has 5,160 optical sensors to detect the Cherenkov light produced by neutrino interactions, with its principal scientific focus on higher-energy astrophysical neutrinos. The Cherenkov light is the blue flash produced when a charged particle travels through a transparent medium faster than light can travel through that medium.

Researchers reported the first high-energy cosmic neutrinos in 2013 and, in 2018, traced one such neutrino to a distant blazar, a galaxy with a supermassive black hole at its centre that fires a jet of particles and radiation almost directly towards earth. "Francis Halzen has led an international team of researchers and engineers who have provided us with a fantastic instrument. His tenacity and scientific vision has paved the way for a new kind of astronomy," Mark Pearce, Chair of the Nobel Committee for Physics, said.

The neutrino interactions that are continuously collected by IceCube will provide researchers with knowledge about the violent settings in which high-energy neutrinos can be created – and could even reveal previously unknown cosmic phenomena, a statement added. "It was a great surprise and I obviously didn't expect it," Mr. Halzen told the Nobel Committee by phone from Italy, the *Associated Press* reported.

18 accused of sharing Navy data with Pakistan

Acting on a tip-off, the counter-intelligence police in Vijayawada registered a case under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, the Official Secrets Act, and sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, including Section 61(2) (criminal conspiracy).

Under "Operation Firewall-2026", 12 CIC teams were deployed to Andhra Pradesh, Keralam, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Goa, Delhi, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Bihar and Chhattisgarh.

The teams, in coordination with Navy officers, anti-terrorist squads, and the local police, conducted searches and examined the complicity of the 18 suspects, and seized electronic equipment from them.

Two held in espionage case

One of those arrested in connection with the case, Annam Sai Vara Prasad, a contract driver engaged for Naval officers, was picked up in Visakhapatnam. He is accused of having shared key information related to the Visakhapatnam Naval Base in return for money.

Another accused, identified as Pradeep Mukherjee, a naval employee at the Visakhapatnam Naval Base, was arrested in Coimbatore earlier. He is accused of having shared an OTP for the activation of a WhatsApp account for a Pakistani intelligence operative and of having passed on sensitive information relating to defence establishments.

Both men were produced in court on Monday, after which they were sent to Visakhapatnam Jail under judicial custody until October 14.

According to investigators, women intelligence operatives from Pakistan are suspected of having approached the accused using fake profiles on various social media sites.

Bypolls held in five Assembly segments, one Lok Sabha seat

Highest voter turnout of 86% in T.N.'s Madurantakam seat; West Bengal CEO got 97 official complaints on polling day; Congress seeks cancellation of Bengal bypolls due to 'booth capturing'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Bypolls were held on Tuesday in five Assembly seats in Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, and Puducherry, and one Lok Sabha seat in Assam. The Madurantakam Assembly constituency in Tamil Nadu recorded the highest polling percentage of 86.26%.

The other Assembly seat which went to the polls in Tamil Nadu was Dharapuram, which saw a turnout of just over 80%. Both seats in the State were reserved for Scheduled Caste candidates.

The byelections to these two seats were necessitated by the resignations of Magaratham Kumaravel from Madurantakam (SC) and P. Sathyabama from Dharapuram (SC), who both won on All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) tickets in the 2026 State election and subsequently switched to the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) after resigning their Assembly memberships within three weeks in May 2026.

In Puducherry, where the bypoll was held in the Thattanchavady Assembly segment, there was 80.8% voting. The election was caused by the resignation of AINRC chief and Chief Minister N. Rangasamy, who retained the Mangalam Assembly seat.

As West Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari vacated one seat to retain another, bypolls were needed seat Nandigram seat. RITU RAJ KONWAR

In West Bengal, where bypolls were held in the Nandigram and Rejinagar Assembly seats, there was a voter turnout of almost 80%. In the State, many people are awaiting a decision on their inclusion in the electoral roll as their appeal is with the Appellate Tribunals.

Voter polling trends till 5:30 p.m. showed Nandigram at 79.4% and Rejinagar at 78.4%. West Bengal's Chief Electoral Officer received 97 official complaints through designated portals on the polling day.

The bypolls were needed as West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari won two seats and then vacated Nandigram to retain Bhabanipur, where he had defeated former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee. Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) MLA Humayun Kabir, had also won in both Rejinagar and Nowda in Murshidabad, later giving up the Rejinagar seat.

Poll irregularities

Nearly 19,000 members of the electorate from these two seats who could not vote in the last Assembly election were also unable to exercise their franchise in the bypolls. Their names were put under adjudication, and still remain in that state. Congress State president Subhankar Sarkar submitted a memorandum to the West Bengal CEO office, asking for the bypolls in Nandigram and Rejinagar to be cancelled, calling for repolling to take place. West Bengal Congress leaders have made allegations of voter intimidation, booth capturing, proxy voting, and EVM malfunctioning.

About 76% of 19.05 lakh electors voted in the byelection held in Assam's Nagaon Lok Sabha constituency, which was necessitated after Pradyut Bordoloi, who won the constituency for the second successive term in 2024, quit the Congress to contest and win the Dispur Assembly seat on a BJP ticket.

Though 15 candidates are contesting in the Nagaon Lok Sabha seat, which comprises eight Assembly segments in Morigaon and Nagaon districts, the contest is expected to be primarily among the BJP's Devasish Sharma, the Congress's Sibamoni Bora, and the All India United Democratic Front chief Mohammed Badruddin Ajmal.

'Provisional Census data expected to be out by March-April'

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Amit Sharma

The provisional data for Population Census 2027 will be available by March or April next year, according to Amit Sharma, Chief Principal Census Officer and Director of Census Operations for Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh.

Ladakh became the first of India's Union Territories and States to complete the entire Census exercise, ahead of the rest of the country where the exercise is scheduled to finish in February 2027. This is the first digital Census and the first in independent India to enumerate caste, other than Scheduled Castes and Tribes.

Advance enumeration

Other than Ladakh, the second phase or Population Enumeration (PE) phase also concluded in the snow-bound areas of Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, and Jammu and Kashmir on September 30, with a revisional round from October 1 to 5.

On September 5, the PE phase was advanced in the poll-bound States of Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand, and Goa, scheduled to take place from November 16, 2026 to January 4, 2027, ahead of the nationwide enumeration planned for February 2027. The Union government also formally deferred the Census exercise in conflict-ridden Manipur "till further declaration," Mr. Sharma said.

Snow-bound areas

Mr. Sharma said that provisional data from the PE phase shows that 5,292 enumeration blocks have been covered in the designated snow-bound areas of J&K (4,597 blocks) and Ladakh (695 blocks).

The snow-bound enumeration was preceded by a self-enumeration window from August 17 to 31, followed by field enumeration from September 1 to 30.

Mr. Sharma said the completion of the exercise was an important operational milestone and involved specialised arrangements because of the difficult terrain and climatic conditions.

SC to hear Punjab's plea against CBI probe linked to CM's office

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to urgently hear the Punjab government against a State High Court order directing the Central Bureau of Investigation to register a case and probe allegations of corruption against the office of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann.

Appearing before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocates Vikas Singh and Shadan Farasat, for the State government, said the order violated the very basic principles of federalism. Mr. Singh said the State was poll-bound, and a Central agency has been ordered to investigate allegations.

Bhagwant Mann

Mr. Singh said the allegations regard administrative matters but the High Court has ordered a criminal case to be registered.

The Chief Justice said the court would endeavour to list the case for hearing in the next 24 hours or definitely hear it on October 8. The High Court had, on October 5, directed the CBI to probe corruption allegations linked to Chief Minister Mann's office. The allegations raised by the Enforcement Directorate against individuals linked to the Aam Aadmi Party government include corruption in transfers and postings, policy manipulation, cash for tenders, and other serious irregularities.

CBI probe

Pronouncing its order on a public interest litigation case, a Division Bench said that, on a cumulative assessment of the material placed on record in the petition, the court was of the view that a fair and transparent investigation was required into the issue.

Expressing dissatisfaction with the Punjab Police's handling of the case, the High Court entrusted the probe to the CBI.

Supreme Court gets three new judges, strength goes up to 37

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Three new Supreme Court judges took oath on Tuesday, raising the working strength to 37 even as case pendency hovers near one lakh. Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant administered the oath of office to Justices Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar Upadhyay and Aparesh Kumar Singh at the Supreme Court.

The three judges were sworn in a day after the Centre notified their appointments. The Supreme Court Collegium had recommended their names to the government on September 28.

The appointment of the new judges has increased the number of working judges in the apex court to one short of its sanctioned judicial strength of 38, including the CJI.

CJI Surya Kant administers oath of office to newly appointed SC judge Sunita Agarwal during a swearing-in ceremony. PTI

Justice Agarwal was serving as the Gujarat High Court Chief Justice before her appointment to the Supreme Court. The parent High Court of the judge is Allahabad. Justice Upadhyay's parent High Court is also Allahabad though he was serving as the Delhi High Court Chief Justice at the time of his recommendation.

Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh, whose parent High Court is Jharkhand, was serving as Chief Justice of the Telangana High Court before being appointed to the Supreme Court.

Man held over fake video of Delhi ACP with woman

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police have arrested an 'independent journalist' for creating and circulating a fabricated video that allegedly falsely portrayed Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat in an objectionable situation with a woman.

This comes a day after 17 protesters, including a woman journalist who had accused Mr. Bhagat of sexually harassing her during the October 3 protest in Delhi, were arrested by the Delhi Police. The Parliament Street police had booked the protesters on charges of unlawful assembly.

Police said the fabricated video was circulated through an Instagram account. The account was traced to 24-year-old Nadeem Ahmed Ameen, who has been arrested.

Privilege vs free speech case in SC disposed of after two decades

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The seven-judge Bench disposed of the long-pending reference in less than half-an-hour

After a pendency of well over 20 years in the Supreme Court, a seven-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant took less than half-an-hour on Tuesday to dispose of as infructuous a reference related to questions linked to legislative privilege being used to choke free speech, arising out of a 2003 Tamil Nadu Assembly resolution to arrest editors of *The Hindu* for an editorial criticising then Chief Minister Jayalalithaa.

The Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant found no point in going for lengthy hearings after learning from the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly counsel, senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, that the resolution against the newspaper had been withdrawn in 2004.

The Constitution Bench said the withdrawal of the resolution escaped the notice of the Supreme Court.

On the petitioners' suggestion, the Court left the larger and substantial questions of law open for a future occasion in an appropriate case.

On October 5, the very eve of the Constitution Bench hearing, Mr. Ramachandran, backed by Attorney General of India R. Venkataramani and Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, had brought the fact of the withdrawal to the attention of Chief Justice of India.

Mr. Ramachandran had submitted that the fact of the withdrawal was not noticed by the court nor recorded in its order referring the case to the seven-judge Bench a couple of months ago in August. He had said the reference would only be an academic exercise now.

Chief Justice Kant had said the court did not want to get into a prolonged academic exercise, particularly when several other part-heard matters were pending.

The case goes back to 2003 when *The Hindu* had published the editorial, prompting the Assembly Speaker at the time to pass a resolution in the House accusing the daily of having "distorted the proceedings of the Assembly, commented contrary to the events in the Assembly".

The resolution had said the comments made in the editorial "amounts to breach of privilege of the entire House" under Article 194 of the Constitution, which guarantees freedom of speech and immunities to Members of State legislatures.

Govt. inks pact with BrahMos Aerospace

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Defence Ministry on Tuesday signed a ₹661.50-crore contract with BrahMos Aerospace Private Limited (BAPL) for procurement of BrahMos Fire Control Systems and launchers for Indian Navy ships, aimed at strengthening the Navy's maritime strike capability and advancing defence indigenisation.

The Ministry said the contract, signed in New Delhi in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, has been placed under the Buy (Indian-IDDM) category, with a minimum of 68% indigenous content.

The project is expected to encourage greater participation of the Indian defence industry, including micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs), and generate employment over a period of three years, the Ministry said.

APPEAL

Baby Jeevith Sai is 1 year old advised to undergo Intra Cardiac Repair Surgery at Public Health Centre, Chennai. The surgery cost is **Rs.2,00,000/-**. Baby's father deserted the family. Mother finds it very difficult to meet the treatment cost. Please help this child to have a bright future. The donations sent through Ch/D.D/NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, A/c No. 60182010063310, IFSC No: CNRB0016018) favouring **WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT. Your mail id is requested.

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WWS

Rally call: Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others during the march in Delhi. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

In ground zero: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge joins the march demanding CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. ANI

Standing together: Opposition MPs Mahua Moitra, Supriya Sule and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra raising slogans. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Forcibly removed: Congress MP K.C. Venugopal being detained by police personnel after the sit-in at Akashvani Bhavan. PTI

Daylong protest: Rahul dominates airwaves from Akashvani Bhavan

After police appeared to have broken up the Opposition's march against the ECI, the Leader of the Opposition improvised by turning the campus of the broadcasting house into the unlikely centre of an all-day sit-in that lasted well past sunset

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Locked in: Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and others during the sit-in at Akashvani Bhavan in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

It looked as though the protests were winding down around noon on Tuesday, as buses packed with protesting MPs trundled away from Akashvani Bhavan in the national capital after nearly two hours of sloganeering.

Only Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi had another idea. "This can't end here," Mr. Gandhi told his colleagues. "Where is Priyanka [Gandhi]? Where is Akhilesh [Yadav]?" he asked. Both leaders had been packed into buses by the police.

Many Congress MPs, along with Ms. Gandhi, got down from the buses they had been packed into. But the bus carrying Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, which also had Trinamool Congress's Abhishek Banerjee, CPI(M)'s John Brittas and others, had already left the site.

Mr. Gandhi first proposed that the remaining group march to India Gate and tried walking back towards Parliament, away from the barricades, only to be told that all roads were blocked. So, he turned back.

Squeezed into premises

In front of Akashvani Bhavan, he spotted staffers who had spent two hours standing on the parapet wall and watching the protest unfold. Mr. Gandhi waved at them and then, without any warning, waded into the crowd and headed for the narrow pedestrian gate of the complex. He squeezed his way into the premises.

A few Congress MPs managed to follow. Others, including senior leaders K.C. Venugopal and Pawan Khera, were initially stopped at the gate and stood at the grills before the Delhi Police, after some discussion, allowed them to join Mr. Gandhi.

Around 2.30 p.m., a large group of Indian Youth Congress (IYC) and National Students' Union of India (NSUI) activists descended on Akashvani Bhavan. Catching the heavily deployed police personnel by surprise, the activists charged at the iron gates, with many managing to run into the campus. The police reacted swiftly, slamming the gates shut, this time with the activists inside. Buses soon arrived to detain them.

One young activist clambered onto the roof of a police bus and waved an NSUI flag. He was later pulled down by a Delhi Police officer. The buses eventually cleared the premises of the activists.

Meanwhile, Mr. Gandhi and a small group of Congress leaders continued their sit-in under a banyan tree.

By evening, with Mr. Gandhi and the Congress leadership refusing to budge, more leaders joined in. Trinamool Congress leaders Derek O'Brien and Mahua Moitra, who had been bundled away by the police earlier, returned to the site.

Around 8 p.m., the Delhi Police finally moved to clear the campus. Officers first removed the leaders gathered around Mr. Gandhi one by one. Finally, Mr. Gandhi himself was dragged towards a minibus. He resisted throughout, at one point even attempting to wriggle out through a window.

In videos later shared by the Congress, leaders detained at the Kingsway Camp police station could be seen raising slogans.

Opposition MPs' demand for meeting at Parliament Annexe 'unusual', says ECI

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

As the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), led by Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, sat on a more than eight-hour dharna on Tuesday, the Election Commission of India (ECI) said that the Opposition parties had demanded a meeting with the full Commission at a venue outside the ECI premises, which was "unusual" and therefore "could not be accepted".

The ECI said it had offered to send its seniormost officer on duty to the proposed meeting venue to receive the memorandum of the protesting MPs, which in itself would have been an "unprecedented" step. However, this offer was also declined by the protesting leaders.

> Till 4.00 p.m. today, no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment for a meeting with the Election Commission
> **ECI STATEMENT**

'Learnt through media'

In an official statement issued after Mr. Gandhi was detained from his protest site inside Akashvani Bhavan, the headquarters of All India Radio in the national capital, the poll body said it had learnt through the media till 4 p.m. that some MPs wished to meet the Commission along with their delegation during a march by certain political parties towards the ECI.

"With regard to today's developments, it is clarified that, till 4.00 p.m. today, no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment for a meeting with the Election Commission," it said.

However, at around 4.00 p.m., information was received from the Delhi Police that a delegation of MPs, led by Mr. Gandhi, wished to meet the Commission and submit a memorandum.

Following this, when the Election Commission was considering the request, it was informed by the Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP), Delhi Police, that the delegation comprised 240 MPs and that the proposed venue was the Parliament House Annexe.

ECI protocol

"The Election Commission considered this request as unusual and therefore, could not be accepted, as, in accordance with ECI protocol, such meetings are held only on the premises of the Election Commission of India," the statement said.

The ECI said it instead offered to send its seniormost officer on duty to receive the memorandum, but the offer was rejected by the Opposition MPs.

The statement further said that in 2025, the ECI had laid down a procedure for meetings with political parties. All political parties had been informed of the same.

Under the procedure, whenever a delegation of a political party or a joint delegation of several parties wishes to meet the Commission, it seeks an appointment through its duly authorised representative. The meeting is thereafter held at a time mutually agreed upon, the poll body said.

Rahul's protest is a 'political drama', claims made by Congress are lies: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Describing the Congress-led protests against the special intensive revision (SIR) as a "political drama" staged by the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Tuesday accused him and the Congress of "lying" to mislead the people.

The Election Commission of India's (ECI) formal statement on the issue exposed their claims, it said.

At a late-evening press conference, BJP MP and spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi cited the ECI statement to assert that the poll panel did not receive any request from either the Congress party or any other constituent of the INDIA bloc for a meeting.

'No genuine intention'

He alleged that the sequence of events demonstrated that the Congress leaders had no genuine intention to meet the Commission, but only to create a "political spectacle".

Questioning the claim about the number of MPs at the protest, Mr. Trivedi said the Congress had 99 MPs in the Lok Sabha and 30 in the Rajya Sabha, and the Samajwadi Party had 37 MPs, who, he said, were not at the protest site in the evening. He said the Trinamool MPs were also absent, while the DMK and the Aam Aadmi Party stayed away.

"It is very clear that the entire exercise was carried out to turn democracy into a monarchy, while wearing the mask of democracy, and to establish that very monarchy," said Mr. Trivedi.

The BJP leader said the sit-in by Mr. Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and their party colleagues at Akashvani Bhavan reflected the "same mindset of the Congress that does not accept democracy".

Mr. Trivedi questioned at whose behest the Congress "continued to level allegations despite being repeatedly proven wrong".

Left off poll rolls, 4 West Bengal men detained for a month in Chhattisgarh

Senjuti Sengupta
MURSHIDABAD

Family members of the four migrant workers who have been lodged at the Chhattisgarh detention centre. SPECIAL ARRAGEMENT

The Chhattisgarh Police have detained four migrant workers from Murshidabad, West Bengal over suspicion of being Bangladeshi nationals, after their names were deleted from the voters' list during the recent special intensive revision (SIR) exercise.

They have been lodged at a detention centre in Raipur for over a month despite reportedly being long-time Indian residents.

Late in August, at least 23 migrant workers, including the four persons Sabir Sheikh (42), Safikul Islam (39), Nasiruddin Sheikh (35), and Laltu Sheikh (28) from Samserganj and Sahabad areas of Murshidabad, went to Chhattisgarh in search of work. On September 4, the Chhattisgarh Police detained 23 persons from their residences in Chunchiapara-Ganesh Nagar on suspicion of being Bangladeshi nationals. They were taken to a holding centre in Raipur for illegal immigrants.

Nineteen of them were released on September 18 after a local court passed an order while these four men continued to be lodged at the detention centre. The police, in court, questioned their nationality based on the deletion of their names in the SIR exercise. Interestingly, the rest of the 19 persons found their names back on the voters list after the adjudication process.

"I have been staying in Samserganj since my childhood. Our old house was a century old, as my great-grandfather had probably built it. After it was washed away due to soil erosion, we set up our new residence in 1973. How could my son be a Bangladeshi?" said Safikul's father, the 67-year-old Riyajul Sheikh.

They have appealed before the tribunal seeking restoration of their names.

The family members have also filed a petition in the Calcutta High Court seeking their release.

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Managing Director

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The TGTransco invites online Bids under e-procurement for supply of the following Equipment's: **1. Tender Specification No.**TGPMM11-36/26, Description of Equipment:. 33kV CTs (2000-1000-600/1-1-1)A. **2. Tender Specification No.** TGPMM25-35/2026, **Description of Equipment:** Supply of 50MVA 220/33kV Power Transformers.
Bidders/Tenderers can have further details and download the tender schedule from e-procurement market place i.e., www.tender.telangana.gov.in. Contact Nos.: CE/P&MM, Phone: 040-23396000 (Extn.: 3670/3583/3460/3521/3334/3276/3522), Fax No. 040-2330376, www.tgtransco.com
DIPR R.O. No. 624-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Sd/- Chief Engineer/P&MM

OFFICE OF THE PRINCIPAL & CONTROLLER
RUHS COLLEGE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES,
Sector – 11, Kumbha Marg, Pratap Nagar, Jaipur - 302033
Ph. : 0141-2795624, 634 Email : principalruhscms@ruhsraj.org
No. :- F. ( ) RUHS CMS/Store/2026-27/8159 Date :- 01/10/2026
Notice Inviting E-Bids
राज. स्वा.वि.वि. आयुर्विज्ञान महाविद्यालय में NICU/PICU/ICU के लिए कार्य की प्रकृति के आधार पर उच्च कुशल एवं अर्द्धकुशल मैनपावर (नर्स ग्रेड-II एवं वार्ड अटेण्डेण्ट) सेवाओं के उपापन हेतु दर संविदा हेतु (कुल अनुमानित लागत राशि रू. 2,00,000,00/-) दिनांक 22/10/2026 को अपरान्ह 02.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। अधिक विवरण के लिए वेबसाईट Website sppp.raj.nic.in or eprocrajasthan.gov.in or www.ruhscms.org का अवलोकन करें।
UBN:- CMS2627SLOB00062
Raj.Samwad/C/26/11337 Principal

Office Of Superintending Engineer
PHED Circle Jhalawar (Rajasthan)
NOTICE INVITING Bid No. 23/2026-27 Item No. 1-A to 1-C
Bids for Annual Rate contract for Construction & commissioning of 200 mm dia tube wells with submersible pump sets etc. complete work in all types of strata & laying, jointing, testing, commissioning of HDPE pipe line including defect liability period of PANCHAYAT SAMITI AKLERA, MANOHARTHANA, JHALARAPATAN, KHANPUR, BAKANI, BHAWANI MANDI, DAG & PIRAEA of PHED Division Jhalawar/ Bhawani Mandi, District Jhalawar (With Material Complete) are invited from interested bidders upto 15.10.2025 at 18.00 Hours. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the www.dipr.rajasthan.gov.in, http://rajwater.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in and http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in. Departmental websites.
NIB No. PHE2627A2840
UBN No. PHE2627WSRC06010, PHE2627WSRC06011, PHE2627WSRC06013
Superintending Engineer
DIPR/C/17083/2026 PHED Circle Jhalawar

KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka Enterprises)
CIN : U85110KA1970SGC001919
No.KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4878 Date: 03.10.2026
ABSTRACT BID NOTIFICATION
(Through KPP Portal only) (Two Cover System)
KPCL invites bids through GoK KPP Portal Platform https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in from the qualified bidders for the following scope of work.
"Design, Engineering, Manufacture, quality surveillance, inspection & testing at manufacturer's works, supply, packing, forwarding, transportation to site, unloading storage, preservation, handling, insurance, dismantling of existing Platen Super Heater (PLSH), Re-heater (RH) & Final Super Heater (FSH) coil assemblies, erection, testing and commissioning of new PLSH, RH & FSH coil assemblies along with connected accessories, including hydraulic testing & steam blowing, for the 210 MW Unit-1 Boiler at Raichur Thermal Power Station of KPCL". Last Date and Time for submission Tender : 03.11.2026 at 17:00 hours.
Further details can be had form: Chief Engineer (Thermal Designs), KPCL, No.3, 2nd Floor, Green Building, (Drug Controller Office Premises), Palace Road, Bengaluru-560 001. Mobile: 9480682537, E-mail: kpclcetd@gmail.com, cetdkpcl@gmail.com, cetdeerm@gmai.com Website: https://kpcl.karnataka.gov.in

INBRIEF

Railway Board tells officials to maintain cleanliness on trains

Following repeated passenger complaints regarding poor upkeep, dirty bio-toilets, and unhygienic coach conditions on long-distance routes, the Railway Board has stepped in with strict directives to overhaul cleanliness standards. In a letter sent to all railway zones, the Railway Board directed focused, end-to-end monitoring measures for long-distance services, moving away from brief clean-ups at originating stations to sustained upkeep throughout the journey. "As part of the first phase, 11 high-priority trains with journey times exceeding 40 hours have been identified for enhanced oversight," a Railways official said.

DRDO's high-altitude platform clears trial without a hitch

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) has successfully carried out the flight trial of an indigenously developed High-Altitude Platform (HAPS), with the experimental platform reaching an altitude of 21 km above mean sea level and remaining at 20 km for more than 30 minutes. The Defence Ministry said the platform, developed by the Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment, Agra, was a lighter-than-air system being designed as a long-endurance stratospheric aerial surveillance platform.

Centre to propose 5-pronged GST reform plan tomorrow

The proposals are aimed at easing administrative bottlenecks in the GST system and reducing compliance burden, especially for small businesses; they will be discussed at the council meeting

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Centre will propose a five-pronged plan for the next set of reforms to the Goods and Services Tax (GST) system at the upcoming GST Council meeting on Thursday, according to sources in the Union Finance Ministry.

These reforms are aimed at automating and easing a lot of the current administrative bottlenecks in the GST system, and reducing the compliance burden, especially for small businesses. Rates, including the GST on the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, will not be on the agenda.

The five-pronged proposal covers process reforms, structural reforms, ease of living and doing business, exports of services, and e-commerce.

Some of the key changes proposed involve automatic invoice matching between buyers and sellers, reducing paperwork around claiming input tax credits (ITC), reducing the number of times small taxpayers have to file returns, and removing multi-state registrations for small businesses looking to sell across the country.

Reform proposal

The five-pronged plan aims at automating and easing administrative bottlenecks in the GST system

FOCUS ON:
- Process reforms
- Structural reforms
- Ease of living and doing business
- Export of services
- E-commerce

- Key beneficiaries will be small businesses, inter-State businesses, and service exporters
- The proposals will be discussed at the GST Council meeting and, if approved, will be implemented in a staggered manner

Relief measures

The Centre will be sharing a concept note with the States on allowing small taxpayers who supply only to consumers to file their returns once a year instead of once a month as is currently the case.

Another major demand of service providers is to widen the net of what constitutes an export.

At the moment, providing a service to a foreign client through a branch abroad is not counted as an export of service. The Centre is proposing to amend this to categorise such business as an export.

The proposals are to be discussed at the GST Council meeting and, if approved, will be implemented in a staggered manner to give businesses time to adapt to the new systems.

Easing of processes

At the moment, 61% of taxpayers receive their GST registration within three working days without the need for a tax officer's involvement, an official in the Finance Ministry said. The Centre will now propose a streamlining of processes for the remaining taxpayers so as to avoid "unnecessary queries" and avoid rejections.

Further, the Centre will propose an upgrade of the existing invoice management system to match invoices in such a manner that corrections and changes made to an invoice by the seller are recorded at each step and automatically reflected in the buyer's invoice.

"This would avoid a large number of notices issued to taxpayers due to invoice mismatches," the official explained. "The aim is to reduce these mismatch notices to zero."

Credits and refunds

Businesses complain that their input tax credits are often held up from being credited to their accounts because their suppliers have not filed their returns. The Centre is now trying to address this issue. "A buyer who holds the invoice, has received the goods and has paid his supplier in full, including the tax, should keep their credit," the official said. "It should not depend on whether someone further up the chain has paid or not," he added.

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit appointed next Indian Air Force chief

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit has been appointed the next Chief of the Air Staff, the Defence Ministry announced on Tuesday.

He is currently the Vice-Chief of the Air Staff and will take over the top post on October 31, succeeding Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, who retires on the same day.

Air Marshal Dixit will be the 29th Chief of the Air Staff. A fighter pilot with nearly four decades of service, he has more than 3,500 hours of flying experience on a range of aircraft, including the Mirage-2000, MiG variants, Jaguar, IL-78, Hawk, and Tejas, the Ministry said.

Key operations

Commissioned into the fighter stream of the Indian Air Force on December 6, 1986, Air Marshal Dixit has held several key operational and staff appointments.

Before taking over as Vice-Chief of the Air Staff, he served as Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman, Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC) at Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff and as Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Central Air Command. During his career, he has commanded a frontline fighter airbase in the Western Sector and a fighter training base in the Southern Sector.

He has also been involved in several operations and exercises, including Operation Safed Sagar, Operation Rakshak, and Operation Sindoor.

He is an alumnus of the National Defence Academy; Defence Staff Service College, Bangladesh; and National Defence College.

He was awarded the Vayu Sena Medal in 2006, Vishisht Seva Medal in 2011, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2023 and Param Vishisht Seva Medal in 2026 for his service.

More than half of overnight travel is by bus: NSO survey

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The survey found that 70.2% of overnight household trips are for social, communication, and religious purposes. FILE PHOTO

Buses are used significantly more than trains for overnight travel in India, with more than half of all household overnight journeys undertaken by bus, according to the country's first-ever National Household Travel Survey released by the National Statistics Office (NSO) on Monday.

The survey found that 55.8% of overnight household journeys are undertaken by bus, compared with 17.7% by inter-city railways. Railway use is significantly higher among urban households.

About 22.7% of urban households use rail for overnight journeys, compared with around 14% of rural households.

The survey found that 70.2% of overnight household trips are for social, communication, and religious purposes.

The pattern changes sharply when it comes to daily travel to work. Two-wheelers are the dominant mode of transport for workers, accounting for 42.6% of journeys. Their share rises to 52.3% among urban workers, compared with 37.1% in rural areas.

Public transport has a much smaller share of daily workforce mobility nationally. Buses account for just 6.7% of work trips.

Urban workers spend substantially more, at ₹1,044 a month, compared with ₹612 for rural workers. The survey also highlights a gender disparity in workforce mobility. While 61.9% of male workers undertake work-related trips of more than one kilometre, the corresponding share for women is only 41.9%.

There is also a gender gap in commuting expenditure: male workers spend an average of ₹835 a month, compared with ₹533 for female workers. The National Household Travel Survey, conducted between July 2025 and June 2026, covered 4,92,023 households.

Union Cabinet passes resolution hailing PM on 25 years of service

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Narendra Modi

The Union Cabinet on Tuesday passed a resolution congratulating Prime Minister Narendra Modi on completing 25 years of continuous leadership as head of government.

The resolution traced how Mr. Modi carried Gujarat's initiatives to the national stage.

It listed initiatives aimed at empowering women, encouraging startups, expanding opportunities for youth, supporting farmers and vulnerable tribal communities, also noting that over 25 crore people had been lifted out of poverty.

The resolution flagged Mr. Modi's push for reforms "despite political risks", referring to the GST and other measures.

"The resolution highlights Mr. Modi's ability to give India direction through global upheaval. During COVID, he united the country, backed domestic vaccine development and enabled rapid vaccination.

During the West Asia crisis, timely decisions and energy security measures helped India withstand disruption," said a government release. It said that the 2016 surgical strikes, 2019 Balakot air strikes and 2025 Operation Sindoor illustrated the national security red lines established under Mr. Modi.

'There is no one-size-fits-all approach to climate action'

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Bhupendra Yadav

Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav has called for equal attention to adaptation, mitigation, and means of implementation as the world heads towards the United Nations Climate Change Conference, or COP31 Summit, in Antalya in Türkiye in November.

The principles of equity and Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC) must be upheld "in letter and spirit," Mr. Yadav said.

Addressing the Leaders' Plenary in Fiji, where he is leading India's delegation to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change's (UNFCCC) pre-COP31 meetings, Mr. Yadav said there could be no "one-size-fits-all" pathway to climate action.

Local studies and assessments, he said, were key to identifying emerging challenges, mitigation and adaptation measures, and the resources needed, a press statement from the Environment Ministry said.

The talks in Nadi, Fiji, and on the atoll nation of Tuvalu, co-hosted by Australia, Fiji and Tuvalu, are a precursor to the COP31 in Türkiye.

Shared knowledge

Referring to India's long coastline and islands, Mr. Yadav said the country understood the challenges of Pacific Island countries.

Institutions such as the Indian Space Research Organisation, the National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management, and the National Centre for Coastal Research had built expertise in coastal vulnerability assessment, shoreline change mapping, marine spatial planning, and integrated coastal management.

India also uses space-based Earth observation for shoreline monitoring, inundation assessment, cyclones, extreme weather early warning, and climate risk assessment, Mr. Yadav said, and offered to share this knowledge with Pacific partner countries.

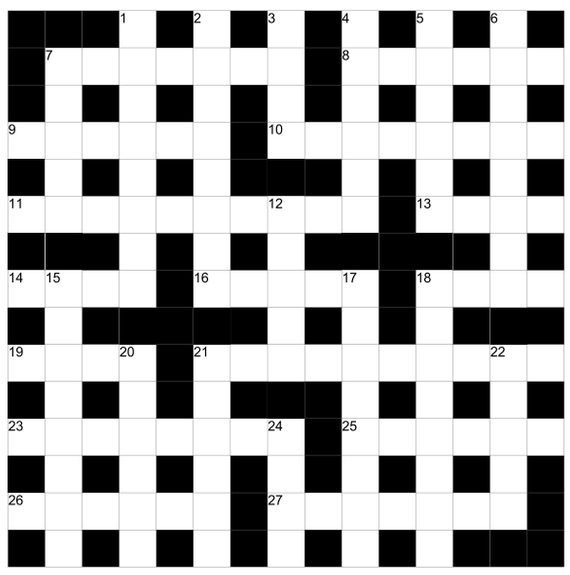
He added the Tuvalu Coastal Adaptation Project showed how international cooperation, particularly the provision of means of implementation, could translate into resilience. The UNFCCC summit will take place from November 9 to 20 in Türkiye.

TH CROSSWORD + 14917

(set by Saral)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



ACROSS
7. Surplus force entering certain industrial town at first (7)
8. Agreement of a conservative on bond (6)
9. Partially scan vast painting (6)
10. Former writer, say penning new books for promoter (8)
11. One preparing rice blend. Fantastic! (10)
13. Copy part of the chorus (4)
14. Primate enshrines relics finally in church area (4)
16. Energy and pressure throwing off Mark's garden tool (5)
18. Right away chopping shrub and plant (4)
19. Quick huge returns investing lakhs initially (4)
21. Withdrawing from skipping around institute street (10)
23. Intense anxiety of soldier in Kohima leaving occasionally (8)
25. Deans ordering small cars (6)
26. Idle talk of girl with very large drink (6)
27. Son left terrible bar in retreat (7)

DOWN
1. Translator unwilling to go through? (8)
2. Confused angry supermodels ignoring short role perhaps (6,2)
3. Swelling troubling your eye from the beginning? (4)
4. Bird's blurry image outside park (6)
5. Some craftsmen principally working next to church in defensive fort (6)
6. Stench spreading across again in gutters (8)
7. Cramps while cycling in country (5)
12. Throws dishes (5)
15. Look at daughter's pants, primarily spoiling dress design (5,3)
17. Piece of music in D sharp, old composing melody at last (8)
18. Support doctor with operation theatre setting (8)
20. Baker's chief to promote cook (6)
21. Disheartened director with an expression of apology, bows (6)
22. Group of players went on playing missing introduction (5)
24. Teacher hiding pain (4)

SUDOKU

	1	8					6	
		5			6	4	1	
					9	3	5	
			6	7	5			
		4				7		
			2	9	4			
	8	6	9					
	4	9	3			6		
	2					9	7	

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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★☆

Solution to previous puzzle

	N	U	R	S	E	R	Y	R	H	Y	M	E	S	
R		L		P		A		E		I		S		C
O	N	T	R	A	C	K		S	H	E	L	T	E	R
M		R		G		E		E		L		A		O
A	P	A	T	H	Y		B	A	D	D	E	B	T	S
N				E				R				L		S
N	I	G	H	T	Y		I	C	E	P	O	I	N	T
U		A		T		H		H		R		S		H
M	A	R	T	I	N	I	S		T	E	C	H	I	E
E		I				R				C				F
R	I	B	C	A	G	E	S		L	I	N	T	E	L
A		A		L		D		U		N		O		O
L	O	L	L	I	N	G		N	O	C	A	N	D	O
S		D		S		U		A		T		N		R
	D	I	S	T	I	N	G	U	I	S	H	E	D	

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

9	5	6	1	8	3	7	2	4
4	1	8	7	2	6	9	5	3
7	2	3	5	4	9	1	8	6
1	4	5	2	7	8	6	3	9
8	6	9	4	3	5	2	1	7
2	3	7	9	6	1	5	4	8
3	8	2	6	1	7	4	9	5
5	7	4	8	9	2	3	6	1
6	9	1	3	5	4	8	7	2

FAITH

Practise, repeat, practise

Practice makes perfect is an oft repeated axiom in life. Perseverance is key, an aspect reiterated by Lord Krishna to Arjuna in the Bhagavad Gita. Tiruvalluvar says, "He who desires not the personal pleasure, but focuses entirely on completing his duty will stand as a pillar of strength and support to one's family and relatives (Kural 615)". One should never give up in life but persevere. Abhyasa– any repeated activity – in any field will yield results, and same is the true of spirituality, said Swami Sivayoganandha.

Having the desire to evolve devotionally is a good base upon which one can develop further. Spending 20 minutes focusing entirely on God, chanting a mantra whereby one controls the wandering mind is the starting point. Lord Krishna says, "If you are unable to fix your mind steadily upon Me, then by the yoga of constant practice seek to reach Me, Oh Dhananjaya", (CH XII, V 9). Nowhere does Krishna say it is easy, aware as He is of human nature. In fact, He further states that if one is unable to even practise Abhyasa yoga, one should intently perform actions for Krishna's sake. One will soon achieve perfection by this method as well. Meditate and dedicate it to Him. Shed ego and do just what God bids you to do: which is to lead a dharmic life and do what is good for the world. One should be like the sun. Regardless of all things else, it always rises and performs its function afresh. The sun does not expect anything in return. Similarly work is its own reward. One should not try to extricate oneself from a task merely because it is difficult; the art of executing it comes from repeated exertion. Only when his mind is light can a person find true happiness.

INBRIEF

World Bank raises India FY27 growth forecast by 50 bps

The World Bank on Tuesday raised India's GDP growth forecast for the current fiscal to 7.1%, up 0.5 percentage points from its projections in April, supported by robust domestic demand and strong exports, despite global headwinds. The medium-term prospects are strong, it said, but also cautioned that external risks are elevated, including downside risks related to global oil prices, El Nino, and stock market corrections that would result in capital flow volatility. PTI

Mphasis extends Scotland deal in £35.4 million contract

IT services company Mphasis has extended its collaboration with Social Security Scotland, securing a £35.4 million contract to manage and maintain the Scottish Government agency's benefits management platform. Under the extended contract, Mphasis will provide support and maintenance for Social Security Scotland's core benefits case management platform, which supports delivery of devolved social security benefits and financial assistance to citizens.

Bondada bags ₹1,154 cr. order for 270 MWp solar project

Bondada Engineering has received ₹1,153.93 crore EPC order for development of a 270 MWp ground-mounted solar PV project across various locations in Maharashtra. The project is a significant addition to Bondada's renewable energy portfolio and will be executed over a six-month period, from the receipt of the order, the Hyderabad-headquartered company said on Tuesday without mentioning the entity that has placed the order.

Govt. steps in to stop Adani's MIAL slot cuts

The civil aviation ministry's intervention effectively puts the proposed international slot cuts on hold while seeking a workable transition plan

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

Turbulent skies: Airlines argued that the proposed timelines were too aggressive and operationally difficult to implement. REUTERS

The Ministry of Civil Aviation has stepped in to pause Adani Airports' proposed reduction in international flight operations at Mumbai's Terminal 2, giving airlines and the airport operator until October 20 to finalise a transition plan for the redevelopment of Terminal 1.

The intervention follows strong opposition from airlines to Mumbai International Airport Ltd.'s (MIAL) plan to cut 265 of Terminal 2's 770 weekly international departure slots from October 26. The proposed reduction, equivalent to about 34% of international departure slots, would affect 46 carriers. IndiGo faces 74 slot cuts, Air India 33, and Emirates and Etihad Airways 10 each.

MIAL said the cuts are necessary to free up Terminal 2 facilities, including check-in counters, baggage belts, gates and office space, for domestic operations shifting from Terminal 1 during its phased redevelopment. The move is aimed at accommodating around five million additional passengers annually.

Airlines, however, have argued that the proposed timelines are too aggressive and operationally difficult to implement.

The ministry has now asked Adani Airports, airlines and other stakeholders to reconvene and work out an "agreeable" and "win-win" transition plan. Adani Airports has called a fresh stakeholder meeting on October 13.

Auto retail sales surge 32% year-on-year

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Sale of petrol vehicles marginally bounced back in September to 41.27%

The Indian automobile industry registered retail sales of 25,36,920 units in September, a growth of 31.82% year-on-year (YoY) and 4.69% month-on-month (MoM), according to data released by the Federation of Automobile Dealers Association (FADA) on Tuesday.

Two-wheeler retail sales stood at 17,90,188 units, up 33.08% YoY and 4.41% MoM, and 15.3% above the pre-COVID September peak of 2018.

Dealers attributed the surge to festive sales in the first half of the month, steady rural and semi-urban demand, pull towards premium motorcycles, and accelerating EV adoption.

Share of electric two-wheelers touched 11.58%. Commercial vehicle retail sales crossed the one-lakh mark in a September for the first time at 1,03,557 units, up 37.62% YoY and 14.09% MoM.

Passenger vehicle retail sales stood at 4,27,213 units, a growth of 32.10% YoY and 6.17% MoM.

While alternative fuel vehicle sales overtook petrol vehicles for the first time in August, sale of petrol vehicles marginally bounced back in September to 41.27% against alternative fuels at 41% (CNG 23.11%, Hybrid 9.44%, EV 8.45%), FADA said.

"The August crossover was therefore an inflection, not a decisive flip. Petrol and alternative fuels are now effectively at parity, trading the lead month to month, even as EV share rose to a fresh high and CNG eased," FADA president Sai Giridhar said.

Cabinet clears apex body to handle roads, rail, ports as one network

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved a Special Purpose Vehicle – the Integrated Transport & Logistics Authority (ITLA) – which will be the apex body to plan, appraise and monitor transport and logistics projects that are now handled separately by different ministries and agencies.

Its central task will be a National Transport Master Plan with a horizon of 10 years or more, covering every major mode.

Short-term sectoral plans of about five years, and the annual plans of the transport ministries, will be checked against that master plan so that new capacity is multi-modal rather than mode by mode, according to a statement.

ITLA will also technically appraise Government of India infrastructure projects costing ₹500 crore or more. Financial appraisal will stay with the existing mechanisms. The same threshold applies after sanction: the authority will monitor implementation of transport and infrastructure projects above ₹500 crore, run a coordinated mechanism for resolving bottlenecks, and carry out impact assessments once projects are completed.

ITLA will build a National Transport Data Repository, drawing on GSTN e-way bills, FASTag, Vahan, GPS-based systems, and other databases.

Cabinet approves ₹10,000-crore SME growth fund

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved the proposal by the Ministry of Finance to commit ₹10,000 crore of central government funding for the setting up of a Small and Medium Enterprises (SME) Growth Fund in line with a proposal in Budget 2026.

The SME Growth Fund is "aimed at catalysing growth-oriented capital for India's SMEs and enabling the emergence of champion Indian enterprises across manufacturing, services, technology, innovation-driven sectors, and strategic value chains", the government said in a release following the Cabinet's decision.

The Fund was first mentioned in Union Budget 2026, when Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman had spoken about it as a means to incentivise enterprises based on select criteria.

"There are existing funds which provide equity support but majority of them focus on early-stage enterprises and cover majorly micro enterprises," the release added. "A structural gap exists for equity growth capital for small and medium enterprises."

The government further said that the majority of the allocation from the Fund will be made towards small and medium manufacturing focused enterprises. The Fund will also consider SMEs in industrial clusters in Tier II and Tier III cities, it added.

"By providing long-term capital, the initiative will enable Indian SMEs to scale operations, invest in technology and manufacturing capacity, expand into international markets, integrate into global value chains, and undertake strategic investments," the release said.

The release went on to say that the SME Growth Fund was one part of the government's overall efforts to strengthen the SME sector through reforms, digitalisation initiatives, credit support mechanisms, ease of doing business measures, public procurement reforms, startup promotion initiatives, and production-linked incentive programmes.

OpenAI all set to watermark ChatGPT text in Europe

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

ChatGPT logo and European Union flag are seen.

OpenAI will begin adding an invisible watermark to eligible text generated by ChatGPT and Codex in the European Union (EU) as the firm moves to comply with transparency norms under EU's AI Act.

OpenAI said the rollout would take place over the coming weeks and apply to eligible users across all ChatGPT and Codex plans in the EU. It said it was not making text watermarking a global default at launch.

Separately, from October 5, API customers worldwide can opt for text watermarking for select models.

The mandate

The move comes as Article 50(2) of the EU AI Act requires providers of generative AI systems to ensure AI-generated or manipulated content, including text, is marked in a machine-readable format and detectable as artificially-generated or manipulated.

The European Commission (EC) says technical steps must be effective, interoperable, robust and reliable, taking into account the limitations of content. The transparency obligations have applied since August 2, 2026. The law does not specifically require firms to use a watermark. The EC also developed a voluntary Code of Practice on Transparency of AI-generated content which sets out practical steps for providers to comply with Article 50.

textGrain technology

OpenAI said its text watermarking technology, called textGrain, adds an invisible statistical signal to the model's choice of words. A detector can later analyse the statistical pattern in the model's word choices.

Limitations

OpenAI said its detector identified watermarks in about 80% of 200-token passages and about 95% of 400-token passages in psychology-related content, at a target false-positive rate of 1% (viz. it would wrongly flag about one in 100 texts without the watermark). Detection was substantially lower for mathematics, where there is less flexibility in word choice.

Editing also significantly weakened the signal. The firm, therefore, said it would initially restrict access to text-watermark detector to approved researchers and expert organisations.

The detector would report whether an OpenAI watermark was detected but would not identify the user or reveal prompts or conversations. OpenAI said the decision reflected the risks of false positives and missed watermarks.

The limitations are huge as the watermark is intended as a provenance signal than definitive AI-authorship test.

Kasturi Cotton gains as traceability in textiles turns crucial

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

Initiative is aimed at giving buyers more confidence over the origin and quality of Indian cotton

Nearly 2.1 lakh bales of Indian-grown cotton were certified as Kasturi Cotton Bharat in the cotton marketing season ended September 30, underscoring the growing importance of traceability in India's textile value chain.

The adoption of Kasturi Cotton accelerated sharply since its launch. Certified volumes rose from 47,100 bales in 2023-24 to 2.13 lakh bales in 2025-26, while more than 10 lakh bales have now been brought under the Kasturi Cotton Bharat blockchain, creating a technology-enabled trail from cotton to the final product.

The step is aimed at giving buyers more confidence over the origin and quality of Indian cotton. Industry users say blockchain-based certification is turning relevant as global textile buyers, particularly in the U.S. and Europe, want more transparency and traceability across supply chains.

Of an estimated 498 lakh bales of cotton output by 2031-32, about 132 lakh bales are projected to qualify as Kasturi Cotton.

Jio IPO 'sans OFS, may list in top 3 at ₹12 lakh cr. valuation'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Digital services firm Jio Platforms' initial public offering (IPO), expected to be India's biggest issue to date, is likely to come without an offer-for-sale (OFS) as none of the investors has expressed interest to either exit or dilute holdings, as per sources.

Jio Platforms (JPL) may list among top-three stocks at a valuation of about ₹12 lakh crore, they said.

"Based on interest received during the overseas roadshows, JPL IPO may list among top three stocks in market capitalisation. It is expected to list at a valuation of around ₹12-13 lakh crore," a source said.

At present, top-three stocks in India are Reliance Industries Ltd., HDFC and Bharti Airtel. The anchor round is likely to be held on October 19 and the issue is likely to open for subscription from October 21-23. Permanent staff of Jio Platforms, RIL and Jio Platforms' subsidiaries will get reservation in stock allocation. The sources indicated Jio may raise about $3.8 billion from the IPO.

NEW DELHI

Twelve crew members injured after tanker attacked off Oman

REUTERS

Twelve crew members on a Panama-flagged tanker were injured in an attack while crossing the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs said in a statement, with those injured receiving medical treatment in Oman. The Ministry said the tanker, *MT On Peace*, had a 19-member crew, including 17 Indians. AFP

BERLIN

Germany arrests ex-spy chief for 'passing secrets to foreign powers'

AP

A former German spy chief was arrested on Tuesday on suspicion of passing sensitive information to foreign powers. August Hanning, who ran Germany's BND foreign intelligence agency from 1998 to 2005, is accused of espionage, treason and working for foreign intelligence services, federal prosecutors said. AFP

PARIS

Hundreds held in France as school protests descend into violence

REUTERS

Mass protests over decrepit conditions at France's high schools descended into sporadic violence on Tuesday, leading to nearly 500 arrests and prompting President Emmanuel Macron to call a meeting. The Interior Ministry said 256,000 people protested nationwide, while union organisers put the figure at 450,000. AFP

NAIROBI

Kenya confirms first Ebola case after traveller from Congo dies

REUTERS

Kenyan authorities on Tuesday confirmed the country's first imported Ebola case from Congo, making Kenya the latest country affected by the fast-moving outbreak. Health Minister Aden Duale said a Kenyan citizen who arrived from Congo via Uganda tested positive for the Ebola virus and died late Monday. AP

Ukraine fires 900 drones overnight at Russia

Associated Press
KYIV

Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said on Tuesday.

Unconfirmed media reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people.

Ukrainian officials are now bracing for what President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned is an upcoming "massive" aerial attack by Russia.

"Today, we received updated intelligence on Russia's preparations for a massive strike. We are preparing countermeasures," Mr. Zelenskyy said.

Meanwhile, the Russian Defence Ministry said its forces overnight struck targets in Ukraine's southern Odesa region on the Black Sea coast with drones, where an ammunition depot was hit.

Houthis 'hit' Riyadh airport; Yemen military claims gains

The group denies being pushed back and says it still controlled territory seized during its recent advance along Yemen's Red Sea coast; Riyadh airport is facing temporary closures of its airspace

Agence France-Presse
SANAA

Pro-government fighters celebrate while riding vehicles in a convoy near the Bab el-Mandeb Strait in Taiz on Tuesday. AFP

Yemen's Houthis (Ansar Allah) claimed an attack on the Saudi capital's main airport and on Tuesday denied being pushed back by government forces, who have launched a major operation to recapture lost territory.

The Houthi statements come as Yemen's military said it had removed the pro-Iran group from areas around the Bab el-Mandeb strait, a Red Sea chokepoint, and the port city of Mokha.

Claims by both sides in Yemen have been impossible to independently verify, with the situation on the ground moving fast and access for journalists difficult.

Houthi military spokesperson Yahya Saree said the group still held all territory seized last month when they swept through coastal areas along the Red Sea oil-and-cargo route.

Houthi fighters "have full control over all their advances on the ground", he posted on Telegram.

Mr. Saree said they had carried out dozens of strikes in the past few hours targeting government forces in Yemen's Al-Jawf and Marib regions, while also attacking Taiz governorate.

On Monday, the Houthis said they had struck Riyadh airport and a refinery belonging to Saudi state oil giant Aramco.

Loud explosions rattled the Saudi capital on Monday evening. They were followed by another explosion on Tuesday that echoed through northern parts of the city, residents said.

Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport is facing frequent temporary closures of its airspace, according to tracking website Flightradar24. Saudi authorities have not publicly acknowledged the closures or confirmed any strikes targeting the facility.

But on Tuesday the civil aviation authority said at least three people were wounded in attacks on Jazan and Najran airports near the Yemen border a day earlier.

Saudi Arabia, the main backer of the Yemeni government, has been providing air support for the counter-offensive launched by government forces.

Government forces claimed late Monday that they had achieved "victories on several fronts". But military sources with the government refrained from confirming Mokha's recapture, only saying they had cut the one supply route to the area.

They also said they expelled the Houthis from several areas in Taiz in the southwest.

Jeffrey Archer, bestselling British novelist, dies at 86

Associated Press
LONDON

Jeffrey Archer climbed the ranks of Britain's Conservative Party under Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher. NAGARA GOPAL

Bestselling British author Jeffrey Archer, whose career as a politician was derailed by a perjury conviction, has died. He was 86.

Archer died "suddenly and peacefully" at his home on Monday, a day before the global release of his final novel, *Adam and Eve*, publisher HarperCollins said. Like his bestseller *Kane and Abel*, the new book follows a pair of biblically named characters born on the same day to different social classes.

Both a celebrated author and scandal-plagued politician, Archer's professional life teetered between triumph and turmoil as he wrote his way through a brief prison sentence and returned to the political arena.

His writing career spanned five decades and helped him bounce back from financial ruin following some bad investments. His debut novel, *Not a Penny More, Not a Penny Less*, hit the shelves in 1976 and was said to have been inspired by his own experience nearly going bankrupt.

He went on to spend 14 years and five months on Britain's *Sunday Times* bestseller lists and over five years on *The New York Times* bestseller lists, selling 300 million books worldwide, according to HarperCollins.

Political stint

Archer climbed the ranks of Britain's Conservative Party under Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher and was appointed in 1992 to the House of Lords by her successor, Prime Minister John Major.

Archer was cast out of his political party just before he was jailed on perjury charges in 2001.

Archer chronicled his time behind bars in a three-volume series titled *A Prison Diary*. The memoirs – *Hell*, *Purgatory* and *Heaven* – shared rare insight into the lives of inmates in British prisons, from the high-security HMP Belmarsh to the North Sea Camp open prison.

Archer is survived by his wife of 60 years, Dame Mary Archer, their two sons, two granddaughters and three grandsons, his publisher said.

Why NASA wants to build a nuclear reactor on the moon

NEWS ANALYSIS

Vasudevan Mukunth

View of Moon limb. ISTOCKPHOTO

NASA wants to install a nuclear reactor near the moon's south pole by 2030. Its planned output, 20 kilowatt (kW), could power a few households on earth. Russia's planned reactor for the International Lunar Research Station (ILRS), led by China, will produce around 10 kW. But the fact that they are nuclear makes them significant. The U.S. and China are pursuing parallel efforts today – in partnership with other countries – to be the first to set up a semi-permanent, and in future permanent, moon base. Such a facility will need electricity for everything from heating and life-support to recharging rover batteries. European scientists are also exploring lunar microreactors.

At most locations on the moon, a fortnight of daylight follows a fortnight of darkness. Near the south pole, where both factions are focusing their activities, promontories and craters create a pastiche of lit and shadowed patches, with temperatures inside some of the latter dipping under a frigid -200 C. But unlike solar panels, a nuclear reactor can produce power even in the dark.

The colder craters preserve water ice, which can quench astronauts' thirst and can also be electrolysed to produce hydrogen and oxygen, to power rockets launched from the moon itself. In one 2020 assessment, NASA scientists Julie Kleinhenz and Aaron Paz figured producing 10 tonnes of oxygen this way would require around 68 kW of power. So a 20-kW reactor could be a stepping stone in countries' plans to set up an array of reactors on the moon.

While the moon as a whole is barren, the more ideal locations, with longer periods of sunlight, terrain more suitable to land on, access to craters with water ice, and so on, are highly limited. Research commissioned by NASA has recommended situating nuclear reactors at least 1 km away from humans.

Now, the Outer Space Treaty 1967 says no country may appropriate any part of the moon through occupation or other means. But the Artemis Accords, to which the U.S. and its allies vis-à-vis the moon are signatories, envisage 'safety zones' to prevent harmful interference. Put differently, a state does not have to stake territory on the moon to limit access to others: it can simply plonk a nuclear reactor there and appeal to the need for legitimate safety requirements.

The Accords say these zones must be temporary and respect free access – but a country or a bloc operating a cluster of reactors, landing pads, mines, and habitats could nevertheless gain a controlling advantage. For the appeal of this idea, however, both Artemis and ILRS face breathtaking technical hurdles. Shielding a nuclear reactor on the moon demands either launching the components to ensure its safe operation or producing them on the moon with lunar resources. Distancing a reactor from a base demands deployment machines and power cables. The reactor core will also have to be launched unirradiated and, once online, space agencies will have to find ways to absorb and store all the heat – or radiate waste heat away from large surfaces kept free of moondust. If a reactor fails on the moon, it could contaminate the same few places astronauts would like to be at.

While nuclear power could prove indispensable to a mature economy centred on the moon, no country possesses that economy today even as governments are being tempted to install reactors before their opponents – a danger in itself.

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India
Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064 Website: www.rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in
CIN:U24232RJ2011SGC035067, E-mail: edprmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref. No. :- F.02 (454)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-16/2026-27/5191 Dated :- 28/09/2026

NOTICE INVITING E-Bids

e-Bids are invited by RMSCL, Jaipur from bonafide MANUFACTURERS / LOAN LICENSEE / IMPORTERS / CO-MARKETERS with sole marketing rights for imported proprietary items for rate contract cum supply and empanelment of bidders for Drugs & Medicines. The last date of submission of duly filled up form along with documents on e-proc i.e. **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** and submission of fees is upto 06.00 PM of 27.10.2026 Details of NIB may be seen at the website of State Public Procurement Portal **https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/, http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in., http://rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in** and may be downloaded from there.

Estimated Value (Rs.):- 278.77 Crore

UBN No. MSC2627GLOB00055

Director (Proc.)
RMSCL, Jaipur

Raj.Samwad/C/26/11359

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(CIN:U40109KA1999SGC025521)

No.CEE/T&P/SEE-1/2026-27/7165-80 Date: 05.10.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION

(Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)

KPTCL Invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on **Total Turnkey Basis.**

Sl.No.	Enquiry number and Name of the Works
1.	**KPTCL/2026-27/UC/WORK_INDENT4259**
	Running of **220kV, 1200 sqmm** UG Cable as an alternate source for **220/66/11kV Koramangala GIS sub-station from 220/66/11kV HSR Layout sub-station** for a route length of **6.87km** along with construction of **220kV terminal bays** at both ends in Bengaluru South Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District.
2.	**KPTCL/2026-27/UC/WORK_INDENT4258(Short-term tender)**
	Running of **66kV, 630 sqmm UG Cable** from location No.43 to 54 in Cheelandavadi village state forest Cauvery wildlife protected area for a **distance of 1.265 kms**, as a part of the work of Construction of proposed 66kV SC Line on DC towers from existing 66/11 kV Doddalahalli S/s to proposed 66/11kV **Hegganur** sub-station in Kanakapura Taluk, Bengaluru South District.

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in **on or after 09.10.2026 @ 15:00 hrs.** Last date & time for receipt of Bids and **any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP Portal.** Any other details required in this regard can also be had from the Office of the undersigned during Office hours.

All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.

Sd/- Chief Engineer(Electy.), Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor, Indhana Bhavan, A.R Circle, Bengaluru-560009.

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଶକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିଃ
(ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)
OPTCL Lifeline of Odisha

ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)

Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Janpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
EIC. BharatNet -e- Tender-3/2026-27	Supply and erection of 120 Nos 8/9 metre PSC Poles and stringing of OverHead ADSS Fibre (65Km) in Bharatnet phase-II network in Odisha. **Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 20.10.2026 upto 12:30 PM.**	**Rs. 45,67,190/-**
CPC-68/2026-27	Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection and commissioning of Strengthening of Existing Overhead Lines within 60kms of Coastal belt Districts in priority towards mitigation projects for construction of Disaster Resilient Power Infrastructure from SDMF on Turnkey Contract basis in e-tendering mode only. **Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 04.11.2026 upto 11:00 Hrs.**	**Rs. 1,15,64,95,241/-**
CPC-71/2026-27	Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection, Testing and commissioning of (I) 765/400/220kV GIS Sub-Station at Khuntuni (At Betakholi) with 3x1500MVA, 765/400kV ICT, 2x240MVAR, 765kV Bus reactor, 3 x 500MVA, 400/220kV ICT and 1x125MVAR, 400kV Bus reactor (ii) 765 kV DC LINE HEXA ACSR ZEBRA from existing 765/400 kV AIS Grid S/S, PGCIL, Phulapada (Angul) - To proposed 765/400/220kV GIS S/S, Betakholi (74.059 kms) (iii) 400 kV Quad MOOSE LINE from Betakholi to Mendhasal on Multi Circuit Towers (31.92 kms) and one no. dia extension at 400/220/132 kV Grid S/S, Mendhasal for connectivity of 400kV Betakholi-Mendhasal Transmission Line on EPC Contract basis in e- tendering mode only. **Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 16.11.2026 upto 12:45 PM.**	**Rs. 16,76,95,79,953/-**
CPC-76/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed bidders for Procurement of Structure Materials & HDG Nut & bolts for Balance work of two nos. 132kV feeder bay extension each at 220/132/33kV Grid Sub-Station, Jaypatna and 132/33 kV Grid Sub-Station Junagarh and 132kV DC line from existing 220/132/33kV Grid Substation, Jaipatna (Baner) to LILO point (Loc no. 41/1).	**Rs. 5,50,22,814/-**
CPC-77/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed bidders for Carrying out Forest clearance work of an area of approx. 90Ha of land proposed for construction of 400kV Quad Moose DC Line from Jeypore GSS(PGCIL) to Theruvali GSS.	**Rs. 1,35,48,005/-**

Complete set of bidding documents are available at **www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL** and **www.optcl.co.in**.

/optcl.odisha /optcl_odisha **HIPR-64/2026-27**

GLOWING TRIBUTE

You gave Indian cricket everything as captain, Harman: Yuvraj

FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

You gave Indian cricket everything as captain, Harman. The responsibility, the pressure, the highs and the lows, you carried it all with pride. Well done for everything you've done for the team and for the nation — Former India all-rounder Yuvraj Singh's Instagram post for Harmanpreet Kaur.

MY SKIPPER

'Since the day I made my debut, you've always been there for me'

FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

Since the day I made my debut, you've always been there for me. From guiding me through the early days to standing by me through everything, I've always known I could count on you. Harman *di*, your contribution to Indian women's cricket is something that will always be remembered — Shafali Verma on Harmanpreet Kaur.

SELECTION FOR SELECTOR

BCCI invites applications for Agarkar's replacement

FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

The BCCI has formally begun the process to find Ajit Agarkar's successor on the men's senior selection committee, inviting applications for one vacancy on Tuesday, two days after the former India pacer's contract expired. Pragyan Ojha has been asked to chair the committee in the interim.

IN THE FRAY

Abhishek, Gill, Shree Charani and Shafali the ICC PoTM nominees

FILE PHOTO

Shubman Gill, Abhishek Sharma, Shafali Verma and Shree Charani are among the nominees for the men's and women's ICC Player of the Month award for September. Zimbabwe captain Sikandar Raza and Sri Lankan skipper Chamari Athapaththu have also been named in the men's and women's shortlists respectively.

Tap in: Sanabria, foreground, slots home Uruguay's fifth goal. K.R. DEEPAK

India's fight fades as Uruguay nets six

The visitor shows its might in the second half after Thapa makes it 1-1 in the 22nd minute; the host struggles to maintain its defensive discipline

FOOTBALL

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

India showed enough attacking intent to suggest it could compete with two-time world champion Uruguay, but a second-half collapse exposed the gulf in pace, depth and efficiency as the host eventually capitulated to a 1-6 loss at the Salt Lake Stadium on Tuesday.

India started positively but struggled to maintain its defensive discipline as the game progressed.

Uruguay took the lead in the 11th minute when Federico Vinas was brought down inside the box, allowing Darwin Nunez to convert from the spot.

Responding well

India responded well and drew level in the 22nd minute.

Ryan Williams' effort was parried by goalkeeper Thiago Cardozo, but Thapa reacted quickest to the rebound and fired home.

The Blue Tigers were able to find openings in the final third whenever they moved the ball with purpose.

But their vulnerability was exposed when possession changed hands.

That weakness was evident in the 28th minute after play resumed following a 35-minute delay due to lightning.

Rodrigo Bentancur released Nandez down the right as India failed to reorganise quickly enough, allowing the full-back to find Maxi Araujo, who produced a clinical finish to put Uruguay in the lead.

The goal highlighted India's biggest problem: it lacked the speed to shift from attack to defence and struggled to rebuild quickly after winning possession.

There were encouraging moments, too. Gurpreet Singh Sandhu produced an excellent 37th-minute save to deny Nunez after the striker had been put through.

India went into the break 1-2 down, with its attacking players – Edmund Lalrindika, Manvir Singh and Williams – lacking precision in the final third.

Uruguay coach Diego Forlan made seven changes, including Lucas Torreira and Facundo Pellistri, adding fresh quality and energy to his side. Rodrigo Zalazar made it 3-1 in the 53rd minute, Araujo scored his second in the 59th, Juan Sanabria found the target in the 71st, and Rodrigo Aguirre netted in the 86th to complete the rout.

India's efforts did not disappear, but its inability to match Uruguay's pace and intensity became increasingly evident.

The host struggled to close spaces and recover its defensive shape as Uruguay repeatedly exploited transitions.

India had late opportunities through substitutes Mohammed Sanan and Sahal Abdul Samad, but both efforts were saved by Cardozo in the Uruguay goal.

The result: India 1 (Anirudh Thapa 22) lost to Uruguay 6 (Darwin Nunez 11-pen, Maxi Araujo 28, 59, Rodrigo Zalazar 53, Juan Sanabria 71, Rodrigo Aguirre 86).

Shreyas makes it a cakewalk for India

WI IN INDIA

S. Dipak Ragav
LUCKNOW

Coming into the series opener, Shreyas Iyer was under some pressure, having not scored a half-century in his last 10 T20I appearances. All that changed on Tuesday as the Indian skipper slammed a sensational maiden T20I century, an unbeaten 102 (43b, 10x4, 6x6), to power the Men in Blue to a thumping eight-wicket win over the West Indies at the Ekana Stadium here.

Chasing 172, India found itself in trouble at 35 for two after losing openers Abhishek Sharma and Sanju Samson cheaply.

With the match finely poised, Shreyas took charge in the final over of the PowerPlay, smashing Shamar Joseph for a hat-trick of boundaries to signal his intentions.

The Mumbai batter's strength has always been his ability to find boundaries while playing orthodox shots. He unsettled the West Indies bowlers by shuffling in the crease to access acute angles.

In the ninth over, he did that repeatedly to Romario Shepherd, lofting the medium-pacer over covers for three back-to-back hits to the fence.

At the other end, Ishan Kishan chipped in with a few boundaries, but he only had to put his captain back on strike, which he regularly did.

Once he got past his half-century, which came off 28 balls, Shreyas cut loose, taking just 15 deliveries for the next 52 runs. Against Akeal Hosein, he backed away and lofted the left-arm spinner for a six and four over cover.

In the 14th over, Shreyas plundered 23 off Matthew Forde, including three maximums. The skipper deposited Roston Chase down the ground to bring up his ton and then sealed the win with 5.2 overs to spare.

Spinners excel

Earlier, the Indian tweakers led by debutant Naman Dhir (three for 31) wreaked havoc through the middle phase of the innings, scalping seven wickets to bundle West Indies out for 171.

For Windies, Shai Hope and Sherfane Rutherford did the heavy lifting, scoring fighting half-centuries.

While Hope got the team off to a strong start, the host pulled it back in the final over of the PowerPlay when Axar Patel (two for 26) bowled a maiden which included the wicket of Rovman Powell after the run-out of Shimron Hetmyer.

From 44 for three, Hope and Rutherford consolidated through a 63-run fourth-wicket stand. Dhir and Kuldeep (two for 33) then ran through the middle-order as the visitor slumped from 107 for three to 135 for eight.

Rutherford, though, got his team to a respectable total, punishing some poor bowling from the Indian quicks in the death overs, but against a rampaging Shreyas it was too little.

Standing tall: Shreyas was unstoppable after Dhir, bottom right, struck vital blows on his debut. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

SCOREBOARD

WEST INDIES
Shai Hope c Axar b Dhir 52 *(37b, 6x4, 2x6)*, Kamil Pooran b Arshdeep 12 *(11b, 2x4)*, Shimron Hetmyer run out 5 *(2b, 1x4)*, Rovman Powell b Axar 0 *(3b)*, Sherfane Rutherford c Dhir b Mayank 56 *(34b, 6x4, 3x6)*, Roston Chase lbw b Kuldeep 5 *(3b, 1x4)*, Romario Shepherd c Tilak b Dhir 7 *(5b, 1x6)*, Matthew Forde c Kishan b Kuldeep 2 *(4b)*, Shamar Springer c Axar b Dhir 9 *(7b, 1x6)*, Akeal Hosein c Kishan b Axar 15 *(9b, 1x4, 1x6)*, Shamar Joseph (not out) 0 *(1b)*; Extras (b-2, lb-5, nb-1): 8; Total (in 19.1 overs): 171.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-38 (Kamil, 4.3 overs), 2-44 (Hetmyer, 5.2), 3-44 (Powell, 5.5), 4-107 (Hope, 11.4), 5-114 (Chase, 12.3), 6-121 (Shepherd, 13.2), 7-124 (Forde, 14.1), 8-135 (Springer, 15.5), 9-171 (Rutherford, 18.5).

INDIA BOWLING
Arshdeep 4-0-34-1, Mayank 4-0-40-1, Axar 3.1-1-26-2, Kuldeep 4-0-33-2, Dhir 4-0-31-3.

INDIA
Sanju Samson c & b Akeal 11 *(9b, 1x4)*, Abhishek Sharma c Hetmyer b Chase 21 *(10b, 3x4, 1x6)*, Ishan Kishan (not out) 37 *(27b, 5x4)*, Shreyas Iyer (not out) 102 *(43b, 10x4, 6x6)*; Extras (nb-1): 1; Total (for two wkts. in 14.4 overs): 172.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-29 (Abhishek, 2.3), 2-35 (Samson, 3.3).

WEST INDIES BOWLING
Forde 2-0-39-0, Akeal 4-0-37-1, Chase 3.4-0-37-1, Shamar 2-0-23-0, Shepherd 2-0-24-0, Springer 1-0-12-0.

Toss: India.
PoM: Shreyas.
India won by eight wickets with 32 balls remaining to lead five-match series 1-0.
Second T20I: October 9, Ranchi, 7 p.m.

Bhuvneshwar last represented India in November 2022. FILE PHOTO

Bhuvneshwar recalled for NZ T20Is

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

Bhuvneshwar Kumar's return to India's T20I squad after nearly four years will be one of the talking points of the forthcoming tour of New Zealand, starting October 22.

The 36-year-old last represented India in November 2022.

Washington Sundar, who was withdrawn from the ongoing T20I series against the West Indies, will instead play three First Class matches for India-A in New Zealand. Rishabh Pant has also been included in the India-A squad, subject to fitness.

The squads: T20Is: Shreyas Iyer (Capt.), Tilak Varma (Vice-capt.), Abhishek Sharma, Sanju Samson (wk), Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ishan Kishan (wk), Axar Patel, Shivam Dube, Nitish Kumar, Naman Dhir, Prince Yadav, Mayank Yadav, Arshdeep Singh, Bhuvneshwar Kumar, Varun Chakaravarthy, and Kuldeep Yadav.
The fixtures: Oct. 22 and 24 (Christchurch), Oct. 27 (Wellington), Oct. 30 (Auckland), Nov. 1 (Hamilton).
India-A: Dhruv Jurel (Capt. & wk), Yashasvi Jaiswal, K.L. Rahul, Devdutt Padikkal, R. Smaran, Rishabh Pant* (wk), Washington Sundar, Auqib Nabi, Akash Deep, Anshul Kamboj, Manav Suthar, Mukesh Choudhary, B. Sai Sudharsan, Yash Rathod, and Mukesh Kumar.
*Subject to fitness
The dates: Oct. 24 to 27 (Lincoln); Oct. 31 to Nov. 3 (Christchurch), Nov. 7 to 10 (Lincoln).

Harmanpreet quits captaincy, Smriti named new skipper

Sports Bureau
MUMBAI

Harmanpreet Kaur has stepped down as captain of India's women's cricket team across all three formats, bringing the curtain down on a leadership tenure that reached its peak with India winning its maiden women's ODI World Cup last year.

Smriti Mandhana was named as Harmanpreet's successor. The latter announced her decision in an *Instagram* post on Tuesday, a day after she, vice-captain Smriti and head coach Amol Muzumdar met BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia in Guwahati.

Harmanpreet gets the timing right in leaving leadership role

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Nearly 300,000 views. More than 10,000 comments.

In less than two hours after she announced through social media that she was stepping down as India's captain, the traffic on Harmanpreet Kaur's Instagram page reflected not just the distance she has travelled as a cricketer, but the journey women's cricket has undertaken from the humblest of starts imaginable.

So, it is over: the reign of the most successful captain in Indian women's cricket.

It hasn't come as a shock.

There has been, for quite a while now, a lot of noise around Harmanpreet's captaincy. Her former teammates, ex-selectors, have all been talking about the need for a change in leadership. Of late, that noise became louder. Harmanpreet has got the timing right. Just as she does with those power-packed shots of hers that have terrorised the bowlers the world over.

Heady success: Harmanpreet led India to a maiden World Cup triumph last year. She also guided the Women in Blue to glory in the Asia Cup and Asian Games recently. ANI, GETTY IMAGES & R.V. MOORTHY

She has quit as captain right after leading India to some significant triumphs.

Her last three assignments: the Asian Games, the Asia Cup and the first-ever Women's Test at Lord's. India won all those three in resounding fashion.

Yes, before that, there was a major disappointment at the T20 World Cup in England, where India failed to make it to the knockout stage. But, last year, Harmanpreet had led the Women in Blue to their biggest moment ever – the ODI World Cup, that too at home.

That was India's first-ever triumph in a global ICC tournament. She led her women from the front during that unforgettable campaign, which had gone so wrong at one stage that they were in a must-win situation in game after game.

Relishing the challenge

Harmanpreet loved to lead. She is one of those players who aren't weighed down by the burden of captaincy, which, in cricket, isn't just an armband, as is the case with other sports.

She took new kids, like Kranti Gaud and Shree Charani, under her wings. She gave someone like Shafali Verma the confidence to bowl.

And now she has given the new captain – Smriti Mandhana – enough time to settle into the job before India's next big event.

WOMEN'S SQUADS

The India women's teams for the white-ball series against Zimbabwe was announced on Tuesday.

The squads:

T20Is: Smriti Mandhana (Capt.), Shafali Verma (Vice-capt.), Niki Prasad, Harmanpreet Kaur, Anushka Sharma, Richa Ghosh (wk), G. Kamalini (wk), Deepti Sharma, Prema Rawat, Shree Charani, Nandani Sharma, Kranti Gaud, Arundhati Reddy, Jintimani Kalita, and Minnu Mani.

The schedule: Oct. 16, 18 and 20. All matches at Raipur. Start time 7 p.m.

ODIs: Smriti Mandhana (Capt.), Deepti Sharma (Vice-capt.), Shafali Verma, Pratika Rawal, Harmanpreet Kaur, Harleen Deol, Tejal Hasabnis, Richa Ghosh (wk), Yastika Bhatia (wk), Vaishnavi Sharma, Nandani Sharma, Shree Charani, Kranti Gaud, Sayali Satghare, and Renuka Singh.

The dates: Oct. 23, 25 and 28. All matches at Vadodara. Start time 2 p.m.

INBRIEF

Djokovic triumphs as de Minaur retires injured

Novak Djokovic won his seventh China Open title after Alex de Minaur retired with a groin injury during the final in Beijing on Tuesday. de Minaur left the court for a medical timeout after losing the first-set tie-breaker, but played on with his left thigh bandaged. However, he had to stop after winning the first game of the second set, leaving him trailing 6-7(3), 1-0. Sixth-ranked Djokovic's win continued his unbeaten record at the tournament with 34 straight victories.

Delhi Capitals names Ganguly as head coach for IPL 2027

Delhi Capitals announced on Tuesday that Sourav Ganguly will be the head coach of the franchise for the 2027 Indian Premier League (IPL). The 54-year-old replaces Hemang Badani at the helm of the coaching set-up. With co-owners GMR Group and JSW Sports coming to an arrangement in 2024 that the operational control will rotate every two years, the latter will take charge of the franchise for the next two IPL seasons. GMR was overseeing operations in 2025 and 2026, when DC finished fifth and sixth in the standings, respectively.

Energised by County stint, Sai Kishore aims to win it all

The TN skipper says playing in foreign conditions provided a good chance to test himself; he wants collective approach to be the team's philosophy as it gets ready for the domestic season

RANJI TROPHY

Tarun Shastry
CHENNAI

It is not every day that you see former England Test captain and World Cup winner Ben Stokes fling his bat in the air in disbelief after being bamboozled and castled 'through the gate'.

Sai Kishore, though, has that image to savour – Stokes left stunned by the Tamil Nadu spinner during his recent County stint in England.

Back home and into the rigours of the country's premier domestic competition, the Ranji Trophy, the TN red-ball captain spoke to *The Hindu* before leaving for Jaipur, where his side opens its campaign against Rajasthan on October 11.

"Playing in foreign conditions was a good opportunity to test myself. I played at different grounds and, for the first time, at Old Trafford. You watch these grounds on TV and do your research, but it is different when you actually play there," said Sai Kishore.

Looking forward: Sai Kishore says the young Tamil Nadu side has the enthusiasm and hunger to do well. FILE PHOTO: BISWARANJAN ROUT

"Performing on those greenish pitches gave me confidence in my skill," added the 29-year-old, who bagged 22 wickets in six games for his side, Gloucestershire.

Sai Kishore will have a familiar face in former teammate Yo Mahesh, who takes over as TN head coach this season.

"I've played with Yomi, so that relationship helps... together we should just take it forward," said Sai Kishore.

Captaincy, meanwhile, is a responsibility he cherishes.

An honour

"It's a great honour, privilege, pleasure and responsibility to captain Tamil Nadu. I'm very grateful for what I've got.

"We will give our everything. The fire is very important. The desire to win is important. This is a young side and with that comes fresh energy and enthusiasm," he said.

For the skipper, however, the larger goal remains the same. "If there is one goal, it is the trophy. We need a collective approach, and that will be the team's philosophy".

Baloda puts India in control; Green claims seven for the visitor

AUS U-19 IN INDIA

Sahil Mathur
AHMEDABAD

Tanmay Baloda continued from where he left off in the first innings, adding four more wickets to his match tally to make it a 10-for. His spell of four for 26 put India under-19 in an advantageous position against Australia under-19 at the end of day two of the second Test here on Tuesday.

Australia u-19 was 86 for four at stumps, trailing the host by 55 runs. India u-19 was earlier bowled out for 315 after taking a 141-run lead.

Despite India's dominance, the day still belonged to leg-spinner Spencer Green, who finished with figures of seven for 110.

Green was Australia's go-to weapon from the morning and got overnight batters Kushagra Ojha (29) and Yashbardhan Chauhan (52) out in consecutive overs. With only the odd ball turning, Aryan Yadav (30) and Manal Chauhan (34) were comfortable in rotating strike while finding the fence occasionally.

Post lunch, Yashbardhan miscued Green while Thomas Vaseo rushed Aryan to clean him up. Green then got Mohit Ulva and Ayaan Akram back-to-back.

Green. VIJAY SONEJI

But Abhiprai Biswas counter-attacked. He slog-swept his first ball for a six and took the aerial route over the fielders whenever possible. He brought up his fifty off just 36 balls. However, Biswas missed a straighter one to give Green his seventh scalp.

India added 42 more to its lead through the last-wicket partnership before Baloda put his side in a commanding spot with the ball, heading into the third day.

The scores: Australia u-19 174 & 86/4 in 26 overs (Tanmay Baloda 4/26) vs. India u-19 315 in 78.4 overs (Yashbardhan Chauhan 52, Abhiprai Biswas 73, Spencer Green 7/110).

McSweeney, Sutherland and Beardman do the star turn as Australia-A goes one up

AUS-A IN INDIA

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

Four wickets against his name, three with balls over 142 kmph on the speed gun. Mahli Beardman's raging balls of fire proved too hot for India-A as it succumbed to a 125-run loss to Australia-A in the first one-dayer at the CAP Ground here on Tuesday.

The 21-year-old's timely strikes helped bowl the home side out for 149 after Nathan McSweeney scored a fighting hundred (123, 135b, 13x4) to post a target of 275. Rajat Patidar was the only Indian batter (53, 51b, 5x4, 1x6) to put up some resistance.

After choosing to bat, Australia-A was pushed onto the back foot quickly. Yash Thakur used the short ball to force Mitch Owen and Sam Konstas into mistimed pulls.

With two more edges finding the fielders, the visitor found themselves in trouble at 87 for five. But McSweeney and captain Will Sutherland (77, 68b, 2x4, 4x6) arrested the slide with a sixth-wicket partnership of 141.

Upping the ante

Sutherland shifted gears as the lights came on for the final hour of the innings. He used his long levers to loft spinners into the leg-side fence. Just as Australia-A's fightback looked set to help it reach 300, Suryansh Shedge (four for 40) picked three in four overs to close out the innings.

Despite Beardman sending the Indian top-order packing by beating them with his pace, India-A continued to harbour hopes of chasing the total down with its extended batting line-up.

Patidar managed to forge steady partnerships with skipper Ruturaj Gaikwad (15) and Nishant Sindhu (31). But once they fell, the lower-order folded up.

The scores: Australia-A 274 in 48.2 overs (Nathan McSweeney 123, Will Sutherland 77, Thakur 3/47, Shedge 4/40) bt India-A 149 in 31.4 overs (Rajat Patidar 53, Beardman 4/23). **Toss:** Australia-A; **PoM:** McSweeney.

In full flow: McSweeney's ton took Australia-A to 274. X@CAP

Prabodh.

Prabodh knocks out Balsekar

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Suraj Prabodh rallied to stun second seed Aditya Balsekar 3-6, 6-2, 7-6(4) at the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship here on Tuesday.

Important results

(round-of-32): Men: Suraj Prabodh bt Aditya Balsekar 2-6, 6-2, 7-6(4); Udit Kamboj bt Aditya Mor 6-1, 7-5; Deep Munim bt Prajwal Tewari 6-7(3), 6-4, 6-4; Ajay Malik bt Dhiraj Vennapusa 7-6(8), 6-7(3), 6-1.
Women: Aditi Rawat bt L. Arunkumar 6-3, 7-5; Laxmi Siri Dandu bt A. Khorakiwala 6-2, 6-1; Sohini Mohanty bt Joell Nichole 7-5, 6-3; Bela Tamhankar bt Jasmine Rawat 6-4, 6-2;
Under-18: Boys: Praneel Sharma bt Sarthak Gaikwad 6-0, 6-3; Srivaant Mummadi bt Harsh Malik 6-0, 6-2; Om Ramesh Patel bt Mehul Jothish 6-2, 6-3; Aditya Mor bt Rishi Yadav 6-4, 6-3.
Girls: Savitha Bhuvaneswaran bt Sarena Gahlot 6-1, 6-1; Shreeniti Chowdhury bt Paavani Bisht 6-1, 6-0; Harsha Oruganti bt Vaishnavi Singh 6-2, 6-0; Iha Joshi bt Sree Velmanikandan 6-7(4), 6-3, 6-3.

Aditya Mehta hopes to deliver a special gift for his little one

C'WEALTH CUE SPORTS

Tarun Shastry
CHENNAI

Aditya Mehta will have a little extra motivation when he takes the snooker table at the Commonwealth cue sports championships in Ahmedabad from Wednesday.

The former World No. 49 became a father in January, and there is one gift he would dearly love to take back home – an international title.

"I still haven't won an international tournament since my daughter's birth. That's a huge motivation. I'd like win a title for her," Aditya told *The Hindu*.

At 39, Aditya feels he has rediscovered a part of his game that had gone missing over the last few years due to injuries.

Aditya.

"There was a bit of a lull for me in the middle.

"I wasn't quite the player I used to be. I fell, and then I didn't really know where I was going.

" I've passed that phase now. I'm very comfortable with where I am today."

His approach to practice has changed, too.

"It is more about getting quality out of those two or three hours," he said. "I try to go in every day and do something a little better."

Return to pro circuit

That renewed confidence has got Aditya thinking about a return to the professional circuit.

"A few years ago, I was not really sure whether I would ever want to go back to the professional tour. But if I continue down the road I've been on for the last year or so, I would like to have another crack at the pro tour."

For now, though, his sights are firmly set on Ahmedabad – and that special gift for his little one.

"I definitely feel the game is there, and I'd love to win this time".

Indian paddlers get pride of place for WTT Feeder tournament

TABLE TENNIS

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

India will be seeded at the top in four of the five categories in the World Table Tennis Feeder tournament to be held at the Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University (TNPESU) near here from October 28 to November 1.

India's Manav Thakkar (World ranked 48) and Sachi Aoki (WR 55) of Japan have been given the top billing in men's and women's singles.

In men's and women's doubles, Ankur Bhattacharjee and Akash Pal and Diya Chitale-Yashswini Ghorpade pair have been seeded No.1 while Harmeet Desai and Yashaswini Ghorpade have been given the pride of place in the mixed doubles.

Other prominent Indians in men's singles are Ankur, G. Sathiyan, Harmeet and S.F.R. Snehit and Diya, Yashaswini, Divyanshi Bhowmick, Sutirtha Mukherjee and Nithya Mani in women's singles.

Prior to the senior Feeder event, TNPESU will also host the WTT Youth Contender from October 23 to 26.

France roars back to rout Belgium; Italy beats Turkiye

NATIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Michael Olise starred as France stormed back from behind to thrash Belgium 4-1 in the UEFA Nations League on Monday, while Italy continued its resurgence with a 3-1 victory over Turkiye.

Dodi Lukebakio's first-half strike had Belgium on track for a first competitive victory over France since 1981, but Zinedine Zidane turned to his star-studded bench and the host produced a devastating late surge.

France holds a three-point lead over Italy in Group A1, with Belgium another point behind.

Italy, rebuilding under Roberto Mancini, moved up into second place courtesy of a 3-1 win over Turkiye in Bologna.

The results: League A: Group 1: France 4 (Doue 77, Cherki 81, Olise 88, 90+1) bt Belgium 1 (Lukebakio 35); Italy 3 (Scamacca 26, Calafiori 64, Esposito 87) bt Turkiye 1 (Simsir 61). **League B: Group 2:** Ukraine 1 (Yaremchuk 83) lost to Hungary 2 (Toth 52, Csinger 85); Northern Ireland 0 drew with Georgia 0. **Group 4:** Romania 0 lost to Sweden 1 (Gyokeres 13); Bosnia 1 (Basic 84-pen) bt Poland 0. **League C: Group 2:** Cyprus 2 (Costi 70, Edwards 90+4) bt Latvia 1 (Daskevics 57); Montenegro 0 drew with Armenia 0.

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File No. HO/Civil/T&E-E-5296/01/2025 28123, Dt.23/09/2026
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL)-III, IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR
Bid Identification No.Civil/EST/32/26-27
NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement
1. Name of the Work : Construction of Swimming Pool in the district of Kandhamal, Odisha.
2. Value of the Work : Rs.1705.25 Lakhs (Approx.)
3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months
4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :
i. Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt. 07.10.2026
ii. End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt. 28.10.2026
iii. Opening date : 11.30 Hours of dt. 29.10.2026.
Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.
Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/349/2627 OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0127

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, PHULBANI (R&B) CIRCLE, PHULBANI
E-mail : sernbphulbani@gmail.com
Letter No. 2063 Dated : 01/10/2026
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB) - Bid Identification No.CCE_R and B_PLB_05 of 2026_27

1.	The Chief Construction Engineer, Phulbani (R&B) Circle, Phulbani on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE for construction of the Building works as detailed in the table below from eligible contractors.		
2.	Nature of work	:	Building Works
3.	No. of tenders	:	Two Nos
4.	Tender Cost	:	Rs.10,000/- (through online) only.
5.	Class of Contractor	:	B and A Class
6.	Date & Time of sale & receipt of Bids	:	10.00 AM of 07.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of 21.10.2026
7.	Date of Opening of Bid	:	11.00 AM of 22.10.2026
8.	The Bidders shall have to participate in online bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website https://tendersodisha.gov.in. Any addendum/Corrigendum / Cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website. The authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason.		

Chief Construction Engineer, Phulbani (R&B) Circle, Phulbani.
34001/949/2627 OIPR-34001/34129/1/26-27/0006

Government Of Odisha - "e" Procurement of Notice
Bid Identification No. 12 of 2026-27
Notice No.3694 Dated.05.10.2026
Ref- TCN No.3691 Dated.05.10.2026

Sr.No.	Item	Details
1	The GENERAL MANAGER, OSAM BOARD invites percentage rate bids in Double cover system in ONLINE MODE only for work as detailed below :	
2	Nature of the work	Construction of Boundary wall at Nimapada Model Haat Nimapada
3	No of work	01 Nos
4	Bid Cost	Rs. 4000.00 online transfer.
5	Value of Tender	Rs. 1088727
6	Class of Contractor	D & C
7	Availability of BID Documents in the website	Dt . 07.10.2026 to 16.10.2026
8	Last date / time of Receipt of bids in the portal	Dt . 16.10.2026 up to 5.00 PM
9	Date of opening of bid	Dt. 21.10.2026 at 11.30 AM
10	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website : https://tendersorissa.gov.in. Any Addendum/Corrigendum/Cancellation of the Tender etc. can also be seen in the website: https://tendersorissa.gov.in.	

Sd/- General Manager, O.S.A.M. Board, Bhubaneswar
39001/61/2627 OIPR-39001/39024/1/26-27/0005

From flying under the radar to flying high — the Savitha Shri story

The Chennai GM took the chess world by storm in her maiden Olympiad appearance, winning individual gold on the reserve board and helping India bag the team bronze

C. Shyam Sundar

Savitha Shri. Remember the name. She was the surprise package India unleashed at the 24th Olympiad in Uzbekistan recently. In a display which shocked the chess world and even herself, the 19-year-old laid down a marker for the future, with her progress set to be followed keenly.

From being a kid who once sat across the table against Magnus Carlsen – who would soon go on to become the World champion in 2013 – to dazzling at the game's ultimate team event, Savitha has come a long way. She won titles at the National level and on the world stage, bagging the under-12 crown in the World Cadets championship in 2018 and bronze in the World Rapid championship four years later.

Biggest achievements

She appeared to fly under the radar despite her talent and achievements. The Olympiad medals – individual and team – are probably her biggest prizes till date.

The Chennai WGM, who took the competition by storm with a gold medal on the reserve board, had picked up the game at the age of four watching her brother play.

However, it wasn't a smooth ride initially. Her father Krishnan Baskar, who was working as an electrical technician in Singapore, initially thought chess wasn't an expensive pursuit. He subsequently gave up his job abroad in an effort to back his daughter. "I got a chessboard for ₹500 and thought it was all that I needed to spend," he said.

To his surprise, the expenses were more than what he could afford. When a little Savitha took to the game like a duck to water, the family couldn't make ends meet and support the two children at the same time. Baskar said he had to ask his son, Mugesh, to give up chess and focus on academics. He has now completed his degree and begun working.

In the meantime, Savitha's talent meant her father dived headlong into supporting her. He used to accompany her to tournaments and was delighted to watch her perform well.

At one point, the family began to feel the pinch financially. They had to pledge gold jewellery to make sure that her fledgling career didn't hit a roadblock as funding her trips to play tournaments appeared to be beyond the means. "Savitha has become a mature person now," Baskar said even as he waited patiently at the airport to welcome her after her exploits in Samarkand, where the Indian women's team finished with a bronze.

He was delighted to see Savitha shine at the highest level and wished for more support. "*Unmaiya sollanum na, neraya support thevai* (honestly speaking, more is needed)," Baskar said, emphasising on the need for more funding to pursue chess at the top.

First-time experience

As confident as Baskar is about Savitha's career, the teenager appears to be adapting to the new-found stardom. She didn't seem to be weighed down by pressure despite appearing in her maiden Olympiad. "I didn't feel it. I was part of a very supportive team... my teammates were awesome. They just told me to play my game," she said about her undefeated run of eight victories and two draws at the global event.

She described her performance as "amazing". "I wasn't really expecting it. When I had four (wins) from four games, I thought I should keep pushing. As long as I score, it is better for the team," Savitha said while assessing her display, which was instrumental in the team clinching a spot on the podium.

She won on demand and also showed that she could defend resolutely when needed. The hard-fought draws in two matches saved the team from suffering defeats and kept it in the hunt for a medal. She, however, said: "I regret not being able to win in the final round."

Unstoppable run

Savitha was flying in the first four rounds. But, in a surprise move, she was rested for the match against Poland, which the team went on to lose.

Asked about the decision that cost India dear, she said rather matter-of-factly: "Vantika [Agrawal] had won all three matches and was also in good form. Poland is not really that strong compared to the other teams we played. It's unfortunate that we lost. Again, I don't think I have to blame anyone. It was the captain's (Swayams Mishra) decision. I completely agree with it."

All praise for her teammates – Koneru Humpy, R. Vaishali, Divya Deshmukh and Vantika – the Chennai player said: "What can I say? Such a supporting team. For me, it's my first time in the Olympiad. All of them are such senior players... Humpy, Vaishali *akka*. They kept motivating me to play all the rounds." But the amiable and confident

FLICKR & B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Savitha admitted that she was a bit nervous ahead of the contest against China.

"I did feel it at the start of the round. But once the game started, I wasn't thinking about that," she said, adding that playing five-six hours every game very tiring.

Pleasant surprise

Grandmaster Mishra couldn't conceal his delight at the newcomer's stunning streak. He felt that the early run gave her a lot of confidence and that she built on the fantastic start. "We expected her to do well but this one was a pleasant surprise, not just for me but for herself as well. She kept on winning, especially in many clutch games where we needed her to."

Mishra was impressed with Savitha's ability to recover from tough positions and win. "I think we need more players like her who are always fighting for the team."

About her special qualities, the coach said: "Her confidence is very high... When going into the fourth hour, players get tired. That is where I think she was able to be very precise and accurate in most of her games. The moment others get tired, she has the highest energy."

High praise from the team captain indeed!

Where it started

Savitha was trained initially by the late K. Thirukkalathy, a noted coach and former State chess association office-bearer.

"He taught me how to move the pieces. It all started from there. He was a very good coach," she said, terming him as "special" and the one who showed the way. She presently trains under reputed coach and GM R.B. Ramesh, who counts R. Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali among his wards.

What's unique about her

Ramesh had good words to say about Savitha. "Over the board, she does the most practical things without much hesitation when most players would hesitate." On her part, she said, "Ramesh sir helps by analysing games and offers psychological support. We work a lot on the middle and end-game".

Representing India at the Olympiad was a dream for Savitha, according to her father. She made the opportunity count when it came along as she got a look-in after the experienced D. Harika opted out.

Baskar and his family were there at the airport to receive Savitha, who arrived from Uzbekistan with a couple of her compatriots (Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali). As the wait grew longer, he kept pacing around, trying to get in touch with his daughter over the phone. When she emerged, the family seemed overjoyed, with the girl's grandmother thrilled in the moment.

Savitha is known to raise her level when the situation demands and had shown it when she bagged crucial Elo points before the covid-19 pandemic and in 2022. Now that she has gained important points with a splendid show in Samarkand, she would be motivated to get better and improve her ranking.

She is Chennai's new superstar in chess and will look to emerge as the next big thing in the Indian sporting firmament.

THE GIST

- Savitha's stunning run at the Olympiad included eight victories and two draws
- India women's team captain Mishra was impressed with her ability to recover from tough positions and win
- She presently trains under reputed coach and GM R.B. Ramesh, who counts Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali among his wards

In this Delhi studio, tintype brings chemistry into every portrait

Tintype is a traditional, hand-made photographic process from the mid-19th century that made portrait photography more accessible outside the formal and expensive studios of the time; it seems simple yet it conceals a process that demands scientific precision — and therein lies its charm

Aditya Ansh
NEW DELHI

In an age when a portrait can be made in a fraction of a second, Vibhav Kapoor, artist and assistant professor at O.P. Jindal Global University, Sonipat, spends several minutes making one photograph, much of the time spent negotiating with chemistry.

In his Delhi-NCR studio, Mr. Kapoor works with tintype, a 19th-century photographic process in which an image is created directly on a metal plate.

The French photographer Adolphe Alexandre Martin is credited with developing the technique in 1853, two years after Frederick Scott Archer invented the wet-plate collodion process.

Chemically demanding

Unlike processes that produced glass negatives or paper prints, tintypes created a positive image directly on a dark metal plate.

Mr. Kapoor takes a plate with collodion, a syrupy solution of nitrocellulose dissolved in ether and alcohol. He pours it onto a metal plate to form a thin, sticky film, and sensitises it in a silver-nitrate bath in which the iodides and bromides react with silver nitrate to form light-sensitive silver iodide and silver bromide.

Finally, he exposes these light-sensitive compounds through a large-format camera, and develops the images in a dark room using a ferrous sulphate solution acidified with glacial acetic acid and thinned with alcohol; it amplifies the latent image by converting more exposed silver halides into visible metallic silver.

The entire sequence from coating to fixing must be completed while the plate remains wet. There is also no negative to reprint from, so duplicating tintypes is equally arduous.

19th century process

In the mid-19th century, the tintype process was valued for being relatively inexpensive and durable. The dominant photographic process of the era was the daguerreotype. It was costly because it required silver-plated copper sheets as the base material plus iodine and mercury vapour to develop images. Together with the labour-intensive crafting process, each daguerreotype was a luxury item.

Tintypes, however, afforded portraits outside the more formal, expensive photographic studios of the period. In India as well, the process formed part of the early history of photography.

In 1864, a British photographer named T. Murray introduced Sawai Ram Singh II of Jaipur to the tintype camera and documented his court, architecture, and lives of women in the royal zenana. Murray is also known to have helped the ruler develop a royal archive of visuals.

A tintype of Padmanabh Singh, of the erstwhile ruling dynasty of Jaipur State; (Below) portrait in tintype. VIBHAV KAPOOR/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

According to Mr. Kapoor, the Jaipur royal photographer Ram Singh also used the process. "It is a very traditional, hand-made process," Mr. Kapoor said. But its apparent simplicity conceals a process that demands scientific precision.

Mr. Kapoor first learnt tintype photography during his master's degree at the Rochester Institute of Technology, New York, which he spent coating plates, photographing, developing, drying, and finally varnishing the finished image.

The way tintype works also affects the photographer and the subject. The CMOS sensors in today's digital cameras are so fast that a person needs to pose for just a second. On the other hand, the light-sensitive compounds in tintype photography 'record' the light over 8-10 seconds, so the subjects need to present themselves still for that period.

For a portrait, as Mr. Kapoor put it, "The person is performing ..., presenting themselves."

The image emerges in 10 to 15 minutes thereafter.

Weather and chemistry

That said, the photograph's most unpredictable component is the weather. "The chemistry is very volatile and humidity plays a crucial role," Mr. Kapoor said.

"During the monsoon, the humidity causes the tintypes to develop spots," Matthew Fossier, a U.S. tintype practitioner in Texas, said.

Dust is another serious problem. As dust particles settle on the wet collodion layer, they interrupt the formation of silver halide crystals. When the plate is developed, the affected area produces metallic silver differently from the surrounding film, and which appears as an opaque or transparent spot.

Temperature fluctuations can create other artefacts as well, per Mr. Fossier. The collodion contains volatile solvents and heat makes them evaporate faster, leaving the film to become sticky. The plate must be moved quickly to the silver-nitrate bath, where silver ions react with the halides in the collodion to form the light-sensitive silver-halide layer. If the collodion has begun to set unevenly by then, however, the resulting layer can be uneven as well.

He added that the effect is pronounced when pouring the collodion, which reduces the time available to get the plate into the silver bath.

According to Mr. Kapoor, the Delhi-NCR temperatures require him to adjust his solutions: "Heat acts as a catalyst [and] more heat means reactions are faster. The developer has to be managed."

The developer is a chemical solution that reveals the image captured on a sensitised metal plate after exposure. But in warmer weather, the developer works faster, causing streaks or an uneven fog to appear in the picture.

To avoid this, Mr. Kapoor dilutes the developer to change its strength and how long it stays on the plate, slowing the reaction, and allowing the picture to develop clearly.

Photography arrived in India in the 19th century, and the wet-collodion processes became ubiquitous as tintypes circulated in Indian towns in the late 19th and early 20th centuries. Today, however, Mr. Kapoor said "only a handful of photographers in India practise tintype".

(Aditya Ansh is an independent media writer based in New Delhi. adityaansh30@gmail.com)

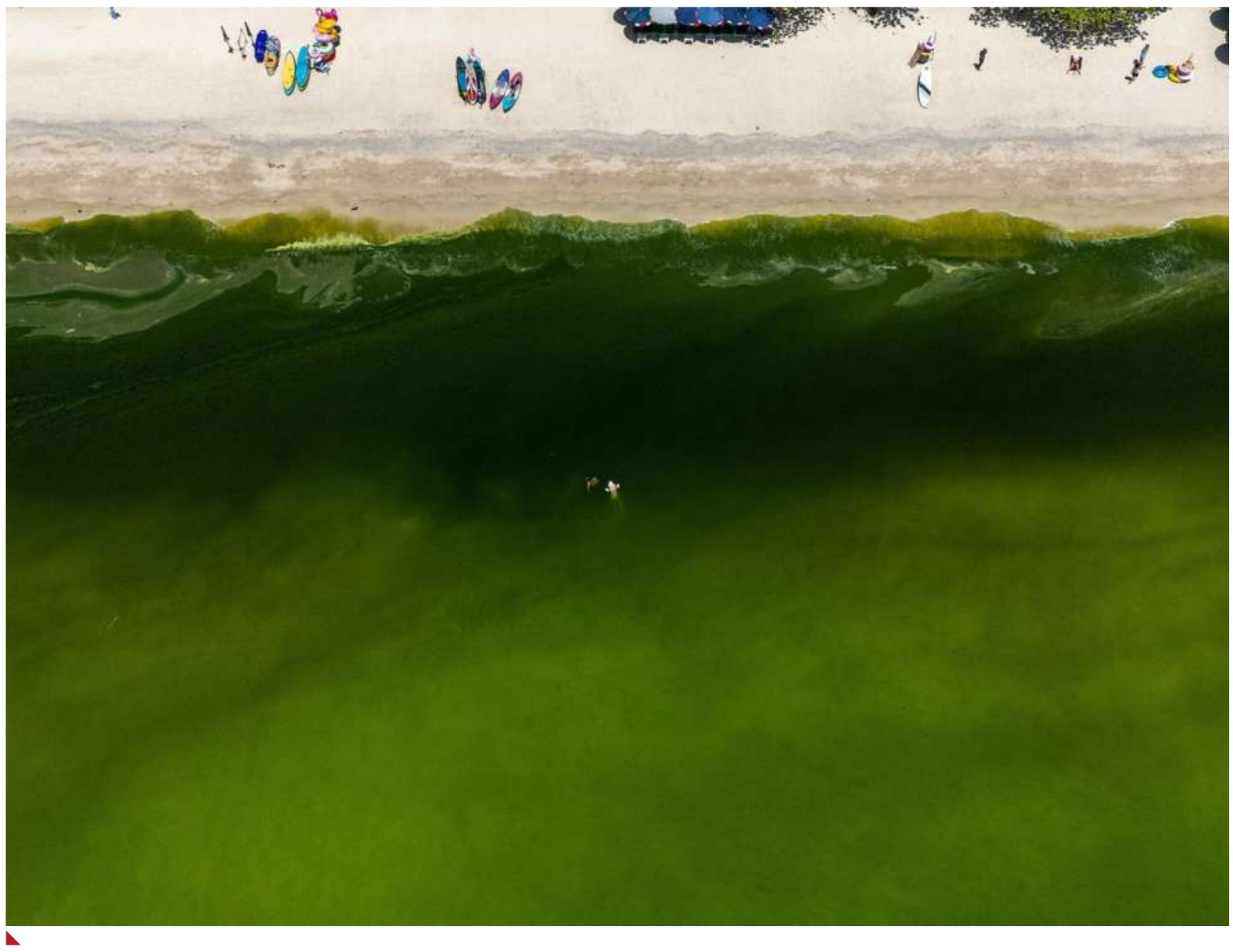
THE GIST

Tintype created images directly on metal plates; it was developed by French photographer Adolphe Alexandre Martin in 1853, two years after Frederick Scott Archer invented the wet-plate collodion process

The process was popular because it was cheap and durable unlike the more expensive daguerreotype; it made portrait photography accessible to more people outside formal studios

Tintypes became common in towns across the country during the late 19th and early 20th centuries; today, however, only a few photographers in India still practise the process

BIG SHOT



A drone view shows tourists swimming in green seawater associated with a plankton bloom, in Koh Lan, Pattaya, Chonburi province, Thailand. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Silk Road: Eurasia's web of trade

Cultural crossroad: The main routes of the Silk Road. KELVIN CASE (CC BY-SA)

Vasudevan Mukunth

Contrary to the name, the Silk Road was a network of multiple land and maritime trade routes connecting parts of east, central, south, and west Asia. The network took different shapes over more than a millennium but became especially important from around the second century BC, when China's Han dynasty expanded west and established contacts with Central Asian states. Because Chinese silk was a prized commodity then, the network was called the Silk Road. Since it offered well-travelled roads, the Silk Road also became the routes that technologies, religions, artistic styles, languages, and natural philosophy took to spread across Eurasia. It is in fact how papermaking spread out from China, as did how Buddhism travelled from India through Central Asia into China. Christianity, Manichaeism, and later Islam also spread along parts of the network — just like musical traditions, and astrological and medical knowledge.

The network also benefited from the Mongol Empire bringing much of Eurasia within a connected political system in the 13th and 14th centuries, and encouraged long-distance journeys. The Road's import gradually declined by the early modern period as trade became cheaper over sea routes, especially in the Indian Ocean, while political conditions changed on land. Even so, the network proved instrumental to make premodern Eurasia as economically and culturally interconnected as it had become, despite its size.

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Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

India's data centre sector investment commitments

173 in $ billion. India's data centre (DC) market added about 130 MW of new capacity in the first six months of 2026, while more than 200 MW is expected to go live in the second half of the year, CBRE said in a report released on Tuesday. Hyperscale and co-location investments accounted for close to 62% of the cumulative DC commitments. PTI

Amount Zambia will sign in U.S. five-year health deal

3.6 in $ billion. Zambia will sign a revised health agreement with the U.S. that will not include contentious clauses committing the African nation to share data with the U.S. government. The U.S. has signed new bilateral health agreements with around two dozen African nations since last year, but some have pushed back on requirements to provide patient data. PTI

Indian crew members injured in ship hit by projectile in Hormuz

11 Eleven Indian crew members were injured on Tuesday after a Panama-flagged commercial vessel was hit by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz. The vessel, *MT On Peace*, carried 19 crew members, including 17 Indian nationals. The Ministry of External Affairs said continuing incidents of attacks on shipping in the region remain a "cause of deep concern" for India. PTI

Ukrainian drones downed overnight, according to Russia

900 Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said on Tuesday. Unconfirmed reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people. PTI

Students who received bicycles under Delhi's Vidya Vahini Yojana

18,000 Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday distributed bicycles to 581 Class 9 girl students under the government's Vidya Vahini Yojana, aimed at making the daily commute to school easier and promoting independence among girls. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The status of U.S. blockade on Cuba

U.S. blockade and decades-old embargo on Cuba have worsened the island's economic and humanitarian crisis, with fuel shortages disrupting electricity, food distribution, healthcare; as Havana seeks to ease the crisis, Trump administration's pressure and demand for regime change continue to constrain Cuba's options

WORLD INSIGHT

Srinivasan Ramani
Sambavi Parthasarathy

The story so far:

It has been nearly nine months since the U.S. President Donald Trump signed an executive order threatening tariffs on any country that supplies Cuba with oil, and the U.S. Coast Guard began intercepting tankers and ships bound for the island. Power cuts in Cuba have since become very common, often lasting beyond 12 hours a day and even close to 20 hours in some provinces. Independent UN human rights experts condemned these actions, calling them "energy starvation" and an "unlawful blockade" of the island country, as the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights reported. In July 2026, the UN General Assembly voted 136-9 (with 30 abstentions) to debate the blockade despite U.S. objections. Mr. Trump, meanwhile, has threatened a takeover of the island nation – a threat that is unlawful according to the UN Charter, which prohibits "the threat or use of force" against a country's political independence. The new blockade is over and above a 64-year-old embargo by the U.S.

Embargo or blockade?

Following the 1959 Cuban revolution, the Cuban government led by Fidel Castro nationalised U.S.-owned property in 1959-60. The U.S. responded, imposing a partial "embargo" on Cuban trade in October 1960 and making it full-fledged in 1962. Cuba terms the measures *el bloqueo,* or a blockade, as it goes beyond mere bilateral trade and is exemplified by further measures taken by the U.S. on Cuban foreign trade. The Cuban Democracy Act of 1992 barred foreign subsidiaries of U.S. firms from trading in Cuba, and the Helms-Burton Act of 1996 wrote the embargo into law, so that only the U.S. Congress can lift it. It also allowed lawsuits against foreign firms using property in Cuba that was confiscated from the Americans.

After coming to power, Mr. Trump expanded further on these punitive measures by bringing Cuba back on the State Sponsors of Terrorism list (without any justification after it was briefly removed by the outgoing Biden administration in January 2025). This has meant that banks find it difficult to deal with Cuban entities. In May, the Trump administration imposed secondary sanctions on foreign firms dealing with the Cuban state and its military conglomerate, GAESA. It has also indicted former Cuban President Raul Castro on problematic charges, besides the January 29 order, which declared a national emergency and authorised extra duties on goods from any country that sells or provides oil to Cuba.

Year after year in the UN General Assembly, since 1992, there has been near-unanimous demand to end the "embargo", but the resolutions are not binding, and this has allowed the U.S. to continue it. Havana claims that the cumulative damage of the embargo has been to the tune of $178.7 billion and $8.08 billion in the year up to February 2026 itself, which includes just one month of the fuel blockade. These costs are not just lost U.S. trade, but also the impact on Cuba's overall trade because of what the embargo imposes. For example, ships docking in Cuba are barred from U.S. ports for 180 days, which has led to increased freight costs. With the U.S. imposing financial sanctions, banks refuse Cuban payments, and imports of medical equipment and machinery have also been affected.

Has this hostility against Cuba always been the case?

U.S. policy towards Cuba has been motivated largely by the lobbying efforts of Cuban exiles based in Miami, Florida, who fled the island following the Revolution. These hardliners include those born to Cuban-immigrant parents, such as current Secretary of State Marco Rubio, who have sought the collapse of the communist system in Cuba. They have also strongly backed the Trump administration's actions, as making conditions that are "ripe for regime change", according to the International Crisis Group.

The hostility against Cuba experienced a brief thaw during former President Barack Obama's second tenure. In December 2014, he and Raul Castro announced a normalisation of ties, which led to embassies reopening, Cuba being taken off the terrorism list, and culminating in a visit to Havana by Mr Obama. Travel and remittance rules were eased, but the embargo still stayed. Mr. Trump reverted much of it during his first tenure before imposing stronger restrictions in his second tenure, which intensified after U.S. forces attacked Venezuela and abducted its president, Nicolas Maduro and took control over the Latin American country's fuel and energy resources since then.

Why was Venezuela an important lifeline for Cuba?

Following the collapse of the Soviet Union, which affected the Cuban economy severely, leading to what was called a "special period", Fidel Castro and Hugo Chavez signed an "oil-for-services" agreement in 2000. This led to the Barrio Adentro health missions (neighbourhood medical services) provided by Cuban doctors in Venezuela. Some 40,000 Cuban doctors, teachers and other professionals worked in Venezuela, while the country supplied about 1,00,000 barrels of oil a day on relatively easy terms. Cuba also resold some of the oil for hard currency, according to U.S. officials, to mitigate the impact of the U.S. financial sanctions.

Meanwhile, mismanagement of the state oil company PDVSA, the 2014 crash in oil prices and later U.S. sanctions cut Venezuela's oil output to a third by the late 2010s, leading to lowered shipments to Cuba. The imports met, by late 2025, only about a quarter of Cuban demand for oil and about a third of its oil imports.

In January 2026, that came to naught too after the U.S. took control of Venezuela's oil sector. Mexico, which had supplied about 44% of Cuba's oil imports, then suspended deliveries. Russia has not been able to step up and fill in the gap either, with just sporadic ships managing to deliver supplies to Cuba since the naval blockade.

What was the impact of the fuel blockade?

The International Crisis Group lists "severe disruption to transportation, food distribution, health care, water systems and communications" in the country. On May 7, three UN Special Rapporteurs said fuel scarcity was keeping people from hospitals and children from school. They cited a backlog of more than 96,000 surgeries, 11,000 of them for children, and delays in infant immunisation.

The scale of the impact is shown in satellite imagery data. An index of night-time light intensity built from NASA satellite data, a proxy for electricity use, fell from about 10-12 in 2021-25 to around six by mid-2026. Ships reaching Cuba have been reduced from 100-120 a month to just 50-60 in early 2026 and oil cargoes have become sporadic. The impact of the sanctions has also meant a large drop in employment in industries such as tourism – which the Cuban government sought to utilise to shore up its dollar reserves – and mining and shipping. The naval blockade has also occurred at a time when one in five Cubans have emigrated in the past five years due to the weak economy.

How is China helping Cuba mitigate the fuel shortage?

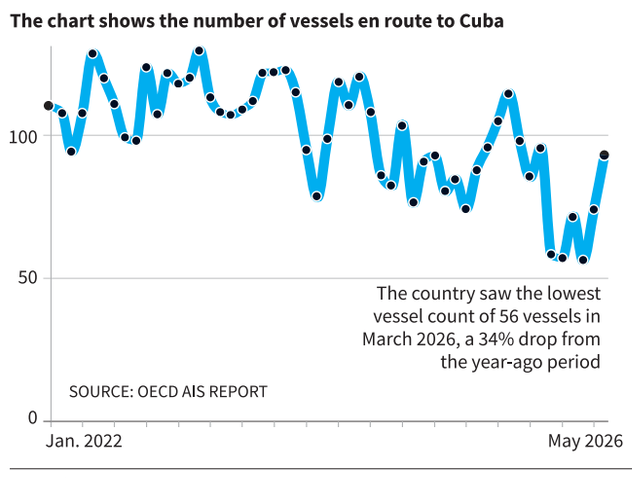
On September 23, President Miguel Diaz-Canel said that Cuba has installed 1,418 MW of solar capacity in 144 parks and would pass 1,500 MW by the end of 2026. He said that renewables already generate 21.4% of the country's electricity. Much of the equipment for these installations have arrived from China. Data from the energy think tank Ember show Chinese exports of solar panels and cells to Cuba being minimal till 2024 and then going up to a cumulative 2,200 MW by mid-2026. In September, reports showed that a third batch of 5,000 standalone solar systems donated by China arrived for public buildings and isolated homes, after shipments in August and November 2025. But power blackouts persist because solar power is not generated after sunset, when demand peaks and battery storage is inadequate in Cuba. The power grid also relies on aging oil-fired plants.

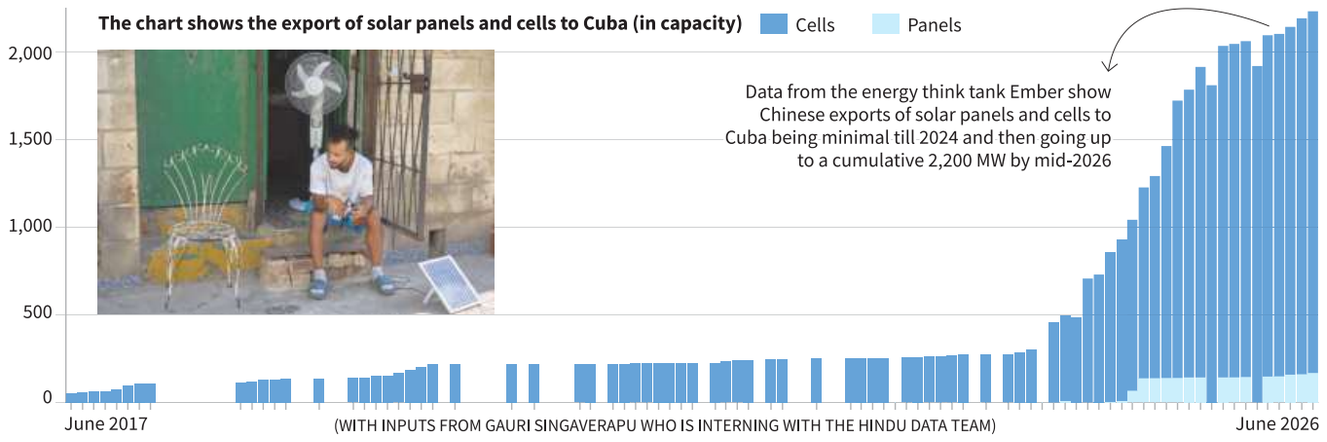
Chinese customs data also show China's imports from Cuba rising from about $50 million in 2015 to $320 million in 2022, with commodities such as zinc ores, nickel products, lead and silver ores, lobsters, cigars and rum. But this trade fell to $230 million in 2025 and $145 million roughly in 2026 so far.

What other reforms has Havana embarked upon?

Havana approved 176 reforms in June to expand private enterprise and foreign investment, but the blockade continues to stymie these. Back-channel talks with the Trump administration have continued but there is little progress because the latter demands regime change while Havana insists that it "will not compromise on its sovereignty or political constitution", according to ICG.

Fragile lifelines | Fewer ships and disrupted trade underline growing pressure on Cuba's economy





(WITH INPUTS FROM GAURI SINGAVERAPU WHO IS INTERNING WITH THE HINDU DATA TEAM)

THE GIST

- The U.S. has tightened pressure on Cuba through secondary sanctions, restrictions on foreign firms and a fuel blockade, building on the 64-year-old embargo that has raised trade, shipping and financial costs for Havana
- Venezuela's oil-for-services arrangement had long been a crucial lifeline for Cuba, but falling Venezuelan production, U.S. intervention and the suspension of Mexican supplies have left the island struggling to meet its fuel needs
- Cuba is turning to Chinese-backed solar power and reforms to private enterprise and foreign investment to cope, but inadequate battery storage, an ageing power grid and continued sanctions have limited their impact

Why growing trust in digital payments may be leaving Indians more exposed to cybercrime

UPI has become a more trusted and frequently used mode of payment in India; but SPIR 2026 finds a paradox, people who trusted online banking the most and used UPI most often were more likely to have been victims of cybercrime; report shows how fraud networks exploit this trust through deceptive schemes, fake apps and 'digital arrest'

Vinson Prakash

At a roadside tea stall, the QR code neatly taped on the can of biscuits now does more work than the cash box. A scan, a password, and a reassuring beep. No change to count, no note to fumble. In a country where your vegetable vendor, the auto driver and the doctor all get paid the same way, digital payments, especially UPI, have become a site where one's bread and butter are bought and sold.

The scale is hard to overstate. UPI has processed over 24,000 crore transactions in FY 2025-26, with the transaction values crossing ₹314 lakh crore. As the world's most populous country, India has 70% of its population connected to the internet, making it one of the most sought-after global markets for internet services and digital platforms. That vast, eager, and active user base is also a tempting target. One that is ripe to be picked on by cybercriminals. The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026 shows how the two meet: how India uses the internet and how cybercriminals stay one step ahead of users.

Digital payments are a daily habit for Indians. About half (49%) of the respondents use UPI apps every day, while another quarter (24%) use them once or twice a week. UPI also stood out as the most frequently used online payment method, with almost half (48%) saying they use it "many times", ahead of card, wallet, and NEFT/RTGS payment methods (Table 1).

Trust follows usage. UPI garnered the most trust out of all payment methods, with a third (34%) of the respondents considering it "very safe" and two in five (41%) considering it "somewhat safe", meaning three in four people consider it to be safe. Card payments came in second, with about two in three (65%) considering it safe – 28% considering it 'very safe' and 37% 'somewhat safe' – followed by wallet-based apps and mobile banking apps. Taking all online banking modes together, a majority of the respondents find them to be safe, with about a quarter (23%) finding them "very safe" and about two in five (40%) finding them "somewhat safe".

On its own, this is a success story. People trust a system they use constantly, and the system mostly delivers.

The trust test

UPI dominates online payments, but the SPIR 2026 data shows that high trust and frequent use can coexist with greater exposure to cybercrime

Table 1: UPI is the most frequently used for of online payment

Online payment modes	Frequency of use		
	Many times	Sometimes	Never
UPI	48	30	19
Debit/credit card payment	20	40	33
Payment wallets	14	25	49
NEFT/RTGS	7	23	57

Note: *All figures are in percentages. The rest did not respond. The categories 'never' and 'I don't make online payments' are merged to form the 'never' category.*

Question asked: *When making payments online, how frequently do you use the following a) UPI b) NEFT/RTGS c) Debit/credit card payment d) Payment wallets – many times, sometimes, or never?*

Table 2: Those who consider online banking to be safe are more likely to be victims of cybercrime

Index of perceived safety of various modes of online banking	Have you been a victim of a cybercrime or helped the victim closely in cyber complaint registration/handling the issue?	
	Yes	No
Very safe	28	65
Somewhat safe	26	70
Somewhat unsafe	22	73
Very unsafe	14	80

Note: *All figures are in percentages. The rest did not respond.*

Question asked: *Have you been a victim of a cybercrime in the last 2-3 years; or did you help the victim closely in registering the cyber complaint or in handling the overall issue?*

Question asked: *In your opinion, how safe are these modes of online banking: a) UPI b) Mobile banking apps c) Internet banking websites d) Debit/credit card payments g) Wallet-based apps – very safe, somewhat safe, somewhat unsafe, or very unsafe?*

The trust paradox

SPIR also asked a different set of questions about behaviour, which together measure how vulnerable a person is to unsafe online practices. Would they open a link from an unverified sender? A photo, video, or file from a stranger? Share an OTP with an unknown caller? And so on.

When trust is set beside vulnerability, the pattern is striking. The people most prone to unsafe online practices were also the most confident about online banking. Among the highly vulnerable, about half (49%) called online banking modes "very safe" and another 39% considered them "somewhat safe". Among those with moderate to no vulnerability, only about a fifth, on average, considered online banking to be "very safe".

Following this thread towards victimisation, it was found that those who considered online banking modes as "very safe" were also more likely to have been victims of cybercrimes in the past 2-3 years. Among victims, 28% considered online banking modes to be "very safe" compared with 14% who considered online banking modes 'very unsafe' (Table 2). As perceptions of safety decreased, so did their likelihood of being a victim.

Usage tells the same story. Those who use UPI "many times" were more likely to have been victims of cybercrime in the last 2-3 years, compared to those who "never" use it.

People's high trust and usage of online banking methods is being met with an adversary that is organised and inventive. A cybercrime expert in the report described a supply chain that sells fraudsters "kits" of pre-activated SIM cards, bank accounts, and cell phones. For a small investment of ₹10,000-20,000 in these kits, the fraudsters can swindle someone's life savings worth tens of lakhs or crores, and remain largely untraceable. The interviewed victims further shed light on the various inventive schemes cybercriminals use to defraud people. The fraudsters create entire investment/betting apps, convincingly hold victims under digital arrest for several days, and gain victims' trust and convince them to share personal information.

The deception does not stop at victims. Two people interviewed for the report, both accused of perpetrating cybercrime, said they had lent their bank accounts to fraudsters who deceived them, leaving them part of a crime they did not fully understand. Fraudsters are not only exploiting gaps in the financial system, but they are recruiting its users and leaving them to be apprehended by the police as the most replaceable link in the chain, while they themselves go untouched.

The SPIR 2026 points to an almost paradoxical association: the more people use digital payments, the more they trust them, and the more likely they are to be victims of cybercrime. But that is only one half of the picture. The other half is a sophisticated adversary who is armed with the right tools, exploits the trust people have in their financial systems, and quite tactfully plays on the human psyche to deceive their victims.

(Vinson Prakash is a researcher at Common Cause)

Cyber fraud victims dissatisfied with banks over delayed action and poor recovery support: study

13% of respondents experienced cybercrime in the past two to three years, with 54% of victims reporting digital financial fraud; while most victims approached banks within 24 hours, many reported delays in blocking unauthorised transactions, poor support and banks' reluctance to accept liability; victims, experts also raised several concerns

Radhika Jha

Cybercrimes have disrupted our conventional understanding of both how crimes take place and how the systems responding to them function. While there is much to be said about the non-financial cybercrimes that may be just as prevalent as financial cybercrimes, the latter have captured the public's imagination and fears in unprecedented ways.

A recent study by Common Cause and Lokniti, CSDS, the Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026: Cybercrimes – Victim Perspectives and Systemic Responses, brings out the perspectives of the common public, victims, and domain experts on this issue, focusing on how victims navigate through the complex systems. The study is based on a survey of 8,306 respondents from across 16 States/U.T.s, along with in-depth interviews with 37 stakeholders, including victims, cybercrime experts, and others.

In financial cybercrime cases, the banking sector becomes an integral part of the reporting and resolution process, widening the traditional understanding of the core criminal justice institutions such as the police and courts. In this context, the study explores, among other things, whether banks as an institution are prepared to deal with these cases and to take accountability for security lapses.

According to the survey data, 13% of the overall respondents were victims of cybercrimes in the last 2-3 years. Among the victims, more than half (54%) were victims of digital financial frauds.

One of the first actions taken by the victim after the incident was complaining directly to the banks. More than half of the victims of digital financial fraud (52%) who were surveyed said that they had complained to the bank separately after the incident. A majority, 63%, complained within the first 24 hours.

Banks' response

Despite the promptness in reporting shown by many victims, the response by the banks leaves much to be desired. A 2017 RBI guideline states that in cases of third-party breach due to no deficiency by either the bank or the customer, and if the customer notifies the bank within three days, the loss must be borne by the bank entirely. This was extended on a pilot basis in 2026 to include those cases wherein the customer had been tricked or coerced into making scam payments, with limited liability being placed on the bank in such cases.

In-depth interviews with victims revealed, however, that the banks' response to cybercrimes is almost entirely focused on evading accountability and liability. The standard response from the banks in cases of digital financial fraud is that the victim "collaborated" with the perpetrator of the cybercrime. All the victims of digital financial cybercrimes who were interviewed qualitatively, barring one, said that the bank maintained this in their case, even in cases where the victims did not interact with the perpetrators at any point. Notably, the one case in which the banks did not give this response included a high net-worth individual with a long-standing relationship with the bank.

Low satisfaction

Vipin (name changed), a Gurgaon-based journalist, got a scam call for SIM upgradation on a Saturday. The caller, pretending to be an Airtel employee, shared some of his personal information to appear legitimate, including his name, date of birth, Aadhaar number, and debit card number. Despite cutting the call, ₹5,000 was withdrawn from a payment wallet linked to his number the following day. He immediately blocked his number and emailed his bank, since it was closed on Sunday. However, by Monday afternoon, his account had still not been blocked, and the fraudsters had taken a loan of ₹5 lakhs against his credit card, half of which had already been withdrawn. The bank, however, took "zero accountability" for this loss and was "apathetic" to the complaint, as reported by him.

Other victims reported similar instances of delays by the banks in stopping the flow of unauthorised transactions immediately following the complaint. While the banks become directly liable for such losses when presented with such evidence of negligence in taking prompt action, there is little accountability for the mental, physical and financial costs to the victim in the recovery process necessitated by such negligence

Data (in)security

A more serious allegation levelled against the banks, both by cybercrime experts as well as victims, is that of complicity in the cybercrimes, whether directly or indirectly. The survey data shows that amongst victims who complained to the bank separately, as many as 40% were of the opinion that the cybercrime occurred due to their financial data being leaked by a bank insider. Amongst those who did not complain to the bank separately, 26% hold this opinion. Overall, while a significant proportion of the victims feel that the breach of their personal data enabled the cybercrime incident, this sentiment is amplified amongst those who had first-hand experience with the bank in dealing with their case.

In-depth interviews with victims made similar grave allegations against the banks. Of the 13 digital financial fraud victims interviewed, five victims were of the opinion that bank officials were directly or indirectly complicit in the crime. One of the victims was told by the police officer investigating her case that the bank must be complicit, though no charges were filed against it.

Cybercrime experts and senior police officers dealing with these cases strongly supported this perception. They further stressed the lack of accountability for the common leakages of customer data, due to inadequate security systems.

Another major systemic loophole is the lack of due diligence by banks when opening bank accounts, which can be used as mule accounts in cybercrime cases. Policing and cybercrime experts were of the opinion that banks prioritise their business interests over building secure systems. "People like you and me will lose access to our accounts due to KYC procedures, but these accounts [the cyber criminals'] will never be closed", stated a former police officer.

Satisfaction with the banks

Overall, the levels of satisfaction with the banks remained low across the victims of digital financial cybercrimes, as is emerging both from the survey data as well as the in-depth interviews with victims. More than one out of five victims of digital financial fraud surveyed reported being "very dissatisfied" with the bank's role in recovering money, while 16% said that they were somewhat dissatisfied.

Amongst the in-depth interview respondents, the satisfaction levels were lower, with the victims rating the banks a poor one out of five. Even in cases where the victims were able to recover their money fully or partially, the satisfaction with the banks remained low. Notably, there was not much variation in the reported experience or satisfaction levels across private and public-sector banks.

(Radhika Jha is Project Lead (Rule of Law) at Common Cause and lead researcher and author of the Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) series. Views expressed are personal)

Banking on banks

Victims often report fraud quickly, but face delays and poor support when seeking recovery

Table 1: More than half of all cybercrimes involve digital financial frauds

Nature of crime	Victims
Digital financial frauds	54
Hacking of devices	13
Personal data theft	11
Cyberbullying/abuse on social media	7
Online sexual harassment	4

Note: *The rest did not respond or reported facing other types of crime. All figures are in percentages*

Question: *What type of crime did you face?*

Table 2: Nearly two out of three respondents reported the fraud to the bank within 24 hours

Time taken to report the fraud after it occurred	Victims/respondents who assisted victims of cybercrimes (%)
Within 24 hours	63
Within 48 hours	21
More than 48 hours	11

Note: *The rest did not respond.*

Question asked: *How soon after the fraud did you/ they report it- within 24 hours, within 48 hours, more than 48 hours?*

Table 3: Two-fifths of the victims who complained separately to the bank feel that crime occurred due to a breach of personal data

Complained made separately to the bank (among victim)	Yes, it occurred due to a breach of personal data	No, it didn't happen because of the breach of personal data
Yes	40	44
No	26	54

Note: *The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages.*

Question asked: *Some victims of financial cybercrimes believe that their financial data was leaked by a bank insider because of which they were targeted by criminals. In your case, do you think the crime occurred due to a breach of your personal data by the bank or its personnel?*

Statement 1: *Yes, it occurred due to a breach of personal data;* ***Statement 2:*** *No, it didn't happen because of that.*

Table 4: Nearly a quarter of the victims of cyber fraud are very dissatisfied with the bank's role in recovery of money

	Degree of satisfaction			
	Very satisfied	Somewhat satisfied	Somewhat dissatisfied	Very dissatisfied
The bank's role in recovering the money	11	21	16	22

Note: *The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages. The table includes responses from both the victims and those who assisted cybercrime victims of digital financial fraud.*

Question asked: *How satisfied were you with the following – very satisfied, somewhat satisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, or very dissatisfied?*